

What's News

Business & Finance

◆ Disney named Josh D'Amaro as its new chief executive, elevating the man in charge of its theme parks and cruise ships to lead the entertainment brand. **A1**

◆ U.S. manufacturing is in retreat, with fewer people working in the sector than at any point since the Covid-19 pandemic ended. **A1**

◆ Software stocks sagged on investors' fears that the technology could be supplanted by AI, helping to depress the S&P 500, Nasdaq and Dow by 0.8%, 1.4% and 0.3%, respectively. **A1**

◆ Fed governor Stephen Miran said he has resigned from his job as a top White House economic adviser, ending an unusual dual role. **A2**

◆ Citadel founder and CEO Ken Griffin criticized the Trump administration's interference in the daily business of American companies and raised concerns about self-serving decisions made by government officials. **A2**

◆ PepsiCo is cutting prices by as much as 15% on some of its snacks after consumers complained about the affordability of the products. **B1**

◆ PayPal replaced its chief executive, saying its board decided "the pace of change and execution was not in line" with expectations. **B2**

◆ Google plans to spend \$4.75 billion to help find enough electricity to run more data centers, a capacity essential to maintaining the AI race. **B1**

◆ Nintendo maintained its annual forecasts for Switch 2 sales and net profit even as it reported sharply higher nine-month results, boosted by the gaming device's popularity. **B4**

Worldwide

◆ The Republican-led House passed funding legislation to end a partial government shutdown and kick off 10 days of negotiations over immigration enforcement. **A3**

◆ Two Iranian maritime provocations against the U.S. appear not to have derailed scheduled nuclear talks between Tehran and Washington this week, U.S. officials said. **A6**

◆ A new poll shows 76% of Greenlanders say they wouldn't benefit from becoming part of the U.S., noting disparities in provisions for social welfare between Denmark and the U.S. **A7**

◆ Trump doubled down on his view that Republicans should "nationalize" voting in the U.S., questioning whether certain states should continue running their own elections as spelled out in the Constitution. **A4**

◆ Former President Bill Clinton and former Secretary of State Hillary Clinton reached a deal to appear for depositions in the House investigation into Jeffrey Epstein. **A5**

◆ Trump said he is seeking \$1 billion in damages from Harvard University, the latest escalation in his administration's fight with the institution over alleged antisemitism. **A3**

◆ Polish authorities arrested a Defense Ministry official for allegedly spying on behalf of Russia and Belarus, in one of the country's highest-profile espionage cases. **A6**

◆ A Doberman pinscher named Penny won best in show at the 150th annual Westminster Kennel Club Dog Show in New York City. **A5**

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U.S. Manufacturing Is in Retreat

Factories cut jobs as president's promised boom from tariffs hasn't occurred

By DAVID UBERTI

The manufacturing boom President Trump promised would usher in a golden age for the U.S. is going in reverse. After years of economic interventions by the Trump and Biden administrations, fewer people work in manufacturing than any point since the pandemic ended.

Manufacturers shed workers in each of the eight months after Trump unveiled "Liberation Day" tariffs, according to federal figures, extending a contraction that has seen more than 200,000 roles disappear since 2023.

An index of factory activity tracked by the Institute for Supply Management shrunk in 26 straight months through December, but showed a January uptick in new orders and production that surprised analysts. The Census Bureau estimated that manufacturing construction spending, which surged with Biden-era funding for chips and renewable energy, fell in each of Trump's first nine months in office.

The gradual slowdown is in some ways a continuation of decadeslong trends that pulled factory jobs overseas and helped empty out Midwestern cities. In an industry where capital plans and construction timelines extend years into the future, turnarounds also don't happen overnight.

In November, the Federal Reserve slashed estimates for overall U.S. output since the pandemic in an annual revision to metrics for industry.

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Manufacturing job openings

Monthly job openings

Six-month moving average

Source: Labor Department

Russia Resumes Attacks to Cripple Ukraine Energy

WARM HEARTS: Polish volunteers served soup in a bitterly cold Kyiv on Tuesday as Russia launched one of its biggest strikes on Ukrainian cities. The air attack hit thermal power plants and left nearly 2,000 apartment buildings without heat. **A6**

The Aide Stoking Trump's Impulses

Stephen Miller uses his White House clout to fuel boundary-pushing policies

By JOSH DAWSEY AND TARINI PARTI

Moments after federal officers fatally shot Alex Pretti, his body still lying facedown on an icy Minneapolis street, Customs and Border Protection officials texted Stephen Miller, the White House aide and presidential confidant who framed the government's response.

While White House communication and policy aides tried to sort out what they knew, what they should say and who would brief President Trump, Miller jumped ahead. Three hours after the shooting, Miller told the world via X that the slain VA nurse was a "domestic terrorist" who had "tried to assassinate federal law enforcement," a description that set off one of the Trump administration's biggest political crises of the president's second term.

None of the language Miller used had been approved or reviewed, said administration officials familiar with the matter. Miller, who shared a photo of the handgun found on Pretti's hip with White House officials, told colleagues his comments were based on

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◆ Measure ending shutdown signed... **A3**

Walmart Joins \$1 Trillion Club

In trading Tuesday morning, Walmart passed the \$125.47 a share needed to reach its trillion-dollar valuation. Shares closed up 2.9%, giving the retailer a market cap of \$1.018 trillion. **B1**

Walmart's market capitalization, past three years

Source: FactSet

Companies with market value over \$1 trillion

They Landed the Super Bowl. The Party Got Away.

The game is in San Jose's backyard, but city is getting the 'Charlie Brown' treatment

By JIM CARLTON

SAN JOSE, Calif.—Do you know the way to San Jose? Some here think the NFL doesn't.

The city's more glamorous cousin, San Francisco, ended up with the lion's share of official Super Bowl week activities. This despite San Francisco being 40 miles north of Levi's Stadium, where the game will be played, while San Jose is next door.

Even worse, it's not the first time the Bay Area's largest city has lost out on first place to its No. 2 neighbor.

During the 2016 Super Bowl

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◆ NFL's best free-agent bargain..... **A16**

AI Worry Erases \$300 Billion In Software Firms' Market Value

By MATT WIRZ AND JACK PITCHER

Investors' fears that new developments in artificial intelligence will supplant software reverberated through the stock market Tuesday, dragging down the shares of companies that develop, license and even invest in code and systems.

Traders have questioned whether AI will chip away at the competitive moat built by software makers like Adobe and Salesforce ever since generative AI models hit the market several years ago. Recent advancements in tools such as those from AI developer Anthropic are now prompting more scrutiny.

On Tuesday morning, investors homed in on Anthropic's announcement that it was adding new legal tools to its Cowork assistant meant to help automate a number of legal drafting and research tasks. Shares of Thomson Reuters, Legalzoom.com and London Stock Exchange, which all provide some form of legal tools or research databases, all fell more than 12%.

By afternoon trading, the downturn had swept through the broader software market. A pair of S&P indexes that track software, financial-data and exchange stocks lost a combined total of around \$300 billion in market value.

The tech-heavy Nasdaq composite fell 1.4%. The S&P 500 was 0.8% lower, while the Dow Jones Industrial Average, which is less exposed to software, fell 0.3%.

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◆ Heard on the Street: Fickle market for AI offerings... **B13**

INSIDE

BUSINESS & FINANCE

Cybercrime prosecutors raid X's Paris office, summon Musk for interview. **B1**

S&P's 'Earnings Pope' Stirs Lament With Exit

By KRYSTAL HUR

The high priest of the S&P 500 index. The dean of data. The earnings pope.

Those are all monikers bestowed upon Howard Silverblatt, longtime senior index analyst at S&P Global. Famous for his encyclopedic knowledge of the benchmark stock index and his fast-paced Brooklyn burr, he has been a markets data maven for everyone from Wall Street analysts to financial journalists.

But after nearly 49 years, Silverblatt has taken on a new title: Florida retiree.

Silverblatt spent his entire career at S&P, a rarity among restless Wall Street hustlers who often flit between companies to climb the corporate ladder. His monthly email blasts, chock-full of data on earnings, stock buybacks and returns tied to the S&P 500, have long been considered essential reading for market watchers. Now many are wondering what he'll do next.

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U.S. NEWS

Factory Sector Is In Retreat

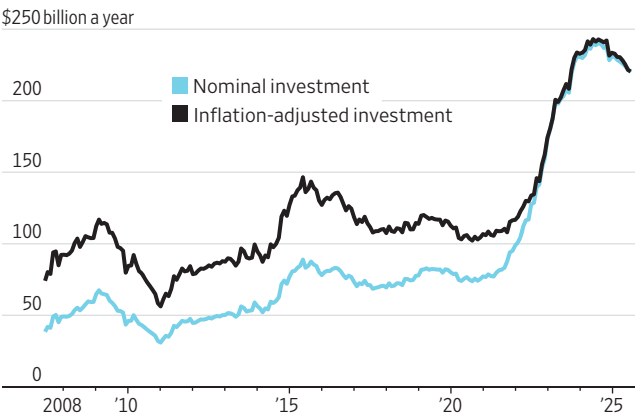
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trial production.
“We never got all the way back” from the pandemic, said Josh Lehner, a U.S. economist at SGH Macro Advisors.
While auto and chip makers have cut tens of thousands of workers over the past year, stable layoff rates across the sector suggest that the jobs pullback is gradual.
Lehner and other economists also said there are signs output has stabilized, if not inched higher, though gains in efficiency could limit the number of new jobs. A White House spokesman noted that manufacturing productivity ticked upward in recent quarters and that workers’ wage hikes outpaced inflation over the past year.
In the long term, tariffs could achieve their desired effect of making some manufacturers more competitive with overseas producers. Economists believe lower interest rates and deregulation could also provide support. But in the shorter run, tariffs have boosted many companies’ costs on materials sourced abroad, pushing firms that buy foreign parts to raise prices or scramble for supplies.
The White House’s stop-and-start policymaking—Trump threatened new tariffs on Europe, Canada and South Korea in recent weeks—has also led to what many executives view as a lost year for investment. The possibility that the Supreme Court could nullify some import taxes has added to the uncertainty.
At the same time, China and others have continued pumping out exports despite tariffs, pushing down prices in global markets where U.S. manufacturers are struggling to compete.
“There’s very little in our product portfolio that has benefited from tariffs,” said H.O. Woltz III, chief executive of North Carolina-based Insteel Industries.
With tariffs on foreign steel doubled to 50% this year, Insteel has increasingly struggled to get from U.S. suppliers the metal it shapes into wire that reinforces concrete infrastructure, such as the Gordie Howe bridge, a major trade crossing that will



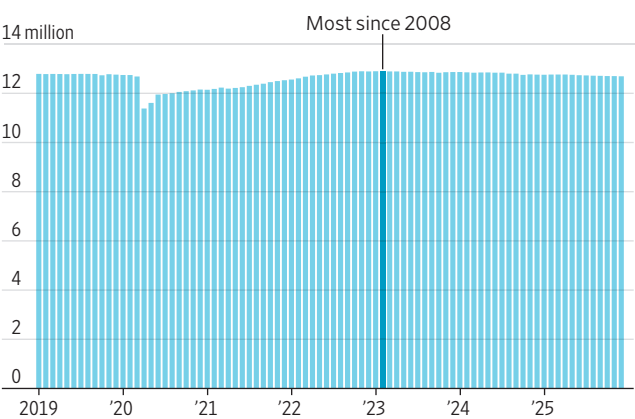
Workers prepare to weld a steel tube at HCC, a company that uses parts to make combines, in Mendota, Ill.

soon connect Detroit to Canada. Instead, Insteel has at times turned to tariffed imports from Algeria, India and elsewhere when there weren’t enough U.S. supplies to go around.
“Our growth today could be compromised by the dearth of [domestic] raw material available to us,” Woltz said.
In the trucking industry, a yearslong postpandemic slide has dinged firms such as metal-component maker NN. The Charlotte, N.C.-based company, which runs 23 plants in six countries, trimmed its U.S. workforce in recent years to compete with low-cost factories abroad, as well as in response to slowing growth in electric-vehicle demand.
CEO Harold Bevis believes tariffs will ultimately benefit NN by curbing Chinese competition for precision parts that appear in steering systems, audiovisual controls and more. But meanwhile, import taxes have helped push up costs for steel and aluminum, adding to pressures from soaring market prices for the gold and silver NN uses in some products.
That has squeezed how much cash the firm has to invest in new, potentially lucrative sectors such as data centers and electrical equipment.
“So you take a hit,” Bevis said. NN is trying to recoup costs by raising prices in subsequent orders.
Bevis said business has accelerated while Ford and GM, which recently took multibillion-dollar write-downs on their EV businesses, have pushed for domestic parts. As

Manufacturing construction spending, annualized rate



U.S. manufacturing jobs



Sources: Census Bureau (spending); Labor Department (manufacturing jobs)

NN evaluates where to expand manufacturing for the auto business, Bevis warned places such as Michigan and Massachusetts are still a hard sell compared with Mexico, where many products remain tariff-free through a trade deal.
Investing to supply the auto market in China—home to three NN factories—is also a safer bet than building out its footprint stateside.
Pointing to that country’s parallel push to consolidate auto supply chains within its borders, Bevis said, “They are doing it at a way faster pace than the U.S.”
Trump, a Republican, has

taken other measures to try to jump-start the manufacturing sector. He muscled trading partners such as Japan and South Korea into deals that include pledges to invest hundreds of billions of dollars in the U.S. Firms such as Apple, TSMC and AstraZeneca have announced massive projects that could create thousands of manufacturing jobs.
Administration officials said the long-term vision is to make industries self-sufficient. The timeline for investments is often years, muddling the near-term outlook for manufacturing.
“I don’t know when all of this money is going to kick in,” Trump said in a December interview with The Wall Street Journal.
Analysts said that new investments will likely focus on the robotic tools and artificial-intelligence components that have captivated Wall Street, meaning a surge in new, permanent factory jobs is less likely.
Some investors believe interest-rate cuts and stimulative fiscal policy should help the economy grow faster this year.
“The biggest factor overall in how manufacturing is doing is how our economy is doing. There’s no getting away from that,” said Scott Paul, president of the Alliance for American Manufacturing, which supports tariffs on steel and many Chinese products. “It’s way too early to tell what the new normal is because we’ve just exited the roller-coaster ride.”

Miran Resigns As Trump Adviser

Official is expected to remain at Fed until Senate confirms successor

By MATT GROSSMAN

Federal Reserve governor Stephen Miran said he has resigned from his job as a top White House economic adviser, ending an unusual dual role he had held since he joined the central bank in September.
The move allows Miran to keep his promise to step down from the White House if his time at the Fed were to extend past Jan. 31, when his term at the central bank expired. Miran can stay in place on the Fed’s Board of Governors until a successor is confirmed.
“I believe it is important to stay true to my word while I continue to perform the job at the Federal Reserve to which you and the Senate appointed me,” Miran wrote in a letter to President Trump seen by The Wall Street Journal.
Miran was the chairman of the White House Council of Economic Advisers when Trump nominated him in August to fill the final months of a term on the Fed’s board left vacant when another official, Adriana Kugler, resigned.
Miran went on leave from his White House position but retained the title while at the Fed. Some worried the arrangement compromised the independence of the Fed. Miran said at the time he would make independent policy judgments.
Democratic senators on Monday questioned Miran on his plans in a letter. “Your extended tenure at the Federal Reserve has only compounded what was an improper arrangement from the outset, and this dual employment must end,” the letter said.
A White House spokesman confirmed Miran’s departure and praised his work as an economic adviser.

Executive Criticizes Trump Intrusions

By PETER RUDEGEAR

Citadel founder and CEO Ken Griffin criticized the Trump administration’s interference into the day-to-day business of American companies and raised concerns about self-serving decisions made by government officials.
“When the U.S. government starts to engage in corporate America in a way that tastes of favoritism, I know for most CEOs that I’m friends with, they find it incredibly distasteful,” Griffin said in a conversation at the WSJ Invest Live event Tuesday in West Palm Beach, Fla. “Most CEOs just don’t want to find themselves in the business of having to, in some sense, suck up to one administration after another to succeed in running their business.”
Griffin faulted the federal government for investing in private-sector companies, a practice that he said also happened in the Obama and Biden administrations. Under President Trump, Griffin said he was also bothered by business deals that benefited family members of the president and administration officials, such as when lieutenants to an Abu Dhabi royal bought a 49% stake in the Trump family’s nascent cryptocurrency firm just before the inauguration. The Wall Street Journal earlier reported on the \$500 million investment.
Griffin opened the door for a potential run for political office or job in government. “I’d like to believe that at a future point in my life, I will be involved in public service,” he said, adding any such move would be many years from now.

Markets Data Guru Retires

Continued from Page One
dering what they will do without him.
“That 60-hour workweek was not as much fun as it used to be,” Silverblatt, 71 years old, said in an interview. “We are entering a new stage, and you do need people coming up to fill that.”
Today’s financial markets are a far cry from what they were decades ago. The S&P 500 returned around 12% on an annualized basis during Silverblatt’s nearly half-century-long run, counting price changes and dividend payments. The adoption of electronic systems has made trading faster and more plentiful than ever before. Individual investors have flooded into markets, while nontraditional assets from cryptocurrencies to prediction markets have exploded in popularity.

In contrast, Silverblatt has remained anchored in the past. He prefers reading newspapers over screens, still creasing the pages into a subway fold like he was taught as a child. He crunched numbers using an old DOS-based database manager, printing out hard copies full of data and checking the figures by pen. He kept a pager clipped to his belt.
“I like the fact that he, in some ways, represents the old Wall Street,” said Jason DeSena Tremmert, co-founder and chairman of Strategas. “He’s kind of a scrappy guy.”
Silverblatt grew up in a one-bedroom apartment in Brooklyn. His mother worked part time as a bookkeeper while his father was a tax attorney. He studied business management at Syracuse University.
Silverblatt began his career at Standard & Poor’s in 1977, poring over corporate filings and reports to create databases and help compile the S&P stock guide, known as the bible of Wall Street before stock information was readily available online. Early in his career, he and his colleagues would sometimes sleep at a bar close to



Howard Silverblatt

the office instead of at home.
He met his wife, Rebecca, at a wedding in 1992. She was dating another man at the time (“He had a boat,” Silverblatt said), but by the following year, she and Silverblatt were married.
“Howard lives and works at warp speed,” said CFRA Research’s Sam Stovall, who worked with Silverblatt at S&P Global for 28 years. “He basically is in a totally different dimension from the rest of the world, and that’s how he gets things done.”

He was similarly headstrong in his work. David Blitzer, former chair of the S&P index committee and Silverblatt’s old boss, recalls once arguing with a reporter on the phone after refusing to give him data for an article. The next day, he saw those very figures in the paper. The source turned out to be Silverblatt.
For Silverblatt, it was a no-brainer to give the data to the reporter—or to anyone who asked. He tried to answer every question that entered his inbox, from individual investors at home, financial journalists on deadline or investing firms. Colleagues at S&P Global would send him their own requests, too.
In a 2001 interview with The Wall Street Journal, Chuck Hill, then-director of research at First Call, accused S&P of acting like a self-appointed “earnings pope,” for including expenses in calculating operating earnings that most analysts believed should be excluded. Silverblatt responded through his own Journal interview: “We have no problem with being the pope.” He now says that is his favorite of his nicknames.

CORRECTIONS & AMPLIFICATIONS

The SAVE Act would require voters to provide identification proving citizenship to be eligible to vote, and some Republicans pushed for that bill to be included in a congressional package to fund the government. In some editions Tuesday, a U.S. News article about the partial government shutdown incorrectly called it the VOTE Act. The error also appeared in some editions Monday in a Page One article about the shutdown.

Freezing temperatures were forecast for much of Tennessee on Monday. A U.S. News article on Tuesday about winter weather conditions incorrectly said subzero temperatures were forecast.

Charter Communications reported consolidated net income of \$1.55 billion in the fourth quarter. A Business & Finance article on Saturday about the company incorrectly said net income was \$1.33 billion.

Readers can alert The Wall Street Journal to any errors in news articles by emailing wsjcontact@wsj.com or by calling 888-410-2667.

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U.S. NEWS

President Signs Measure to End Shutdown

Funding legislation kicks off 10 days of talks over enforcing immigration laws

By Olivia Beavers
And Siobhan Hughes

WASHINGTON—The Republican-led House narrowly passed funding legislation to end a partial government shutdown and kick off 10 days of negotiations over immigration enforcement, after President Trump helped stamp out an intraparty rebellion.

The House voted 217-214 to fund a large portion of the government through the rest of the fiscal year, which ends Sept. 30. The Senate cleared the package last week. Trump, who repeatedly urged lawmakers to back the deal, signed it into law, restoring funding for agencies that had lapsed Saturday.

The legislation provides \$1.2 trillion spread across five spending bills, including the Pentagon and the Health and Human Services Department. It splits off a sixth measure for the Department of Homeland Security, instead funding it through Feb. 13 at current lev-

els. DHS was separated to allow lawmakers more time to negotiate over possible new restrictions on immigration agents demanded by Democrats.

“Republicans got the job done,” House Speaker Mike Johnson (R., La.) told reporters after the vote. He said that completing negotiations over DHS would be vital because the department houses important functions like the Transportation Security Administration and the Federal Emergency Management Agency alongside immigration agents.

Senate Majority Leader John Thune (R., S.D.) cast doubt on the ease of striking a deal. “Maybe things will come together and we’ll be able to vote on something at the end of the two weeks,” he said. “But that would be overly optimistic, based on my experience.”

Most Democrats, including House Minority Leader Hakeem Jeffries of New York, voted against the package Tuesday, as a protest against funding current immigration enforcement policies in DHS. Some said even stopgap funding for immigration enforcement was too much.



President Trump signed the funding legislation on Tuesday after the GOP-led House passed it by a 217-214 vote.

Immigration and Customs Enforcement and Border Patrol interior operations are “out of control,” said Rep. Ted Lieu (D., Calif.), a member of party leadership, who voted against the bill.

Twenty-one Republicans voted against the package, largely including hard-liners

who wanted to use the spending package as a vehicle to tighten election procedures. Meanwhile, twenty-one Democrats—mostly a collection of appropriations committee members and centrists—voted for it.

Headed into the coming negotiations, Democrats want

immigration agents to be required to wear body cameras and carry identification and are seeking higher legal thresholds for arrests and searches. They want an end to roving immigration enforcement patrols. The Democrats also want to ensure that federal agents are held to the same use-of-force policies that apply to other police forces and to be held accountable for violations, including through independent investigations.

“We don’t need promises. We need law,” said Senate Minority Leader Chuck Schumer (D., N.Y.).

Republicans have pushed back on some demands, particularly on what the standard should be for warrants, with some also seeking a crack-down on so-called sanctuary cities, which resist cooperating with some enforcement efforts.

GOP lawmakers also believe that they have a strong bargaining position, given that Trump’s signature 2025 law provided an extra \$75 billion for ICE and \$65 billion for Customs and Border Protection.

“We’ll be able to use that funding,” said Rep. Chip Roy

(R., Texas). If Democrats “want to hold up TSA and FEMA because they don’t want to do the right thing for ICE and Border Patrol, then that’s on them.”

Not all Republicans were pleased with the deal brokered between the White House and Senate Democrats on the revised package, which was sparked late last month after immigration agents killed Alex Pretti in Minneapolis. Instead of simply passing the House’s measure funding the remaining six of the 12 annual appropriations bills, the Senate’s changes meant the package had to go back to the House for approval.

The path for House Republicans this week looked unclear until the Trump administration unlocked the necessary GOP support to move forward with the appropriations bills.

In a procedural rule vote earlier in the day—in which typically the majority party gets no help from the minority party—several Republican members initially voted “no” or withheld their vote. In the end, all but one Republican lawmaker, Rep. Thomas Massie of Kentucky, voted yes, allowing the rule to pass.

States Rush to Remove Legal Shield for Federal Officers

The fatal shootings of Alex Pretti and Renee Good are fueling new efforts to fill a long-standing gap in U.S. law: It is nearly impossible to hold federal agents liable for causing someone’s death.

By Lydia Wheeler,
Valerie Bauerlein
and James Romoser

Federal law has long allowed civil lawsuits seeking damages against state and local government officials, including police officers, for violating someone’s constitutional rights. But that same right to sue doesn’t apply when the alleged wrongdoer is an employee of the federal government.

Legislatures in several states are considering bills that would allow lawsuits under state law that seek to hold federal officials, including those with Immigration and Customs Enforcement, liable for committing civil-rights abuses.

“In our community there’s a lot of despair that there may not ever be accountability for these individuals,” said Minnesota Rep. Jamie Long, a Democrat who started working on legislation after Good was killed by an ICE officer.

Illinois, which faced months of U.S. immigration raids, passed such a law in Decem-

ber and drew a quick lawsuit from the Trump administration, which argues that the measure is an unconstitutional effort to regulate the federal government. The case is pending. The legislation “inevitably will become a vehicle to threaten and harass federal officers” at an already dangerous time for federal law enforcement, the Justice Department said in its lawsuit.

Tricia McLaughlin, a spokeswoman for the Department of Homeland Security, said, “Federal officials acting in the course of their duties are immune from liability under state law. Politicians are laying blame at the feet of law enforcement instead of looking in the mirror at how they have fueled the hatred and violent attacks we are seeing against federal law enforcement officers.”

Other states working on legislation include Colorado, Maryland, New York, Oregon, Rhode Island, Virginia, Washington and Wisconsin. Four states—California, Maine, Massachusetts and New Jersey—previously had legal mechanisms that made it possible to sue any official, state or federal, for constitutional violations, but they have been largely untested against federal officers, lawyers said.

Antonio Romanucci, a Chicago-based lawyer represent-



Photos of Renee Good and Alex Pretti were seen among flowers at a makeshift memorial late last month in the area where Pretti was shot and killed by federal agents in Minneapolis.

ing Good’s family, said he would likely sue the U.S. government for negligence under the Federal Tort Claims Act. That law shields individual federal employees from being held financially responsible for negligence or wrongdoing done in the course of their job, but it does allow suits seeking compensation from government agencies.

Romanucci said the man who shot Good, ICE officer Jonathan Ross, negligently put himself in front of Good’s SUV. “Police officers, whether they’re federal or state, are never to place themselves in ‘officer-created jeopardy,’” he said.

It could be a long road. The Federal Tort Claims Act requires would-be litigants to

file an administrative claim for compensation before going to court. The government would have six months to respond to that claim.

Romanucci said the Good family isn’t deterred. “They want justice,” he said.

Last month, Romanucci demanded that ICE, the Justice Department and the Federal Bureau of Investigation pre-

serve all physical and digital evidence as potential discovery material in a civil lawsuit.

Pretti’s family has hired lawyer Steve Schleicher to represent its interests. He didn’t respond to interview requests. Pretti was killed by Border Patrol agents on Jan. 24 after he was confronted by federal officers while filming them on a Minneapolis street.

For a time, the Supreme Court created a potential pathway to sue federal agents. In a famous 1971 case known as *Bivens*, the court allowed a lawsuit against federal drug agents who entered a man’s house without a warrant and arrested him. But in recent decades, the high court has retreated from that holding, so much so “that it is essentially defunct without them formally overruling the case,” said Michelle Lapointe, legal director at the American Immigration Council.

In about a dozen cases, the justices have thrown out lawsuits against federal officers who were accused of violating constitutional rights. Most recently, the court in 2022 rejected a civil suit against a Border Patrol agent who had shoved an American citizen to the ground during an investigation of human smuggling. Lawyers are still pursuing other test cases they hope will turn the tide.

New York, New Jersey File Suit to Restore Funding for Tunnel

By Alyssa Lukpat

New York and New Jersey sued the Trump administration Tuesday for withholding federal funding for a new \$16 billion rail tunnel under the Hudson River.

The project manager overseeing construction of the Hudson Tunnel Project said last month that it was stopping all work on the project after losing funding. The Trump administration froze funds in October while it reviewed whether the project included any diversity, equity and inclusion policies.

The states alleged in their federal lawsuit, filed in New York’s southern district, that the government was illegally withholding billions in funds already committed to the project. The states are asking the court to order the government to release the funds.

“Donald Trump’s revenge tour on New York threatens to derail one of the most vital infrastructure projects this nation has built in generations, putting thousands of union jobs and billions of dollars in economic benefits in jeopardy and threatening the commutes of 200,000 riders,” said New

York Gov. Kathy Hochul, a Democrat.

The project overseen by the Gateway Development Commission was constructing new tunnels for commuter rail trains to cross the Hudson River between New York and New Jersey. The commission said pausing work would result in the immediate loss of 1,000 jobs while an extended shutdown would put 11,000 construction jobs at risk.

The states said the commission had to use its own funds and available credit to continue funding construction. “But that cannot continue forever,” the lawsuit said.

Contractors were told all work on the project stops Friday unless they got federal funding back, the suit says.

The Gateway Development Commission separately sued the Trump administration this week over the withheld funds.

About \$12 billion in funding for the project comes from federal grants, while roughly \$4 billion comes from federal loans to be repaid by the states and the Port Authority of New York and New Jersey. The Trump administration paused funding from all these sources, the commission said.

Trump Says He Wants \$1 Billion From Harvard

By Gareth Vipers

President Trump said he is seeking \$1 billion in damages from Harvard University, the latest escalation in his administration’s fight with the institution over alleged antisemitism.

Trump posted on social media after the New York Times reported that his administration had dropped its demand for a \$200 million payment to the government to settle the dispute.

“Strongly Antisemitic Harvard University has been feeding a lot of ‘nonsense’ to The Failing New York Times,” Trump wrote on his Truth Social platform overnight Monday into Tuesday. “This case will continue until justice is served,” he added. “We are now seeking One Billion Dollars in damages, and want nothing further to do, into the future, with Harvard University.”

Trump didn’t specify how or when he might seek the \$1 billion. Harvard didn’t respond to requests for comment.

The Ivy League school has been locked in a battle with the Trump administration for months over allegations of an-

tisemitism and concerns about diversity practices. Last year, the government pulled billions of dollars in federal research funds, threatened the school’s tax-exempt status and attacked its ability to enroll international students.

The Times reported Monday that Harvard had rejected the idea of the \$200 million payment because it was wary of backlash from liberal students and faculty. Hours later, Trump criticized the newspaper and Harvard in two Truth Social posts.

Trump has targeted a slate of prominent American universities in a crackdown that has disrupted university operations and raised questions over institutional autonomy. In November, Cornell University agreed to pay \$60 million, following similar deals by Brown and Columbia universities to settle their disputes with the administration.

The feud dates back to Trump’s criticism of Harvard’s handling of pro-Palestinian protests on campus and debates over diversity, equity and inclusion programs.

Rosebud

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U.S. NEWS

Senate Probes Swiss Accounts’ Nazi Links

UBS uses legal fight to curb groups from reopening a deal struck in 1990s

By MARGOT PATRICK

UBS has said it wants to bring greater transparency to Switzerland’s dark chapter helping the Nazis in World War II.

In Brooklyn federal court, UBS has a different message for the Jewish organization that asked for the Credit Suisse probe in 2020, the Simon Wiesenthal Center. Be quiet, and don’t ask us for any more money.

The issue received an airing in Congress on Tuesday when UBS executives, a rabbi from the Simon Wiesenthal Center and an independent investigator delving into archives at UBS’s Credit Suisse unit testified before the Senate Judiciary Committee.

The investigator, Neil Barofsky, told senators his probe has found much deeper ties between Credit Suisse and the Nazi war effort than previously known. These included bank accounts held by the German Foreign Office, which helped in the mass deportation of Jews to concentration camps in the Holocaust. SS, or Schutzstaffel, agents also had accounts at the bank, he said.

In all, he said he found around 890 accounts potentially tied to Nazis.

Barofsky said he found previously unreported examples of Credit Suisse carrying out forced transfers of Jewish clients’ assets into Nazi-affiliated banks. He also found indications that Credit Suisse helped fleeing officials resettle in Argentina after the war.

For decades after World War II, Swiss banks turned away the families of Holocaust victims, saying they had no records of their loved ones’ accounts and assets. Neutral Switzerland denied suggestions it helped to finance the Nazis



Neil Barofsky, at right at table in foreground, testified during a Senate Judiciary Committee hearing in Washington on Tuesday.

and prolonged their terror.

A settlement struck in the late 1990s with UBS and Credit Suisse—resulting in nearly \$1.3 billion in payments—came after years of diplomatic wrangling, and denials by the banks that they were harboring any significant amounts of money for Jewish victims or had done any meaningful business with Nazis.

The settlement compensated bank account holders, slave laborers and others who had assets looted or were refused refuge in Switzerland. The idea was it would draw a line under the Swiss banks’ activities in that era forever.

UBS has voluntarily and extensively cooperated with the Barofsky probe, UBS Americas President Rob Karofsky told senators.

The bank got kudos in recent years for letting a team overseen by Barofsky roam deep into the archives at its Credit Suisse unit, where they discovered accounts tied to the Nazi war machine that weren’t disclosed before the late-1990s legal settlement with Jewish groups.

UBS, however, has refused to share information around Credit Suisse’s legal decision-making at that time, something requested by Barofsky. Before releasing those attorney-client communications, the bank wants assurances that it won’t be sued over what is discovered in the inquiry or that the decades-old settlement gets reopened.

Karofsky and UBS’s chief lawyer, who also appeared, said the settlement was never supposed to relate to all actual claims and covered any activities that later came to light.

Credit Suisse collapsed in March 2023 after a series of scandals and while in poor financial health. UBS rescued it with the backing of the Swiss government. The two banks were Switzerland’s largest, and both absorbed smaller banks in acquisitions following WWII.

In a filing in federal court last week, UBS requested a judge’s order to ban the Simon Wiesenthal Center and other Jewish groups that participated in the settlement from questioning the settlement’s validity.

It asked the judge to make explicit that the settlement disallows any further legal action or additional payments, and to prohibit any of the groups who endorsed it “to cause or promote any public controversy” over the settlement and the Swiss banks’ conduct.

In a letter to the judge, lawyers for the Simon Wiesenthal Center said the sweeping language of UBS’s proposed order would obstruct its First Amendment rights and “its longstanding mission of investigating and bringing to light the full scope of the antisemitic campaign engaged in by the Nazis before, during, and after World War 2.”

Barofsky said the dispute is threatening to derail a full accounting of Credit Suisse’s Nazi ties.

UBS’s Karofsky in his prepared remarks to the Senate said any suggestion that UBS is suing the Simon Wiesenthal Center or attempting to silence it is false. A court hearing on the matter is scheduled for March 12. UBS and the center already underwent two mediation sessions, in Decem-

ber and January.

Barofsky is a former U.S. prosecutor, and is now a partner at law firm Jenner & Block. He was hired by Credit Suisse in 2021 after the Simon Wiesenthal Center found information on possible Nazi clients that hadn’t previously been disclosed. Credit Suisse fired Barofsky in 2022 for overreaching on his mandate, and he was rehired by UBS after it took over in 2023.

UBS has declined to open up its own war-era archives, separate from those of Credit Suisse. UBS previously acknowledged destroying records in the 1990s that might have been relevant. At the time of the record destruction, which was revealed by a night watchman who saw it happening and saved some documents, UBS was under scrutiny for its wartime activities.

Karofsky in his prepared remarks said the current probe’s scope has increased significantly, and beyond what was envisioned. He said the priority now is to complete the review and that UBS will continue to follow the facts.

Trump Steps Up Call to ‘Take Over’ Elections

By KEN THOMAS

WASHINGTON—President Trump doubled down on his view that Republicans should “nationalize” voting in the U.S., questioning whether certain states should continue running their own elections as spelled out in the Constitution.

“I want to see elections be honest, and if a state can’t run an election, I think the people behind me should do something about it,” he said Tuesday.

Trump singled out Detroit, Philadelphia and Atlanta for alleged corruption. “The federal government should get involved,” he said. “These are agents of the federal government to count the vote. If they can’t count the vote legally and honestly, then somebody else should take over.”

Trump’s comments echoed what he said in a podcast interview released Monday with Dan Bongino, his former deputy Federal Bureau of Investigation director, in which he urged Republican officials to “take over” voting procedures in 15 states, which he didn’t name.

Elections are run by state law under the U.S. Constitution, creating a decentralized voting system in which ballots are cast at local precincts.

Democrats have assailed the president’s suggestions of any federal takeover of elections, saying it undermines democratic principles. “Does Donald Trump need a copy of the Constitution? What he’s saying is outlandishly illegal,” said Senate Democratic Leader Chuck Schumer (D., N.Y.).

Senate Majority Leader John Thune (R., S.D.) said, “I’m not in favor of federalizing elections, no. I think that’s a constitutional issue.”

Peltz Aims at Iger Over Company’s Shift

By LAUREN THOMAS AND BEN FRITZ

Nelson Peltz, two years removed from fighting for board seats at **Walt Disney**, threw a fresh zinger at Bob Iger and his CEO succession plan on Tuesday.

In an interview at The Wall Street Journal’s Invest Live event, Peltz questioned the motives behind the selection of parks and cruise-ship head Josh D’Amaro as Iger’s successor. The company chose D’Amaro over entertainment Co-Chairman Dana Walden.

“Iger needs a reason to stay on,” Peltz said. “And if he put the person in charge of entertainment as the CEO, he wouldn’t have an excuse to stay on.”

Iger previously stepped down in 2020 in favor of former parks chairman Bob Chapek. The two men clashed internally over control after the transition and Iger ultimately came back as CEO in 2022.

Peltz, the co-founder and CEO of **Trian Fund Management**, predicted that history would repeat itself and Iger would eventually announce that “Josh doesn’t know anything about the movie business...Therefore, I’m gonna stay on and guide them.”

Representatives for Disney didn’t respond to a request for comment.

D’Amaro will become Disney’s CEO on March 18. Iger

will stay on as a director and senior adviser for the company until his contract expires on Dec. 31.

Disney’s succession process was run by board Chairman James Gorman, who previously helped manage his own succession at Morgan Stanley. Gorman said in an interview that the succession committee considered more than 100 people before homing in on several internal and external candidates.

He said Iger was as involved in the process as other board members not on the succession committee, but his primary role was mentoring internal candidates including D’Amaro and Walden.

Gorman, who wasn’t on Disney’s board during the Chapek era, predicted Iger’s second CEO transition would go more smoothly. “There’s no tension here,” he said. “This will go down well.”

Peltz twice tried to force his way onto the board of Disney and battled Iger over who would take over the entertainment giant. But Disney investors backed Iger and the board, most recently in 2024, rejecting the activist’s concerns.

Triam sold the stock the day after losing the vote in April 2024 and the shares have fallen about 15% since then. Triam no longer has a stake in Disney.

“That’s what happens when you beat us in a proxy fight,” Peltz said.



Josh D’Amaro spent most of his 28 years at Disney working in the theme-parks business.

Disney Taps Parks Chief As CEO

Continued from Page One

D’Amaro is set to take on the top job on March 18 and become a member of the company’s board. Iger is to serve as senior adviser and member of Disney’s board through the end of his contract on Dec. 31.

Gorman told The Wall Street Journal the board picked D’Amaro because of his combination of strategic thinking and understanding of the creative process, as well as his experience working both overseas and in the U.S.

The 54-year-old spent most of his 28 years at Disney working in the theme-parks business in the U.S. and overseas, including stints at California’s Disneyland and Florida’s Walt Disney World. Since 2020, D’Amaro has been chairman of Disney’s experiences unit, which includes theme parks, cruise ships and consumer products.

His rise mirrors the shifting economics of the company, which used to be driven by

profits from television networks. Experiences accounted for 38% of Disney’s revenue in its past fiscal year and 57% of operating income. Disney is spending \$60 billion to grow the theme-parks and cruise businesses in the decade ending in 2033—the biggest such investment in its history.

D’Amaro’s vision for Disney’s future includes giving videogames a bigger role at the company and integrating gaming technology throughout its creative processes, a person familiar with his thinking said. He championed a \$1.5 billion investment in Epic Games in 2024 and has overseen Disney’s relationship with the “Fortnite” maker.

A common criticism of D’Amaro and past CEO candidates who came from the company’s theme-parks and consumer-products businesses is that they lack expertise working with creative talent. Though Disney’s entertainment unit is now smaller than experiences, it creates the characters and stories the attractions and products are based on.

Most of D’Amaro’s experience is in finance and theme-park operations. But since taking over the experiences unit, he has frequently collaborated with colleagues in entertain-

ment and schmoozed with stars at movie premieres and events in the parks.

He has also gotten involved in the primary creative unit that reported to him, Walt Disney Imagineering, by recruiting an experienced leader to reinvigorate the team that designs park attractions and cruise ships.

Still, some at Disney thought Walden, who joined the company in 2019 through its acquisition of most of 21st Century Fox, was a better choice because of her decades working closely with creative talent. She ran Fox’s television studio and network before taking over Disney’s TV business and co-heading streaming.

Disney opted to create a newly elevated role that gives Walden oversight of all of the company’s movies and streaming series, making her one of Hollywood’s most powerful content executives.

Both executives were awarded multimillion-dollar bonuses to stay with the company on top of new contracts. D’Amaro would be paid a salary of \$2.5 million with target annual bonuses of \$32.5 million, according to an offer letter described in a public filing.

In addition, Disney recommended to the board of directors’ compensation committee

that D’Amaro receive a one-time bonus with a target value of \$9.7 million.

Walden’s new employment agreement calls for her to receive a \$3.75 million salary with annual target bonuses of \$23.25 million. The target value of her recommended retention bonus is \$5.26 million.

Working with Walden to turn streaming into a more robust business is one of several tasks already on D’Amaro’s plate. Attendance at Disney’s parks has been roughly flat for the past two years, with growth coming in large part from price increases.

Creating new stories that become hit franchises might be the biggest challenge for D’Amaro, people close to the company said.

Onetime hit factories like Marvel and Star Wars producer Lucasfilm have become inconsistent at the box office and on streaming, and Disney has struggled to launch original franchises in the past several years.

However, the company has continued to pump out massively successful sequels and remakes including last year’s “Zootopia 2” and “Lilo & Stitch,” as well as fresh seasons of hit TV shows like “Only Murders in the Building” and “The Bear.”



Nelson Peltz said at the WSJ’s Invest Live event Tuesday that Walt Disney CEO Bob Iger ‘needs a reason to stay on.’

U.S. NEWS

Clintons Avoid Contempt Vote, Will Testify in Epstein Probe

By ANVEE BHUTANI

WASHINGTON—Former President Bill Clinton and former Secretary of State Hillary Clinton reached a deal Tuesday to appear for depositions later this month in the House investigation into Jeffrey Epstein, avoiding a contempt-of-Congress vote in the House.

The videotaped and transcribed in-person depositions are scheduled for Feb. 26 for Hillary Clinton and Feb. 27 for Bill Clinton. The Clintons’ lawyers made the offer after House Oversight and Government Reform Committee Chair James Comer (R., Ky.) insisted Monday that any depositions

be conducted on video.

In a letter sent to Comer, attorneys for the Clintons requested that the hearings be public, citing concerns about fairness and transparency. It wasn’t immediately clear how Comer would respond to the request. Rep. Robert Garcia of California, the top Democrat on the Oversight Committee, told reporters Tuesday he supported public hearings.

“At the 11th hour, James Comer asked for a camera, that’s fine,” Clinton spokesman Nick Merrill wrote Tuesday afternoon on X. “He can have 1,000 cameras. The Clintons will do this publicly.”

The Clintons have said they

had no personal knowledge of Epstein’s criminal activities. Bill Clinton has said he flew on the disgraced financier’s private jet for foundation work but has said he never visited Epstein’s private island. Their lawyers have argued the House panel’s subpoenas lack a legitimate legislative purpose and are intended to embarrass the former president and secretary of state, both Democrats.

The deal Tuesday has halted a looming contempt vote against both Clintons, after the Oversight Committee voted last month to advance the measures, with several Democrats joining Republicans—particularly on the vote

concerning Bill Clinton.

Democrats have accused Comer and other Republicans of selectively targeting the Clintons while failing to aggressively pursue President Trump’s ties to Epstein. Trump and Epstein socialized in the 1990s and early 2000s when they were neighbors in Palm Beach, Fla.; Trump has said he cut off ties well before Epstein’s 2006 arrest.

Files released by the Justice Department have included photographs of Bill Clinton and references to his past interactions with Epstein, though being mentioned in the files isn’t an indication of wrongdoing.



Bill Clinton and Hillary Clinton, shown at a funeral in 2025, will each appear for a deposition later this month.

When asked Tuesday about the House bringing in the Clintons to testify, Trump responded: “I think it’s a shame.” He added: “I hate to see it in many ways.”

While rare, contempt prosecutions have resulted in jail time in recent years. Trump

advisers Steve Bannon and Peter Navarro served prison sentences after being convicted of contempt of Congress for refusing to cooperate with the House investigation into the Jan. 6, 2021, attack on the Capitol by a mob of Trump supporters.

U.S. WATCH



PINSCH ME, I WON: Penny, a Doberman pinscher, won best in show at the Westminster Dog Show at New York City’s Madison Square Garden on Tuesday. This was the 150th annual show.

AI Worries Spur Selloff In Software

Continued from Page One

ware, shed around 167 points, or 0.3%. The selling Tuesday wasn’t particularly widespread—five of the S&P 500’s 11 sectors closed higher.

PayPal, Expedia, EPAM Systems, Equifax and Intuit were among the hardest hit, all also dropping more than 10%.

“If things are advancing as rapidly as we hear from OpenAI and Anthropic, it’s going to be a problem. Investors are starting to go after any of the companies that could be disrupted, which is all kinds of software application names,” said Art Hogan, chief market strategist at B. Riley Wealth Management.

For weeks, Silicon Valley insiders and software engineers raved about the capabilities of Anthropic’s AI model, Claude, and especially its ability to take over desktops and complete coding projects relatively autonomously. While other AI models and tools have similar capabilities, millions of people are now discovering them and using them to write software, do data analysis and complete other tasks.

Software companies are defending their businesses, noting that writing code is often the easiest part of building a platform based on trust and the individual data and information. But investor jitters have persisted.

Even before Tuesday’s drop,

software and service was S&P Dow Jones Indices’s worst performing subsector this year.

Private-funds firms, whose funds in recent years have invested heavily in software equity and debt, were also dragged into the selloff. Shares of Ares Management, KKR and Blue Owl Capital dropped more than 9%, while Apollo Global Management and Blackstone lost more than 4.5%.

Private-equity managers snapped up software companies, often borrowing money from private-debt funds to pay for the buyouts. The flurry of deals left software as a significant slice of their investment portfolios.

Software was supposed to “eat the world,” as tech investor Marc Andreessen once predicted. Until recently, the industry’s growth made for profitable investments; now, with the industry under pressure from AI, some of those software holdings have drawn scrutiny.

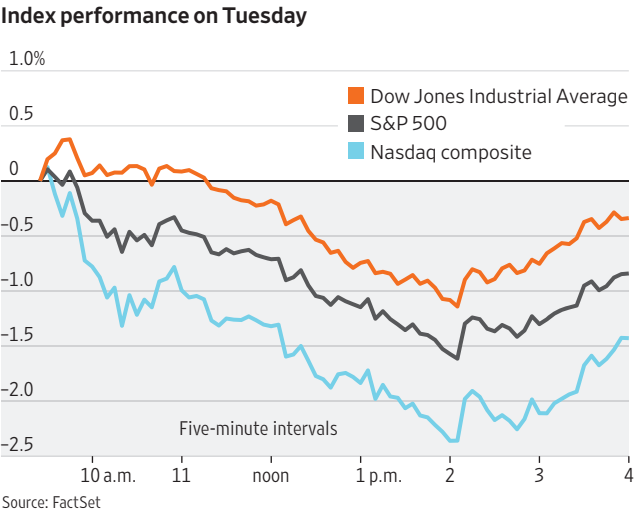
“I don’t view this as a private credit or liquidity issue,” Jon Gray, Blackstone’s presi-

dent and chief operating officer, said at WSJ Invest Live on Tuesday. “It’s the change happening in the economy. You could be an incumbent software company that’s the system of record and maybe you face risk from AI disrupters.”

Gray said the private-credit industry is healthy despite issues with a handful of specific investments recently. But investing in the software sector now comes with “disruption risk,” because of the accelerating pace of change brought by AI and other advancements.

Software now accounts for about 20% of investments in business development companies, a booming type of private-credit fund. That compares to around 10% in 2016, according to research by Barclays.

Blue Owl, in particular, became an evangelist for “recurring-revenue” lending. The firm and others bet that corporate clients would be unlikely to end “sticky” software contracts because of the difficulties involved with changing technology systems.



Traders have questioned whether artificial intelligence will chip away at the competitive protection built by software makers like Salesforce. Its shares fell 6.9% on Tuesday, part of the day’s selloff that hit stocks such as PayPal, Intuit, Expedia, Equifax and Epam Systems.



WASHINGTON, D.C. Ex-Fed Official Gets Mixed Verdict

A former Federal Reserve official was found not guilty Tuesday of conspiring to share confidential central-bank information with Chinese intelligence officers.

After a day of deliberations, a jury acquitted John Rogers, a 64-year-old former senior adviser in the Fed’s division of international finance, of the most serious charge he was facing.

Jurors did convict him of a lesser charge of lying to investigators when, in a 2020 interview with the Fed’s internal-watchdog office, he denied sharing sensitive information.

During a two-week trial, federal prosecutors said Rogers used his role at the Fed to access restricted materials—including economic forecasts—and conveyed that information to Chinese intelligence officers posing as academics.

His sentencing is scheduled for late May, where he faces a maximum of five years in prison.

—C. Ryan Barber

SPACE NASA Moon Trip Delayed Again

NASA’s long-awaited moon shot with astronauts is off until at least March because of hydrogen fuel leaks that marred the dress rehearsal of its giant new rocket.

It is the same problem that delayed the Space Launch System rocket’s debut three years ago. That first test flight was grounded for months because of leaking hydrogen.

NASA announced the news Tuesday, shortly after the critical fueling test ended at Kennedy Space Center. Until the hydrogen leaks, the space agency had been targeting as soon as this weekend for humanity’s first trip to the moon in more than half a century.

“As always, safety remains our top priority,” NASA administrator Jared Isaacman said via X.

Officials said the month-long delay will allow the launch team to conduct another fueling test before committing the four astronauts—three U.S. and one Canadian—to a lunar fly-around.

—Associated Press

NEW YORK Legal Observers to Monitor ICE Action

New York’s attorney general announced plans Tuesday to deploy legal observers to monitor federal immigration enforcement actions in the state.

The initiative will send observers, who will wear purple safety vests, to areas of reported immigration enforcement activity to collect information “that may inform future legal action,” Attorney General Letitia James said.

Tensions remain high nationwide over President Trump’s aggressive immigration crackdown, particularly following the shooting deaths of two U.S. citizens at the hands of federal agents in Minnesota. Videos

“We have seen in Minnesota how quickly and tragically federal operations can escalate in the absence of transparency and accountability,” James said.

James said her office’s observers will serve as “neutral witnesses” who will identify violations of law, but won’t interfere with enforcement activity.

—Associated Press



SPLENDOR IN SCARLET RAYMOND YARD RUBY RING

Renowned jeweler. Untreated treasure. Coveted color.

A superb example of Art Deco style, this Raymond Yard ring presents an untreated 2.25-carat ruby, a rarity as nearly all rubies undergo heat treatment. Set in platinum with accent diamonds, the gem reflects Yard’s exceptional skill in selecting the finest stones. AGL-certified. #32-1117



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WORLD NEWS

Iran Moves Not Seen Derailing Talks

Gunboats tried to stop a tanker and a drone flew close to U.S. aircraft carrier

For a few hours on Tuesday, two Iranian provocations against the U.S. raised questions as to whether nuclear talks between Tehran and Washington could be derailed. But negotiations are still ex-

By Lara Seligman, Benoit Faucon and Jared Malsin

pected this week, U.S. officials said, keeping diplomacy on the table even as President Trump amasses a large military force and issues repeated threats against Iran.

The U.S. shot down an Iranian drone aimed at the aircraft carrier USS Abraham Lincoln, and a U.S.-flagged ship outran an attempt by armed Iranian gunboats to force it to stop, spiking tensions in the Persian Gulf.

But back in Washington, White House press secretary Karoline Leavitt told reporters that U.S.-Iran talks are “still scheduled.” U.S. special envoy Steve Witkoff and Trump son-in-law Jared Kushner had been scheduled to attend a meeting with Iranians on Friday in Turkey, people familiar with the matter said. Trump, also speaking about Iran, added “they are negotiating, they’d like to do something, and we’ll see if something is going to be done.”

The comments signaled that, despite the flare-up, a diplomatic path remains for the U.S. and Iran to reach a deal over Tehran’s nuclear work, ballistic-missile program and support for regional proxies Hamas and Hezbollah. But that wasn’t guaranteed, as Iranian officials threatened to pull out negotiations while some U.S. officials said Trump considered walking away from the talks because of Iran’s ag-



A handout photo shows an F-35C fighter on the USS Abraham Lincoln that was targeted Tuesday.

gressive actions.

It wasn’t clear why Iran decided to adopt a more aggressive posture when the U.S. is piling up air power, warships and missile defenses in the Middle East.

Sanam Vakil, director of the Middle East and North Africa program at Chatham House in London, said the incidents could mean that hard-line factions in Iran’s leadership aren’t on board with the talks.

“When they are under attack, all political sides in the regime work together,” Vakil said. “When there is a mediation, they sabotage each other.”

The risk, she said, is Trump could lose patience and carry out a strike. The president has repeatedly warned that Iran risks being attacked if it doesn’t do a deal to give up its nuclear program.

Tuesday’s incidents began as the Lincoln was sailing about 500 miles from Iran’s southern coast. An Iranian Shahed-139 drone appeared and “unnecessarily maneuvered toward the ship,” said



Source: MarineTraffic

Capt. Tim Hawkins, spokesman for the U.S. Central Command, which oversees the Middle East.

The drone continued flying toward the carrier even after U.S. forces took de-escalatory measures, Hawkins said without specifying the steps. An F-35C fighter from the Lincoln then shot down the drone, he said.

Hours later, two Islamic

Revolutionary Guard Corps boats and an airborne Iranian Mohajer drone sped toward a U.S.-flagged tanker, the Stena Imperative, radioing threats to board and seize the ship, Hawkins said.

A U.S. destroyer with air support escorted the tanker to safety, he said. Iran sent another drone to surveil the Lincoln later Tuesday, but it kept its distance and wasn’t a con-

cern, a person familiar with the matter said.

None of the incidents caused any damage or injuries. Hard-liners, however, are taking a risk by gambling that the U.S. might not be resolved to deliver a heavy blow, said Saeid Golkar, associate professor at the University of Tennessee at Chattanooga and an expert on Iran’s security services.

“It’s the usual bullying tactics,” Golkar said. “But if you light up a matchbox, you end up being burned.”

On the diplomatic front, Iran has backed away from talks in Turkey and is pushing to move the venue for the talks to Oman, people familiar with the matter said. It is also pushing for a total overhaul of their format, rejecting plans for a wider discussion that was to have covered U.S. concerns about the country’s ballistic-missile program and support for regional militant groups Hezbollah and Hamas, the people said.

Iranian officials have long insisted publicly that they would only discuss the nuclear issue. But before the latest objections there had been an understanding that the meeting in Turkey would pursue the fuller range of issues, likely on separate tracks.

The administration has insisted on concessions not only on uranium enrichment, but also on ballistic missiles and support for militias.

Regional powers had worked to set up the talks in Turkey in hopes of opening a diplomatic pathway to avert a possible war. It isn’t clear whether a meeting will go ahead or where.

“It’s consistent with Iranian negotiating techniques to cede a point and then try to reclaim it later,” said Alan Eyre, a former senior U.S. diplomat and nuclear negotiator with Iran. “That happened all the time in the nuclear negotiations.”

Poland Arrests Official on Spy Charge

By Karolina Jeznach

WARSAW—Polish authorities arrested a Defense Ministry official on Tuesday for allegedly spying on behalf of Russia and Belarus, officials said, in one of the highest-profile espionage cases to come to light inside the Polish government.

The accused 60-year-old official worked in the division of strategy and planning, a ministry official familiar with the case said. It was unclear how he had allegedly aided Russia’s and Belarus’s intelligence agencies, which have carried out hybrid warfare and sabotage activities on Polish soil since the start of the Ukraine war.

Poland emerged early in the war as an ardent supporter of Ukraine. The country still provides the biggest channel through which Western military aid reaches Ukraine. Russia has worked to undermine the transport of that aid.

The official had been under military counterintelligence surveillance for an extended period as a case was built against him, said special-services spokesman Jacek Dobrzynski. If found guilty, the man may face up to life in prison for treason.

Dobrzynski added that most of those arrested for working with Russia’s intelligence agencies were Russian, Ukrainian or Belarusian, but that Poles have increasingly been arrested, too.

Another Pole, a 50-year-old resident of the border town of Hrubieszow, on Tuesday received a sentence of three years and six months for passing on information about Jasionka-Rzeszow Airport to Russian intelligence to help with an assassination plot against Ukrainian President Volodymyr Zelensky, Ukrainian officials said. The plot was foiled in 2024.

Russia Resumes Strikes On Ukrainian Energy Sites

By Anastasia Malenko

Russia launched its biggest aerial assault of the year on Ukraine, ending a pause on strikes on Ukraine’s energy systems and dealing another blow to the country during some of the winter’s coldest days.

President Trump said he asked Russian President Vladimir Putin to hold off on strikes for a week because of the frigid temperatures. Russia continued its nightly barrages on Ukraine—including strikes on transportation infrastructure—but Moscow appeared to refrain for several days from direct assaults on energy.

That ended on Tuesday. Russian forces attacked eight Ukrainian regions, striking thermal power plants providing heat for residents of the capital of Kyiv and other cities such as Kharkiv and Dnipro, the energy ministry said.

The attack left nearly 2,000 apartment buildings without heat in Kyiv and Kharkiv, with the temperatures dropping to 13 degrees below zero Fahrenheit. The strikes, which injured at least 12 people, left authorities in several cities scrambling to drain water from radiators in some buildings to prevent damage to heating systems.

Ukrainian President Volodymyr Zelensky said Kyiv would continue to support de-escalatory steps ahead of talks between the U.S., Russia and Ukraine, which are set to resume on Wednesday in Abu Dhabi. The strikes on Tuesday, he said, were an indication of Moscow’s unwillingness to engage in the peace process.

“Each such Russian strike confirms that attitudes in Moscow have not changed: They continue to bet on war and the destruction of Ukraine, and they do not take diplomacy seriously,” Zelensky wrote on X, urging the timely delivery of air-defense missiles from allies.

Trump initially said Thursday that Putin agreed to hold off on strikes for a week. Asked Tuesday during an Oval Office event about the latest attacks, Trump said: “It was



A thermal power plant was damaged during a recent Russian attack on an undisclosed location in Ukraine.

Sunday to Sunday...he kept his word on that. It’s a lot. One week is...we’ll take anything because it’s really, really cold over there.”

On Friday, Kremlin spokesman Dmitry Peskov confirmed that Moscow agreed to stop its strikes until Feb. 1. When asked on Monday whether the energy cease-fire remained in place, he said he had no further details to share.

Zelensky said the energy cease-fire began in practice on Friday and ended on Tuesday, adding that Moscow broke its promise in Kyiv’s view.

“That is, either Russia now believes that there are less than four days in a week instead of seven, or they are really betting on war, and only that, and simply waited for the coldest days of this winter,” Zelensky said Tuesday.

Sen. Lindsey Graham (R., S.C.), one of Ukraine’s supporters in Congress, urged Trump to put more pressure on Russia following Tuesday’s attack. “After this massive attack last night, I would urge President Trump to start a process to provide Ukraine with Tomahawk missiles which would be a game changer militarily. In the coming days and weeks, we must apply more pressure to Putin,” Graham said in a post on X.

The Ukrainian air force said it downed 412 of 450 drones

and 38 of 71 missiles launched by Russian forces in Tuesday’s attack. The Russian ministry of defense said it struck energy facilities that were supporting Ukraine’s military.

Even though Russia appeared to pause strikes on energy sites in recent days, it continued the nightly barrages on Ukraine’s cities. The strikes hit Ukrainian railroads Friday, and killed 12 miners who were on a bus coming from a mine on Sunday, according to DTEK, Ukraine’s largest private energy company.

“They delayed the strike, increased the number of missiles and drones, and struck on the coldest days,” Zelensky said, adding that 43 missiles launched overnight could be intercepted only by the Patriot air-defense system.

NATO Secretary-General Mark Rutte arrived Tuesday morning in Ukraine as the Russian attack continued. He visited one of the damaged plants, and said Russia sought to cripple the Ukrainian energy infrastructure with the latest strike.

Ukraine needs more interceptors for its air-defense systems, Rutte said. “We are urgently working to ensure that more is delivered as quickly as possible. I continue to work with allies, urging them to dig deep in their stockpiles, knowing how pressing is the need.”

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WORLD NEWS

India’s Strategy Won Tariff Reprieve

New Delhi pressed trade deals that bolstered its hand in talks with the U.S.

By Tripti Lahiri

When Canadian Prime Minister Mark Carney declared at Davos that middle powers should deepen their economic ties to navigate the era of great-power politics, India was already showing how it was done. After President Trump imposed 50% tariffs on India’s exports to the U.S., among the highest in the world last year, New Delhi powered ahead on trade deals with other economies, strengthening its hand in negotiations with the U.S. On Monday, the approach appeared to pay off: Trump said he was cutting tariffs on Indian products to 18%. India’s strategy gives middle powers a potential playbook for resisting pressure from major economies, on trade and security. In addition to making

deals with the U.K. and the European Union, and scheduling trade talks with Canada, India ignored insults from the White House and offered extra concessions to bring Washington back to the table. On the U.S. side, Trump dispatched his close aide Sergio Gor as ambassador to India in January, which some political experts saw as a chance to reset U.S.-India relations. In July, New Delhi thought it was on the brink of a U.S. trade deal, but by the end of the month, the Trump administration said India hadn’t done enough to lower trade barriers, and singled it out among buyers of Russian oil. Trump accused India of indirectly funding Russia’s war machine and punished it with 25% tariffs on top of 25% reciprocal tariffs. The levies, which took effect in August, contributed to more uncertainty about the risks of investing in India, leading to billions of dollars of institutional investor funds flowing away from the country in 2025, and driving down

the value of the rupee. Although government spending and tax cuts to stimulate spending have helped support India’s economic growth recently, they didn’t offer a long-term solution. India’s path to reaching an accord with the U.S. involved quiet diplomacy, while making a big deal of the agreements it signed elsewhere. Indian Prime Minister Narendra Modi didn’t rise to comments from White House aides, who called Russia’s invasion of Ukraine “Modi’s war,” and derided India as the “Kremlin’s laundromat” for buying Russian oil. That stoicism allowed Trump to say the two remained friends and kept lines of communication open. India also offered significant concessions, including allowing private investment in nuclear energy. On Sunday, New Delhi announced a tax break for AI data centers that promises to be a boon for U.S. tech giants. But perhaps most significant of all, India inspired a touch of FOMO, or fear of



Indian Prime Minister Narendra Modi used quiet diplomacy to reach an accord with the U.S.

missing out, at the White House by pursuing trade deals with competitors for the vast Indian consumer market. Last week, India and the EU agreed to what they described as the “mother of all deals.” India offered big cuts to levies on European alcohol, and said it would lower tariffs on a quota of European cars to 10% over time, from as high as 110% now. Also worrisome for the U.S. was a fast rapprochement between India and Canada. In 2023, Canada alleged Indian authorities were tied to an ex-

trajudicial killing on its territory, a charge India denied. Now the countries are speeding toward a trade pact. Modi has stayed quiet as Trump has asserted that India won’t buy any more Russian oil, allowing the U.S. president to frame the drop in tariffs against Indian goods as an American victory. New Delhi didn’t respond to requests for comment on whether India has agreed to curtail its Russian oil purchases; the Kremlin said Tuesday it hadn’t received such a message.

Trying to replace Russian oil wholly with U.S. supplies would be difficult and expensive for Indian refineries, energy analysts say. But the fact that India has made significant reductions—and is seen to continue to do so—might be sufficient to satisfy the White House, trade experts say. Analysts are skeptical India can buy hundreds of billion dollars worth of energy, agricultural products and other goods from the U.S.—as Trump said Monday—unless it is given a decade or more to reach that goal.

Taiwan Bolsters Partnership With U.S. Despite Tensions

By Joyu Wang

TAIPEI—Many of the U.S.’s longtime trade and security partners, contending with a new era of uncertain relations, have looked to hedge their reliance on Washington, in some cases warming up to Beijing. For Taiwan, as with other security partners in Asia, giving up on the U.S. isn’t an option. Taiwan’s president pledged on Tuesday to double down on trade and security ties in a speech that clearly staked out what it means to count on the U.S. and be wary of China. Taiwan is committed to deepening its economic and strategic ties to Washington, with a focus on artificial intel-

ligence, drones, critical minerals and supply chains that exclude China, Taiwan’s President Lai Ching-te said. Lai’s comments followed economic discussions in Washington last week that he described as “of great significance to Taiwan-U.S. relations,” a partnership that could be one of “mutually beneficial prosperity.” While President Trump’s tariffs have tested Taiwan, as they have with other trading partners, tensions eased in January with an agreement to lower tariffs in exchange for investment to boost U.S. production of semiconductors. Many U.S. trade partners are considering deeper trade ties with Beijing—though even

North Atlantic Treaty Organization countries that pushed back against Trump’s bid to control Greenland still count on the U.S. for security, exports and technology. In Asia, U.S. partners are carving their own paths when possible. Japan’s Prime Minister Sanae Takaichi has made reducing reliance on China for essential parts and raw materials a cornerstone of her economic policy—while preparing investments to cement Japanese strengths in industries

such as semiconductor technology, an effort aimed in part at ensuring Japan is economically indispensable to the U.S. Tokyo is also hedging its economic bets by building alliances with the European Union, Australia and others, remaining committed to multilateralism and free trade, which the U.S. under Trump now rejects. South Korea, whose relationship with the U.S. is fundamental to national security, has had rough spots with Washington—primarily when

hundreds of South Koreans were detained in an immigration raid at a Hyundai Motor plant in Georgia in September. But President Lee Jae Myung has praised Trump and repeatedly asked for Washington’s help to restart dialogue with North Korea—while Lee has also looked to boost economic cooperation with China, South Korea’s largest trading partner. The prevailing view in Taiwan is that the island’s military would struggle against an invasion by China’s much larger armed forces, and that only with U.S. help could the island be kept out of Beijing’s hands. China, which claims the democratic, self-ruled island as its own territory, has

threatened to use force to seize it. In mid-December, Trump seemed to answer concerns that he could give China a pass, as his administration approved \$11.1 billion in arms sales for Taiwan. The U.S.-Taiwan tariff deal in January reinforced Taiwan’s confidence. Opposition lawmakers in Taiwan have stalled approval of the Lai administration’s proposed defense budget, which includes the latest U.S.-approved weapons purchases. As Lai spoke, a delegation from Taiwan’s main opposition party, the Nationalist Party, or Kuomintang, was across the Taiwan Strait in Beijing for meetings with Chinese Communist Party officials.

Many U.S. trade partners are considering deeper trade ties with China.

WORLD WATCH



COLORFUL DISPLAY: Celebrants honor the Virgin of Candelaria and Saint Blaise of Sebaste in Almonacid del Marquesado, Spain.

FRANCE
Prosecutors Seek Le Pen Office Ban
Prosecutors at a key appeals trial in Paris on Tuesday requested a five-year ban on far-right leader Marine Le Pen holding an elected office, an outcome that may prevent her from running in the 2027 presidential election. Le Pen, 57, is seeking to overturn a March 2025 ruling that found her guilty of misusing European Parliament funds in the hiring of aides from 2004 to 2016. Prosecutors accused Le Pen of being at the head of a system meant to siphon off EU public funds to the benefit of her party. The appeal trial, involving Le Pen, 10 other defendants and the National Rally party as a legal entity, is scheduled to last until next week. “I never expect a pleasant surprise when I set foot in a courtroom,” Le Pen said Tuesday. —Associated Press

UNITED KINGDOM
Mandelson Faces Criminal Probe
Police on Tuesday opened a criminal investigation into politician Peter Mandelson over alleged misconduct related to his ties to Jeffrey Epstein. The government says newly released Epstein files include documents that suggest Mandelson may have shared market-sensitive information with the convicted sex offender while Mandelson was a member of government a decade and a half ago. The Metropolitan Police force said detectives had reviewed reports of misconduct and decided they met the threshold for a full investigation. The Speaker of the Lords, Michael Forsyth, said Mandelson informed officials he will retire from the House of Lords, Parliament’s upper chamber, effective Wednesday. —Associated Press

NORWAY
Royal Son Pleads Not Guilty to Rape
The son of Norway’s crown princess pleaded not guilty to rape charges as he went on trial of Tuesday for multiple alleged offenses. Marius Borg Høiby, 29, is the eldest son of Crown Princess Mette-Marit from a previous relationship and the stepson of the heir to the throne, Crown Prince Haakon. Høiby pleaded not guilty to the most serious of 38 counts against him, including the four counts of rape. The charges also include abuse in a close relationship, acts of violence and transporting 7.7 pounds of marijuana. Others include making death threats. Høiby pleaded guilty to several driving offenses, to an aggravated drugs offense and breaking a restraining order, and “partly” to threats and aggravated assault. —Associated Press

GAZA STRIP
Palestinians Wait At Egypt Border
Palestinians gathered on Tuesday on both sides of Gaza’s border with Egypt, hoping to get through the Rafah crossing after its reopening on Monday was marred by delays and uncertainty. On the Egyptian side were Palestinians who had fled to Egypt and undergone medical treatment there, Egypt’s state-run Al-Qahera News television reported. On the Gaza side, Palestinians in need of treatment unavailable there were brought in buses by the Palestinian Red Crescent from the agency’s headquarters in the territory, hoping for word that they would be allowed to cross. On Monday, it took more than 10 hours for only about a dozen returnees and a small group of medical evacuees to cross in each direction. —Associated Press

Greenlanders Reject American Ties in Poll

By Alexander Ward and Robbie Gramer

WASHINGTON—A new poll shows 76% of Greenlanders say they wouldn’t benefit from becoming part of the U.S., noting their concerns about exchanging the Danish welfare system for American healthcare, eldercare and education. Only 3% of Greenlanders had a “very positive” view of U.S. government-provided benefits, while 59% held a mainly or very negative view of it, the poll shows. The U.S. has some of the highest healthcare costs in the world. Sune Steffen Hansen, a Danish pollster who designed and conducted the survey, said the findings make clear Greenlanders are broadly satisfied being part of the Danish kingdom and even expect their circumstances to get better under their current political arrangement. “That’s a hard deal for the U.S.,” he said. President Trump’s campaign hasn’t only turned citizens more sharply against the U.S., but has also prompted Greenlanders to seek closer ties with the European Union. Trump’s Greenland aims have triggered an extraordinary crisis with one of its closest historic allies and undermined European countries’ faith in the U.S. as a reliable ally, several senior European officials said. The poll of 610 Greenlanders aged 18 or older took place Jan. 16-28, when Trump and members of his administration escalated their rhetoric about potentially using military force to seize the world’s largest island. On Jan. 21, Trump and Mark Rutte, secretary-general of the North Atlantic Treaty Organization, agreed to set up a diplomatic framework for the U.S., Denmark and Greenland to begin negotiations while Washington dropped its military threats. All sides met last week to discuss how to allay U.S. concerns over Arctic security

without crossing Denmark’s red lines on Greenland’s sovereignty, Danish officials said. Trump’s late January decision to avoid the use of force didn’t affect the survey results, Steffen Hansen said. “There was a consistency throughout the process and the results. It is not like people changed their minds overnight.” The greatest impact on attitudes was the full-throated U.S. campaign to acquire Greenland, a territory of about 57,000 people, by any means necessary, he continued. “America wanted to get close to Greenland, but instead they pushed them away.” U.S. intelligence agencies have stepped up their efforts to better understand Greenlanders and their political attitudes. The Trump administration is also weighing direct cash payments to island residents to change their views, U.S. officials said. Such efforts face an uphill battle. Given a choice between strengthening Greenland’s cooperation and relationship with the EU or the U.S., 65% of respondents chose the European bloc and only 5% said the U.S. Meanwhile, 51% of Greenlanders said splitting from Denmark would result in a weaker economy on the island, with 62% of respondents adding that they wouldn’t like to leave the kingdom and become independent now. In the long term, 52% of people said Greenland could be independent without any other country having decisive military or political influence over the island. Greenlanders were interviewed online and over the telephone for the poll, which has a margin of error of 4%. Steffen Hansen said he didn’t receive government funding for the poll. The Copenhagen Post, a Danish newspaper, covered Steffen Hansen’s expenses in exchange for two stories based on the survey’s results, he said. A Pew Research poll published Jan. 29 showed 58% of U.S. adults opposed an American takeover of Greenland.

WORLD NEWS

Argentines Pressed to Stop Hiding Dollars

Milei needs the U.S. currency long kept in secret places for free-market revamp

By Samantha Pearson
And Silvina Frydlewsky

BUENOS AIRES—Argentina’s libertarian leader, Javier Milei, has won over President Trump and wooed global investors. Now he must persuade crisis-weary Argentines to stop hoarding their U.S. dollars.

From greenbacks stuffed into children’s teddy bears to fortunes tucked away in the ceiling, Argentines have more than \$250 billion in dollars stashed at home, along with offshore accounts and safe-deposit boxes—some six times the reserves of the central bank.

But two years into Milei’s term, Argentines are easing their grip on their dollars. Dollars held in the country’s banks by private-sector investors hit a record in late 2025 of nearly \$37 billion, up 160% since Milei took office in December 2023, show central-bank data.

Along the leafy boulevards of Buenos Aires, optimism is rising as the government softens financial controls, encouraging Argentines to plow previously undeclared cash into everything from cars to real estate.

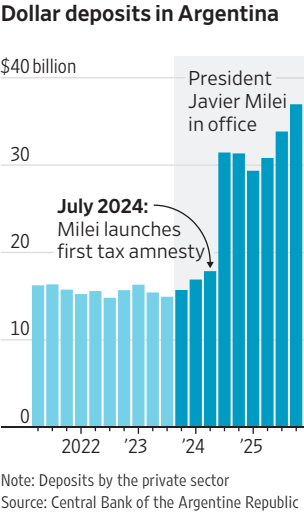
“Customers are getting bolder, there is less need to hide things,” said Fabian Luciani, a car salesman. More than half of his clients pay in cash, he said, sometimes with dollars that families say have been buried in their backyards for years.

Keeping dollars “under the mattress” has long been a national ritual after wild swings in the peso, bank freezes and other capital controls destroyed Argentines’ trust in the banks over the decades.

“I hid it in a chair, inside the metal tube of the chair leg,” said Héctor Orsenigo, who like many here takes pride in his ingenuity. “Everyone has their own little hiding place.”



Auto salesman Fabian Luciani says more than half of the clients in his Buenos Aires business pay in cash.



architect and real-estate developer in Buenos Aires. The amnesty allowed the owners to sell the house and bring the cash to Argentina to invest in one of Keselman’s apartment complexes, he said.

Keselman expects the government’s latest law to lure even more cash into the real-estate market, adding that it is easier to persuade jittery savers to invest in something they can see and touch.

The opening up of Argentina’s nascent mortgage market is also expected to boost sales.

Argentina has announced dozens of tax amnesties over the years, only for the rules to be reversed by subsequent governments, which sometimes chase down Argentines for the assets and cash they just declared. But Milei’s latest law promises to bring more extensive changes, said Truffa, citing rules that shift the burden to tax authorities to prove wrongdoing rather than requiring savers to prove their innocence. “People are starting to say, ‘Hey, maybe this time really is different.’ ”

Others are less optimistic. Argentines are too traumatized to change their habits soon, said Gustavo Lazzari, an economist and owner of a small meat processor. “That memory is passed down, from parents and grandparents.”

Uncovering Parents’ Cash Stash Was Exhilarating

Many Argentines remember the exhilarating moment when they stumbled upon their parents’ secret hiding place. “One day we lifted the cover of the window blind and saw a bag stuck there,” said Patricia Fernández, a public-sector employee. “My dad said, ‘No! Don’t touch that! That’s mine!’ ”

Others are still discover-

ing dollars in family heirlooms left by long-deceased relatives.

In Buenos Aires, the steel-enforced vault of Ingot, a company that rents out safe-deposit boxes, serves as a bellwether for confidence in the government. Business boomed in the past decade amid widespread distrust in the banks,

said Juan Piantoni, the company’s chief executive. Now, Ingot predicts as much as a 15% decline in business this year. The company is doing its best to persuade Argentines to store other items in its boxes. “Maybe someone has a former girlfriend and keeps letters or photos,” he said. “It’s just not appropriate for it to be in the house.”

While working at a bank earlier in his career, Truffa said a flood nearly destroyed the contents of his basement’s safe-deposit boxes, forcing staff to use hair dryers to dry millions of dollars in cash—money whose owners still refused to declare or deposit it into accounts.

But Milei is taking on the taxman. Congress passed a law in December to raise the thresholds for tax evasion, allowing Argentines to use as much as \$70,000 in some cases without declaring the origin of the cash. Previously, they risked prosecution for using more than \$1,000.

While it will take months to put the law into practice, a similar tax amnesty under Milei in 2024 coaxed about \$24 billion back into the financial system and led Argentines to declare roughly 55,000 properties, official figures show.

One of those was a house in Uruguay that belonged to a client of Gerardo Keselman, an

He started hoarding dollars soon after Argentina’s 2001 financial collapse, when the government froze bank deposits and blocked cash withdrawals. The measure wiped out families’ life savings, sparking protests.

Getting these “mattress dollars” back in the banks would be a boon for Milei and his ef-

forts to overhaul South America’s second-biggest economy after Brazil. With more dollars available, lenders could expand loans and export credit, boosting growth and easing some of the pain from the government’s austerity measures.

“Deposit your dollars in the bank...as in any other part of

the world!” Argentina’s economy minister, Luis Caputo, recently urged citizens.

Unearthing cash has in the past been risky, opening families to prosecution for the tax they didn’t pay. Some would rather risk losing it, said Juan Truffa, director of consulting firm Outlier.

DOYLE



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President Petro and President Trump discussed counternarcotics efforts at the White House.

Trump, Colombian Leader Signal Detente After Talk

By Vera Bergengruen
And Juan Forero

WASHINGTON—Just last month, President Trump was floating military action against Colombia to curb cocaine flows and blasting President Gustavo Petro as a “sick man.” On Tuesday, the two held a private meeting that capped a remarkable reversal, with the leaders exchanging gifts and signaling a detente.

Petro, who has blasted Trump as a fascist “complicit in genocide,” left the White House grinning with a red MAGA hat in hand and an autographed copy of “The Art of the Deal.”

“He and I weren’t exactly the best of friends, but I wasn’t insulted because I’d never met him,” Trump said after the meeting, noting they discussed counternarcotics efforts and other issues. “I thought he was terrific.”

U.S. and Colombian officials, who worked behind the scenes to engineer a reset with one of Washington’s most important security partners, appeared to breathe a sigh of relief. The sit-down could reset relations after the countries’ bombastic leaders spent a year trading personal insults and feuding over counternarcoticscotics,

trade, and deportations.

In an unusual break from the usual choreography of visits by foreign leaders, the White House didn’t open the Oval Office sit-down to the press, and skipped the greetings and joint remarks.

“I think this is a small step, but it eases the risk of a great human conflagration,” Petro said after the meeting. While they spoke about “concrete problems and possible paths forward,” neither of them changed their “way of thinking on many issues,” he said. He also said took a pen and added an “S” to the hat gifted by Trump so it said: “Make Americas Great Again.”

Colombian officials said they hoped to show Trump and administration officials another side to Petro—that of a what they characterized as a tireless fighter against the cocaine trade. Many experts on the drug trade say Colombia’s record seizures is a result of there simply being more cocaine than ever before.

Trump has threatened military action against Colombia and wielded tariffs, aid cuts, and other penalties against Petro, whom he has called an “illegal drug leader” with a “fresh mouth.” Petro has said Trump is a threat to humanity, and urged U.S. troops to disobey his orders.

Moments after the meeting, Petro posted a photo of him smiling and shaking hands with a grinning Trump. A note from Trump read: “Gustavo—a great honor—I love Colombia.”

The Colombian leader presented Trump with coffee produced by farmers who have given up growing drug crops.

If the meeting went well behind closed doors, that is good for both countries, said Todd Robinson, who served as the U.S. assistant secretary of state for international narcotics and law enforcement affairs at the State Department until January. “The U.S. needs Colombia if we are going to be serious about fighting crime and insecurity in the hemisphere.”

‘Gustavo—a great honor—I love Colombia,’ read a note from Trump.

FROM PAGE ONE

The Aide Stoking Trump

Continued from Page One
early information.

Not long after Miller’s tweet, Trump posted the photo of the gun on his own social-media post, saying the weapon was loaded and ready to go. “What is that all about?” Trump wrote.

Video footage soon contradicted Miller’s portrayal of Pretti and marked a rare setback for the singularly powerful White House adviser who has shaped many of the president’s most incendiary impulses. Miller has been an architect in almost every boundary-pushing effort in Trump’s second term, according to White House officials familiar with the matter, including immigration sweeps in U.S. cities and the deadly boat strikes in the Caribbean.

When protests spread in Minneapolis, Miller raised the idea of the president invoking the Insurrection Act to send in military troops, a possibility that Trump later voiced publicly, according to White House officials familiar with the matter.

After immigration agents fatally shot Renee Good in early January, senior officials from the White House and Department of Homeland Security discussed whether to continue the operation in Minneapolis, according to officials familiar with the discussions. Miller said even more officers should be deployed, a White House official said, both to continue raids and protect agents conducting them. Miller reminded the president of their original goal in the city: an immigration crackdown related to welfare fraud by Somali migrants.

Miller, a 40-year-old from historically progressive Santa Monica, Calif., has been by Trump’s side through thick and thin since 2016, earning the president’s trust in part by proving that an aggressive approach to curbing illegal immigration would be a political winner.

Miller has repeatedly said that bad people have poured into the U.S. and the administration should respond with aggressive enforcement. He confronts aides who bring up legal checks that might hinder his pursuit and dismisses concerns over public reaction to the administration’s most far-reaching measures, White House officials said.

After agents detained two U.S. citizens working at a Target store in Minneapolis, Miller defended the actions, a White House official said, while other aides grimaced at the widely shared videos.

Miller was influential in Trump’s first term, but his power has expanded in the second one. He personally drafted or edited every executive order the president signed, and faced little opposition from administration officials to his work to reshape immigration policy. Miller helped come up with the idea



Above, White House deputy chief of staff Stephen Miller arriving in Zurich, Switzerland; Miller during a TV interview, below.



FROM TOP: JONATHAN ERNST/REUTERS; KEVIN DIECKHOFF/GETTY IMAGES

vino to lead enforcement operations in the Democratic cities of Minneapolis, Los Angeles and Chicago. Bovino, who reported directly to Noem, became the face of the administration’s immigration crackdown. His militarized enforcement and clashes with protesters ignited a public backlash that endangered ICE officers, some DHS officials said privately. Bovino has since returned to his duties in California.

During Trump’s first year in office, ICE had deported 475,000 migrants living illegally, surpassing Obama’s 2014 total but well short of the administration’s goal, according to an agency official with access to the data. DHS has said there were 675,000 deportations and claimed, without evidence, that 2.2 million people have self-deported.

Expansive portfolio

Miller is known for working longer hours than most anyone at the White House. His office is on the second floor of the West Wing, but he usually floats around the first floor, including the Oval Office. He often speaks in sentences that can seem to stretch for minutes, asking rhetorical questions designed to persuade colleagues to see matters his way. Miller rarely leaves a written trail of his orders, using Signal, an encrypted voice and text-messaging app, to communicate.

Unlike most of his colleagues, Miller has Secret Service protection. He moved his family to a military base after protests outside his Arlington, Va., home. He asked officials at the FBI and Justice Department to investigate protesters, including people who posted his home address online, administration officials said.

Early in Trump’s second term, Miller amassed power in his own homeland security council and outfoxed others with his command of the workings of government, according to White House advisers. His authority, officials said, derives from his ability to manage the president.

He often uses gory images to persuade Trump. After a Department of Government Efficiency staffer, Edward Coristine, also known as “Big Balls,” was beaten in an attempted carjacking last summer, Miller brought the president a large photo of the bloodied man and told him that crime in Washington was climbing. Trump soon posted the photo himself on social media, and deployed the National Guard, saying it was needed to make the city safe.

Days after the Pretti shooting, Miller’s spot in Trump’s orbit appeared unchanged. Miller and his wife were at the exclusive Executive Branch, a private club in Washington affiliated with Trump family members, following the screening of the Melania Trump documentary.

The performer Akon took the stage, attendees said, and Miller worked the room.

This weekend, Miller milled about with the president and cabinet members during the wedding of another top White House aide at Trump’s Mar-a-Lago club in Palm Beach, Fla.

to blow up drug boats, officials said, and to deport migrants to a prison in El Salvador using the wartime Alien Enemies Act, an action now under court challenge.

Senior administration officials credit Miller with increasing cooperation with the Federal Bureau of Investigation and other law-enforcement agencies to the immigration effort, as well as pushing the State Department to force countries to take back immigrants. White House officials who defend Miller say his work as homeland security adviser requires his involvement in a range of the president’s priorities.

Kristi Noem, the homeland security secretary, echoed Miller’s description of Pretti and has told others that Miller directs major decisions at her department, a characterization a White House official disputed. Noem said she runs DHS.

“There’s no question Stephen has been a linchpin in President Trump’s historic success to secure the border and more than 3 million illegal aliens exiting the country,” Noem said in a statement.

“Stephen brings together all corners of the government to ensure every single policy, both foreign and domestic, is implemented at record speed.

The results over the course of the past year speak for themselves,” said White House press secretary Karoline Leavitt.

‘Amateur hour’

In recent weeks, more Republicans have openly questioned Trump’s immigration strategy and its chief architect. North Carolina Republican Sen. Thom Tillis said Trump should fire Miller and Noem, citing their characterization of Pretti as a terrorist. “That is amateur hour at its worst,” he said, adding, “Stephen Miller never fails to live up to my expectations of incompetence.”

Cracks have appeared even in the Oval Office. The president, aware of polls showing that much of his immigration agenda isn’t popular, has told advisers he wasn’t comfortable with how far Miller has gone on some fronts, according to people who have spoken with Trump. The president has said that business officials are calling and complaining to him about longtime workers being deported.

After Miller described Pretti as a terrorist and would-be assassin in the hours following the Jan. 24 shooting, Leavitt said at a news briefing that she spoke only for the

president, who hadn’t made any such claims. Miller told colleagues he was frustrated by the coverage of the whole episode.

Yet Trump allies recognize the lasting power of Miller, who was in Trump’s inner circle for all three of his presidential campaigns. In 2024, while other advisers wanted Trump to center his White House bid on the economy, Miller pushed for immigration.

Early in Trump’s second term, Miller told federal agents in a meeting at the headquarters of Immigration and Customs Enforcement that the president was disappointed in their numbers. Miller urged the agents to “just go out there and arrest illegal aliens,” without bothering with targeted lists, according to people familiar with the meeting.

Miller’s comments marked the start of a more aggressive enforcement campaign focused on progressive, Democratic Party-led cities. Since the shift, masked and heavily armed federal agents have detained some U.S. citizens and

President Trump’s allies recognize the lasting power of Stephen Miller.

people with legal status in broad immigration sweeps, and, in Minneapolis and elsewhere, drawn street protests and violent confrontations.

While leading daily homeland security-related calls with administration officials, Miller, who frequently stressed the first-year goal of one million deportations, pushed officials to ramp up their numbers, said people familiar with the calls. He demanded 3,000 arrests a day—a number deemed unrealistic by many federal agents—and came up with the idea of offering recruitment bonuses as high as \$50,000 for new ICE agents.

Miller pushed for sweeps at Home Depot and other spots where day workers gather, though Trump has at times been asked to temper raids at businesses. Following immigration arrests in September by federal agents at a Hyundai Motor factory in Georgia, Republican Gov. Brian Kemp called the president and asked for the release of 300 South Korean workers, according to administration officials. The president publicly said he opposed the raid and told Kemp privately that he didn’t know it was happening. He told aides repeatedly that he didn’t want any more sweeps at factories or farms, officials said.

Even after Trump signaled his displeasure, Miller continued to argue for large raids, according to people familiar with the discussions. He wanted the administration to surpass the 400,000 deportations tallied in 2014 under former President Barack Obama.

The administration’s immigration push is split between the sweeping measures in line with Miller’s view, and the belief of Tom Homan, Trump’s border czar and Todd Lyons, the ICE director—that agents should target immigrants with criminal histories or final deportation orders.

Noem elevated Border Patrol Commander Gregory Bo-

Super Bowl Host Gets Snubbed

Continued from Page One
at Levi’s, San Francisco reaped 57% of the estimated \$240 million in related spending, a study found. San Jose got 12%. Santa Clara, where Levi’s actually is located, got 7%.

Bob Staedler, a land-use consultant and civic booster, likens San Jose to Charlie Brown, running to kick a football only to have his nemesis Lucy pull it away.

“It feels like another Charlie Brown-with-the-football moment,” said Staedler.

No one here disputes San Francisco is more famous. Even San Jose’s largest employer, Cisco Systems, uses a likeness of the Golden Gate Bridge in its logo. San Francisco is full of attractions including cable cars, Fisherman’s Wharf and the Transamerica Pyramid.

San Francisco has a much larger convention center and far more hotel rooms, which organizers say is why it’s hosting so many events. Those

include the Pro Bowl Games, a Super Bowl innovation summit, an NFL awards show and a raft of concerts by superstars including Sting, Post Malone and Green Day.

San Jose got one sanctioned event—Super Bowl Opening Night.

Mayor Matt Mahan opted to not get mad, but get even. He helped raise \$5 million from businesses to field a competing roster of events, including a three-day block party, watch parties, drone shows and sold-out performances by the R&B singer Kehlani and DJ Dom Dolla.

The players will be close by: the Seattle Seahawks are practicing at San Jose State University while the New England Patriots are at Stanford University in Palo Alto.

“We can complain all we want, but I think we have approached this year differently,” Mahan said.

San Joseans have long lived in San Francisco’s shadow. In the 1960s, Tony Bennett was crooning “I Left My Heart in San Francisco” with the city’s population nearing 800,000 while Dionne Warwick was singing “Do You Know the Way to San Jose?” about a city about half that size.

San Jose caught fire as the



Sunday’s game will be played at Levi’s Stadium in Santa Clara.

KIRBY LEE/REUTERS

capital of Silicon Valley and grew to surpass San Francisco. Boosters started touting selling points such as better weather than their fog-locked neighbor. San Jose gets about 300 days of sun a year.

“People in San Jose wake up and they look at the weather and they say, ‘How warm is it going to be?’ People in San Francisco wake up and say, ‘How cold is the weather going to be?’” real-estate developer Michael Van Every said as he led a walking tour of the redeveloped Willow Glen district.

He and other boosters want

the world to discover San Jose’s attractions. One is the Winchester Mystery House, a 160-room mansion the widow of the Winchester rifle company founder kept expanding reportedly to appease spirits of the gun’s victims.

And while San Francisco has the famous California Academy of Sciences, San Jose boasts the Rosicrucian Egyptian Museum, with mummies and a robot version of Thoth, ancient “Keeper of the Mysteries.”

“It’s kind of odd, but interesting,” said Staedler as he led a driving tour. He slowed his Jaguar SUV to admire the

Westfield Valley Fair mall, with stores like Bloomingdale’s. “They have really fun escape rooms,” he said.

Cameron Ladd, though, said he can’t list the attractions in his hometown without feeling outdone. “There’s Communications Hill featuring a tower that’s part of the history of Silicon Valley,” the speech-recognition linguist said. But unlike San Francisco’s Coit Tower, “this one is an ugly eyesore.”

When the NFL announced a return to Levi’s in 2023, the Bay Area was named as Super Bowl LX host. Mahan flew to New Orleans to accept the football in the handoff ceremony from last year’s game. NFL commissioner Roger Goodell singled out San Francisco in his remarks.

“There’s such a great history in San Francisco and we’re thrilled to be a part of that next year,” he said.

The emphasis on San Francisco-based activities since has left some with a bad taste. “I do feel we aren’t seen as prestigious when you’re down

there,” said Crystal Lequang, whose Amazée Events was among the San Jose area businesses left out.

Mahan predicts that with San Jose’s trajectory the roles may reverse. “Give it 50 years and it will be the San Jose Bay Area,” he said, half joking.

An NFL spokesman said the whole region is involved in Super Bowl events, including an official watch party in Oakland. “We’re excited to spotlight the Bay Area on a global stage,” said Peter O’Reilly, the NFL executive vice president who oversees events.

San Francisco Mayor Daniel Lurie, who headed the Bay Area’s 2016 Super Bowl host committee, said the hundreds of thousands of visitors would benefit everyone.

San Jose officials hope to use the Super Bowl as a springboard for other sporting events, including the FIFA World Cup which also will have games at Levi’s. The plan is to focus on San Jose, not anywhere else, said Tommy O’Hare, the city’s new sports and special events director.

“We haven’t tried to compare ourselves to San Francisco,” said O’Hare, a former Olympic short-track speed skater. “That’s the wrong approach.”



PERSONAL
TECHNOLOGY
NICOLE
NGUYEN

A massive multiday power outage hit my San Francisco neighborhood in December. There were dark streets, stalled robotaxis, even discarded dough from local bakeries bursting from trash bins. My family coped fine, but I know we need to be more prepared for next time.

The number of Californians affected by planned power shut-offs due to wildfire risk and other events jumped 145% last year, compared with 2024, according to data from the California Public Utilities Commission. Meanwhile, winter storms in the Eastern U.S. have left people without power for days in freezing temperatures.

Everyone can benefit from backup power in the event of an outage. But just 14% of American households own a generator, according to 2024 research from Oberlin College.

“The question is: Do you need a larger backup because you have more vulnerabilities?” said Marrielle Mango, a senior project director at Clean Energy Group. If you have medical needs, such as a CPAP machine or refrigerated insulin, it’s an easy decision.

Gas generators, the traditional option, are noisy, high maintenance and smelly. They also emit toxic fumes, so they aren’t an option for apartment dwellers like me. Batteries, which are gaining in size and dropping in price, are quiet and don’t require upkeep. You can bring the smallest power stations where you need them, while larger ones live next to your main electrical panel and take over the whole house when needed.

You might not be able to set up your ideal backup power system before the next storm, but this guide will help you plan for the long term.

Essentials only

Think of a portable power station as a huge phone brick, one big enough to keep your milk from spoiling. You charge it when you have power, then when there’s an outage, you can plug in essential appliances. They’re also useful for camping or running a projector in the backyard. Heavier, higher-capacity batteries have wheels and can weigh upward of 25 pounds.

Depending on how much power you need and for how long, you could spend as little as a hundred dollars—or well into the thousands.

In this category, reputable brands include EcoFlow, Anker and Jackery. When shopping, pay attention to these three specs:

► **Rip the Band-Aid off and just do it.** “Like the reader asking the question, my wife and I traveled extensively pre-kids and wanted to share it with them, but I was terrified to fly with kids. We had a family wedding when my oldest was 6 months old that forced us to fly. It went so much better than I thought and opened the doors to having the confidence to travel more. Now my 5-year-old and 2-year-old have both flown to Europe twice, the Caribbean, and several places in the U.S. Just go into the trip with the expectation that there will be some tears and challenges but knowing that you face those same issues at home. Make sure you bring plenty of entertainment options, so they don’t get bored. Also know that many other travelers have kids or grandkids and are gracious and understanding.”

—Foster Hyde, Alabama

► **Start small and local.** “As a military spouse whose wife traveled



A Home Battery Backup Will Help in Next Outage

Generators are noisy, smelly and high-maintenance. Battery-powered backups can keep fridges on for days, without the upkeep.



◀ **Some power stations such as Anker’s C2000 can be expanded with extra battery packs.**

► **Capacity:** Watt-hour (Wh) refers to the battery’s size, or how long it will last. They go from a few hundred Wh for a few appliances to several thousand

Wh to cover a whole home. (Remember, 1,000 Wh = 1 kWh.)

► **Output:** The watts (W) tell you what kind of appliances you can

run. If your water kettle is 1,500 watts, you would need a battery that’s rated for at least 1,500-watt output.

► **‘Peak,’ ‘surge’ or ‘boost’ wattage:** This is the max output a battery can temporarily reach. Certain appliances, like your fridge, need more power to start up. A 2,000-watt battery might be capable of a 3,000-watt peak.

Battery chemistry is also important. If you want a battery that won’t wear down as quickly over time, look for lithium-iron-phosphate batteries (also called LFP or LiFePO4). These are the same types found in electric vehicles. Cheaper

batteries tend to be made using the more standard lithium-ion.

You’ll also need to estimate your power needs. Jackery has a handy wattage calculator tool. EcoFlow’s 256Wh River 2 (\$189) can cover laptops and mini fridges. Larger appliances demand more expensive batteries.

As I tallied up my in-case-of-emergency list, the watts—and cost—added up quickly.

► **Wi-Fi router:** 15W

► **Fridge:** 100-200W, with an initial 1,000W surge

► **Space heater:** 750W

► **Water kettle:** up to 1,500W

The total? At least 2,500 watts. Anker’s C2000 (\$799) would power those essential electronics for a couple of hours. By adding an expansion battery (\$599), I could comfortably eke out a few more.

I pondered ways to scale back on energy usage, by swapping the space heater for 60-watt electric blankets, for instance. I could also skip the kettle for ramen and tea, but that’s a lot to ask.

Also, it’s easy to forget that your Wi-Fi router is plugged into a mo-

◀ **A power station can be plugged into a home’s electrical panel to provide whole-home power.**



Tips When Traveling With Young Children

By Dawn Gilbertson

The following items first appeared in Dawn Gilbertson’s weekly Travel newsletter.

I asked for your travel tips for a frequent-flying dad with infant twins and you came through. Here are some of my favorites:

► **Rip the Band-Aid off and just do it.** “Like the reader asking the question, my wife and I traveled extensively pre-kids and wanted to share it with them, but I was terrified to fly with kids. We had a family wedding when my oldest was 6 months old that forced us to fly. It went so much better than I thought and opened the doors to having the confidence to travel more. Now my 5-year-old and 2-year-old have both flown to Europe twice, the Caribbean, and several places in the U.S. Just go into the trip with the expectation that there will be some tears and challenges but knowing that you face those same issues at home. Make sure you bring plenty of entertainment options, so they don’t get bored. Also know that many other travelers have kids or grandkids and are gracious and understanding.”

—Foster Hyde, Alabama

► **Start small and local.** “As a military spouse whose wife traveled

and was deployed for up to a year at a time and handled many family moves, traveling with kids can be daunting. You can’t anticipate everything. Like anything, it requires practice. Go to a baseball game/camping/state park lodge. It will be hectic. Building on those experiences should give you not only confidence but great joy at being a family, a husband and a father.”

—Rich Arnold, Ohio

► **Accept that babies cry.** “As a frequent flier and former flight attendant, I say he can do it. If the babies cry, do not feel bad about it. That’s what babies do. I never once felt irritated by a baby crying. If other passengers are irked, too bad. Most flight attendants will be helpful. They can see parents that might be nervous. I’d also recommend a shorter trip first. We went to Kansas City from Chicago with our 2-and-½-year-old and baby in his carrier. Our kids really traveled well as they grew up, and were able to fly by themselves as young teenagers, too.”

—Sharon Staudt, New Hampshire

► **Suck it up and rely on the kindness of strangers.** “I’m a father of now 27-year-old twins. When mine were toddlers, I was also a very frequent business flier. It’s a 180-degree different experience with



► **Traveling with kids in tow is often not easy, many parents say.**

young twins or any kids for that matter. Prioritize the trips you take each year to see family and maybe one getaway vacation. My kids adapted pretty quickly and became excellent travelers by the time they were 7 or 8. Above all, fight through the hard parts and don’t let the fear of what might happen dissuade you from getting out there.”

—Michael O’Connell, Washington

► **Be a human AirTag.** “Count your bags after every stopping point. Arrival, security, eating at a random gate, etc. Keeping track of all your

inanimate objects is exponentially more difficult when you’re tracking a miniature human being. You don’t want to sprint across terminals because you left your diaper bag under a chair.”

—Randy Spoon, Virginia

► **Stay calm.** “I’m a mom of four, close in age, all grown now. The first tip that came to mind was dealing with airport security. I tried very hard to always keep a calm presence and not worry about being in such a frenzied hurry. The kids will feed off your energy. If you are calm, they will be calm. Remember that lots of folks in line have been in your shoes, they give more grace than you think. I always

◀ **A late-December blackout in San Francisco affected about 130,000 residents, the power company said.**

dem, usually in some corner of the house. Rather than use your portable power station, try an uninterruptible power supply (UPS) box. Designed to keep desktop PCs going briefly after an outage occurs, these chunky power strips can keep a modem running for hours.

The whole house

Portable power stations are easy, but you need to plug everything into them yourself. A whole-home battery can simplify a backup, automatically providing juice to all of your outlets during an outage. It also might be the key to keeping your heat on: A gas heating system often has electrical controls wired into your home’s main circuitry.

Whole-home backups require professional installation and can be a multi-thousand-dollar investment. A popular go-to model, Tesla’s 13.5 kWh Powerwall, can cost over \$15,000 including labor and last more than a decade.

But you can save thousands by opting for a manual (rather than automatic) switch and stacking several batteries that you then plug into your electrical panel, said Pete Tims, owner of Quantice Solar, an alternative-energy electrical services provider in Virginia.

For a recent client, Tims installed an EcoFlow Delta Pro Ultra plus expansion battery (12.2 kWh) for \$7,500 total. Scaled-down options cost even less.

To decide your budget, assess how long your region’s outages typically last. “Do you want to spend tens of thousands for a single dayslong outlier? Or have a system to get you through 8 hours, and that’s good enough?” Tims said.

Then, check your utility bill for your typical needs. My household’s daily usage ranges from 5 to 12 kWh. An average three-bedroom, two-bathroom home with a two-car garage typically needs an 8 kWh system, Tims said.

What about cooling? Air conditioners need a huge burst of power to turn on. Only the highest-end batteries or portable systems are equipped to handle the load. Even still, during an outage, you’ll want to use AC sparingly, as it can drain batteries quickly.

You might already own a massive battery that can power your home: an EV. You can reverse the power flow in some models, including the Ford F-150 Lightning, Chevy Silverado EV, Tesla Cybertruck and coming Rivian R2.

Tims recently installed a transfer switch and a bidirectional EV charger for a customer to use a Cybertruck, equivalent to more than six Powerwalls. It cost \$7,000, not including the vehicle’s price.

For my own apartment, I’m starting with a 2 kWh portable battery for \$800. There’s no installation required, and I can add expansion packs over time if needed.

During the next outage, you’ll find me with my family, under an electric blanket, sipping hot tea.

want to jump in and help families but worry they will think I’m some crazy lady.”

—Bethany Reid, Ohio

► **Ice cream and a siesta.** “Plan a daily treat the kids can anticipate and a break for everyone to rest and recharge. This has served me well from toddlers to late teens. We now have coffee or cocktails in a cafe while we rest our feet or zone out on our phones in the hotel for an hour before starting our evening plans. It’s just as valuable for parents to reset their energy during the stress of travel.”

—Joel Mitchell, Texas

One good tip

Heads up if you take the train to Newark, N.J.: The AirTrain service from the airport train station will be unavailable from 5 a.m. to 3 p.m. Monday through Friday due to long-planned construction of a new AirTrain. Passengers will be shuttled to terminals by bus. The trip takes 15 to 45 minutes but the airport advises allowing up to 60 minutes.

Travel math: 20%

The decline in visitors to Vail Resorts mountains this ski season, largely due to little snow in the West.

To subscribe to Dawn’s Friday newsletter, go to [wsj.com/newsletters](https://www.wsj.com/newsletters).

FROM TOP: CARLOS BARRIA/REUTERS; ANKER; PETE TIMS

GIORGIO VIERA/ARPI/GETTY IMAGES

PERSONAL JOURNAL.

By **KELLY CLOONAN**
AND **HEATHER HADDON**

One of the restaurant industry’s hottest new ideas is a paper cup filled with chunks of chicken.

Chipotle Mexican Grill introduced the cups recently as part of a new menu centered on protein. Restaurant chains are pumping the nutrient into everything from pizza crust to coffee, while stepping up marketing of the new offerings to users of weight-loss drugs and fitness buffs.

Papa John’s is testing protein-infused dough, and Subway is selling what it calls “protein pockets”—tortillas with meat and veggies. Beverage chains like Dunkin’ and **Starbucks** are offering high-protein milk options for their lattes, tapping celebrities like reality star Khloé Kardashian and musician Megan Thee Stallion as spokeswomen.

Shake Shack recently introduced a menu of lettuce-wrapped burgers for consumers seeking to cut out the buns with their protein fix. “We’re selling way more of these than I ever thought we would,” Chief Executive Rob Lynch said.

Restaurant companies are responding to consumers’ protein craze, fueled in part by the rise of GLP-1s. Those on the drugs are instructed to increase their protein intake to minimize muscle loss. They also tend to opt for healthier options when eating out, according to market-research firm Circana.

The Trump administration’s Make America Healthy Again movement also has pushed protein. New dietary guidelines urge Americans to prioritize the nutrient at every meal and consume 1.2 to 1.6 grams of it daily for every kilogram of body weight, up from a prior recommendation of 0.8 grams.

Some consumers say fitness and health advice on social media have contributed to the trend.

Alyssa Zarou, an insurance agent on Long Island, said TikTok videos encouraged her to incorporate cottage cheese, known for its high protein content, into her diet.

“It was not something that I ever really ate, and then it became this craze on TikTok,” the 31-year-old said. “It’s way healthier than

Americans Obsess Over Protein

Restaurants are adding the nutrient to more of their offerings, including pizza crust and coffee



what I used to be eating for breakfast.”

Others also point to the growth of gym culture, which has long prioritized protein intake for building muscle.

“The gym is getting a lot of traction on TikTok,” said Omar Lopez, a server in Southern California.

Lopez said it has been easier to find high-protein meals on the go recently. He tried Subway’s protein pockets and now expects to buy them once a week.

“I feel like a lot of places are now starting to get on the wave. They realize that people are on

their fitness journeys and they want to reach their protein goals,” the 25-year-old said.

Chains are hoping protein can help lure more diners. Restaurant traffic declined 1.9% last year as consumers pulled back on eating out, many put off by high prices, according to market-research firm Black Box Intelligence.

“Restaurants are all fighting for traffic,” Deutsche Bank analyst Lauren Silberman said. “Every single company is looking to do protein, no matter what company it is, what things they sell.”

Restaurants tend to charge

Beverage chains like Dunkin’ are selling drinks with high-protein milks and cold foam.

more for extra helpings of meat, and can price innovations, like Starbucks’s protein cold foam at around \$2, at a premium. In some cases, the new offerings are just existing menu items remarketed to focus on protein, posing a low-risk way of driving traffic, analysts said.

“You could always get double chicken or triple chicken if you wanted to pay for it, but now there’s more messaging around it,” William Blair analyst Sharon Zackfia said.

At **Portillo’s**, “we are educating consumers about all the protein on the menu,” Chief Financial Offi-

cer Michelle Hook said. Hook pointed to the chain’s Beef Bowls of its meat and gravy, which allow consumers to “skip the grains and get all the gains.”

Chains also are hammering home the value of their protein offerings to price-conscious consumers.

Jersey Mike’s sells all of the ingredients stacked high on its sandwiches in a bowl without the bread. “It’s a very abundant offering for a great price,” CEO Charlie Morrison said.

Chipotle’s chicken cup goes for around \$3.82, while the steak version averages at \$5.62. Subway recommends its franchisees charge about \$3.99 for its protein pockets.

Starbucks was early to the trend, introducing a line of protein-infused lattes and cold foams in the fall. While awareness is still low among customers, the offerings are driving traffic and bringing some customers back for more, CEO Brian Niccol said during a recent call with analysts. “It is one of those examples of being very much on trend with how people want to eat and drink,” he said. Niccol, for his part, started his day with a vanilla protein latte, he said.

Ethan Pugh, a musician in New York City, said he has been willing to try all the new protein offerings.

“I am easily swayed by things that could be benefiting me in my workout journey,” the 27-year-old said. He tried Starbucks’ protein cold foam, he said, and would consider ordering it again even though it didn’t sit right with his stomach.

“Honestly, I might still throw it on there, just to feel like I’m getting that protein intake,” he said.

Analysts said it was unclear whether the focus on protein will continue in the long term.

“It’s certainly a trend right now. We’ll see if it lasts,” Deutsche Bank’s Silberman said. “I don’t think it is necessary to market a bowl of chicken as protein forever.”

Set Up Your Home to Age in Place

By **VERONICA DAGHER**
AND **ELIZAVETA GALKINA**

Preventing a Fall

Most Americans want to grow old in their own homes, and some spend tens of thousands of dollars transforming their spaces for their later years.

But modifying your home doesn’t require a huge renovation or budget.

There are ways to keep costs down by prioritizing changes that target two of the biggest challenges people face as they get older: preventing a fall and getting around after a hospital stay.

Here are some relatively inexpensive suggestions:

Falls, which frequently occur at home, often lead to hospitalizations and are the primary driver of mobility loss among older adults.

Small changes, such as removing throw rugs and using color contrast tape to mark edges of furniture and stairs, can significantly reduce the risk of falls, says Carol Chiang, an occupational therapist who owns Evolving Homes, which consults on home modifications.

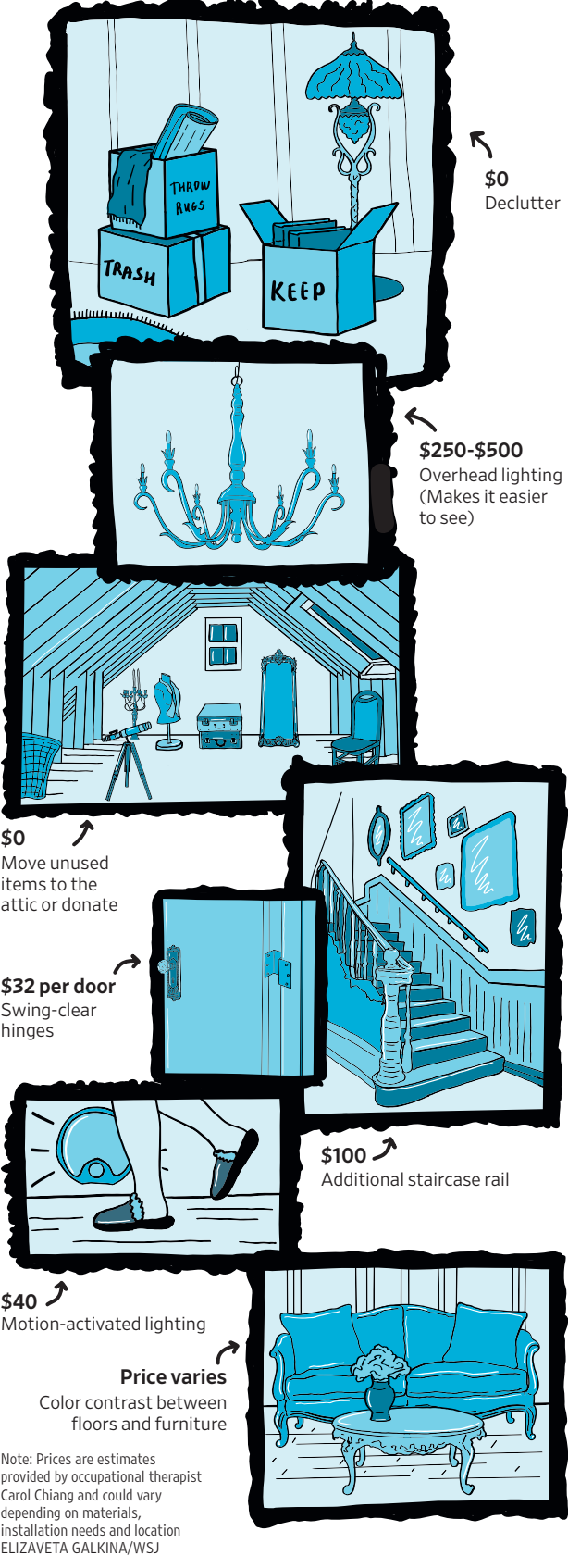
She also suggests installing offset hinges, which allow doors to swing completely clear of the frame to widen walking paths.

These steps improve visibility and open up space to allow safe, independent movement and can be done for about \$1,000 and in under a month (especially if you do it yourself), she said.

Another challenge is getting around your home after a hospital stay.

Chiang suggests targeting frequently used spaces such as the bathroom and bedroom for a more comfortable daily routine. This can reduce the energy required for basic tasks.

By spending a single weekend on simple modifications—such as installing a shower hose and seat—you can proactively make your return-to-home easier for any future hospital stays, she said.



\$0
Declutter

\$250-\$500
Overhead lighting
(Makes it easier to see)

\$0
Move unused items to the attic or donate

\$32 per door
Swing-clear hinges

\$100
Additional staircase rail

\$40
Motion-activated lighting

Price varies
Color contrast between floors and furniture

Note: Prices are estimates provided by occupational therapist Carol Chiang and could vary depending on materials, installation needs and location
ELIZAVETA GALKINA/WSJ

The WSJ Daily Crossword | Edited by Mike Shenk

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SQUARE MEALS | By Jared Cappel

Across

- 1 Like a virgin
- 7 “___ Boy” (song by the Who)
- 10 Flap
- 13 Topping the Scoville scale
- 15 Went around
- 17 Paced aggressively
- 18 Manhunt target
- 19 “A Woman Under the Influence” star Rowlands
- 20 Bank nos.
- 22 Prunes
- 23 The Band bassist Rick
- 25 Party figure, briefly
- 27 Mirabel’s older sister in “Encanto”
- 29 Thick soup noodle
- 31 Some movie ratings

- 34 With
- 42-Across, collectible carriers, or what the marked squares form
- 35 Got away
- 37 Ozco native
- 38 Oscar winner Davis
- 39 Chaplin of “Game of Thrones”
- 40 Mar-a-Lago location
- 42 See 34-Across
- 43 Really exist
- 44 Sephora competitor
- 45 Baseball’s Ponce and Bellinger
- 46 Work wk. end
- 47 Cashew family shrub
- 49 Bash on CNN
- 52 “...And ___ Wrote” (1962 Willie Nelson album)

- 54 Critic’s concern
- 58 Ruffle
- 60 Question to a dog at a door
- 62 Sweet spread
- 63 Trattoria treat
- 64 Heating choice
- 65 Took command of
- 66 Scorecard list
- Down**
- 1 Hurriedly hydrate
- 2 “Passion for the possible,” according to Kierkegaard
- 3 Abbr. on an office memo
- 4 What might keep a music video from rocking?
- 5 Pro ___
- 6 Owner of Mallorca and Menorca

- 7 “High Rollers” rapper
- 8 Lied, in euphemism
- 9 Path of a pop-up
- 10 Lab fuel, perhaps
- 11 Profound
- 12 Metrical tributes
- 14 Clock sound
- 16 Brief visit
- 21 Bar fight?
- 24 Hibachi residue
- 26 Gender-neutral pronoun

- 27 Like the Chinese calendar
- 28 Word of surrender
- 30 “O, she ___ teach the torches to burn bright!”, Romeo
- 31 Type of vote or war
- 32 Early inheritance
- 33 Map expands
- 34 Singer Dua
- 35 Totally exhausted
- 36 Sources of eats on streets
- 38 Put down
- 41 Sticker on a sock
- 42 Stole from a drag queen
- 45 Key of Beethoven’s Fifth
- 46 It’s unavoidable
- 48 Military squad
- 49 “Rats!”
- 50 Lago composition
- 51 Small complaints
- 53 Take command of
- 55 Etymology info
- 56 Make less sharp, perhaps
- 57 Rouse
- 59 Completely
- 61 Un metal precioso

Previous Puzzle’s Solution

O	U	E	B	L	O		J	A	M	S		N	O	W		
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G	N	U					E	V	E	N		C	E	N	T	R
S	I	P					R	E	D	S		L	O	Y	O	L

► Solve this puzzle online and discuss it at [WSJ.com/Puzzles](https://www.wsj.com/puzzles).

ARTS IN REVIEW

MUSIC REVIEW | MARK RICHARDSON

Geologist Mines Different Moods

The Animal Collective member issues his first solo album, an instrumental collection of richly varied sounds and textures

Animal Collective is among the most important indie-rock bands of the 21st century, and yet the quartet never fit neatly within the genre. That’s partly because the band’s sound has always been evolving. For several of its highest-profile years, culminating in the release of 2009’s landmark LP “Merriweather Post Pavilion,” Animal Collective could have been described as an electronic project—during live shows, members often found themselves controlling devices piled onto tables with wires jutting in every direction. Three of its members sing and each of them has released solo work; Noah “Panda Bear” Lennox in particular is a notable figure even away from the band. The nonsinging member who until recently had yet to release a solo LP is Brian Weitz, aka Geologist.

True to his moniker, Mr. Weitz studied environmental science and performs live with a headlamp, as if descending into a cave. His role in the group has always been difficult to define because he’s something of an on-the-fly producer and remixer, processing existing sounds and adding warped samples rather than playing a conventional instrument. A quarter-century into his music career, Mr. Weitz has finally taken the solo-album plunge. “Can I Get a Pack of Camel Lights?” (Drag City), out now, is a highly listenable collection of moods that speaks to his varied interests as a musician and a listener, with no advanced study in Animal Collective’s oeuvre necessary.

The title of the release comes from a phrase that Mr. Weitz estimates he spoke for many thousands of consecutive days before eventually giving up smoking, and it’s an amusingly disarming way to frame a record that is not often whimsical. Early on, the LP channels his long-stated interest in horror-film soundtracks. In addition to his standard arsenal of electrified gizmos and samples, a constant presence on the record is the hurdy-gurdy, a medieval instrument that generates a drone via a hand-cranked wheel that vibrates strings. The sound of the device is merely a starting point, and Mr. Weitz subjects its output to his characteristic processing. But the

His influences range from horror-movie soundtracks to Celtic music.



album, though entirely instrumental, is closer to rock music than the work of Animal Collective.

On the opening “Oracle Road,” the drone of the hurdy-gurdy, when run through distortion, alternately recalls bagpipes, electric guitar with heavy sustain, and even the buzz of the *pungi*, played by snake charmers in South Asia. The geographic ambiguity of this instrumental mix lends a feeling of instability that deepens the emotional range of the track—it hovers uneasily between dread and wonder, bringing to mind the global gothic approach of the British-Australian group Dead Can Dance.

“Tonic” is one of several tracks in which the hurdy-gurdy is processed to resemble a snarling guitar, and a drum machine implies a relationship to experimental rock. It comes across like a lower-fi version of such early punk groups as Suicide and Television with a digital sheen that suggests ’80s Tangerine Dream. The following “RV Envy” adds the thwack of a full drum kit to the mix, and the staticky howl of the hurdy-gurdy is as hectic as a smashed window triggering a building’s alarm system.

Mr. Weitz’s approach on “Can I Get a Pack” is deeply psychedelic, in that it seems designed to transform consciousness, but his mental trip is never of the blissed-out variety. Even the most upbeat tracks are streaked with darkness, and there’s often an undercurrent

of danger. “Compact Mirror / Last Names” stretches for nine minutes, and it works through several distinct sections—bits of percussion echo around a concrete space, a tinkly keyboard offers a rare moment of delicacy, and a bassline from Animal Collective bandmate Dave Portner draws from experimental bands such as This Heat, who fused the low-end of reggae with industrial textures. On “Color in the B&W,” a slow-motion explosion of snare drums and cymbals lingers in the foreground, and the combination of the percussion and a clarinet playing a Middle Eastern scale recalls Peter Gabriel’s film score “Passion: Music for The Last Temptation of Christ.”

While much of the music on the LP seems to unfold in the shadows, several tracks are

Brian Weitz, aka Geologist; his debut album is ‘Can I Get a Pack of Camel Lights?’

lighter in mood. “Not Trad” is overtly Celtic, with a marching melody that could be played by a piper and a thumping drum that seems appropriate for a celebration. And the closing “Sonora” is a spirited epic with a gliding beat and a modal jam that sounds like the instrumental coda from the Who’s “Baba O’Riley” played by an early iteration of Kraftwerk. It’s stiff and funky, eerie and propulsive, and like the album as a whole it cries out to be played again.

Mr. Richardson is the Journal’s pop and rock music critic. Follow him on X @MarkRichardson.

TELEVISION REVIEW | JOHN ANDERSON

A Polish Comedy Of Marriage and Art

THE WRYL FUNNY “Seasons” is hardly a madcap romp in Nazi-occupied Warsaw, but it does have some kinship with “To Be or Not to Be,” the Ernst Lubitsch comedy of 1942. Both are set in Poland, in the theater, with an egomaniacal protagonist wrestling with his sexual insecurities. The war in “Seasons” is not with Germany, though. It’s between our hero and himself. And like Jack Benny (or Mel Brooks in the 1983 remake), he’s losing.

We can see right away that Marcin (Lukasz Simlat, of the Oscar-nominated “Corpus Christi”) is a self-absorbed, overbearing ass: He harangues his actress wife, Ola (Agnieszka Duleba-Kasza), down several streets as the couple and their daughters make their way to an afternoon performance of “Peter Pan” in their modest city of Toruń—he’s playing Captain Hook, she Tinker Bell. He wants to know why she’s unhappy; the audience will be muttering, “Get a clue.” When they finally reach the theater, and drag their argument into the wings, an exasperated Ola reveals to Marcin that she had an affair with Peter Pan (Dobromir Dymecki). At which point both Peter and Tink are whisked skyward on wires. And Marcin is left to stew.

What follows, courtesy of director Michal Grzybowski and his co-writer, Tomasz Walesiak, is an artistic and personal Eurotrain wreck. Torturing himself, Marcin polls the entire company, asking who did or didn’t know about the now-three-year-old affair. Few did not. In his pain and anger, he sabotages the

play, turns the Hook-Pan showdown into a real fight, and leaves an audience full of kids wondering if Neverland is always like this. It suggests the immortal words of Noel Coward—“Why Must the Show Go On?” (“We know that you’re sad / We know that you’ve had / A lot of storm and strife / But is it quite fair to ask us to share / Your dreary private life?”) The play is in ruins. Likewise the Marcin-Ola marriage.

The drollery in “Seasons” is based on the eternal question about what can, and invariably will, go wrong next. Not in slapstick fashion (although the Peter Pan debacle is pretty raucous), but in an Eastern European sense of inevitable cosmic calamity. When we next see Marcin, the chastened-



looking actor’s life is in disarray, but apparently not his career: He’s playing Torvald in the company’s production of “A Doll’s House,” opposite his new lover, Ewa (Wiktorija Filus). When Ewa breaks a leg—lit-

erally—how will the show go on? What actress will nobly step in as Nora and save the production, while reducing Marcin to a puddle of self-recrimination and doubt? No spoilers here.

Ms. Duleba-Kasza’s Ola is a woe-begone delight; one can sense the psychic miles Marcin has run up on her. But can director Grzybowski make Marcin sympathetic? It’s necessary, though no one’s in a hurry, not until Marcin gets mentally frogmarched through several expanses of pain and emotional instruction. He was outraged that no one told him about Ola’s affair prior to “Peter Pan.” Apparently, the company learned its lesson about gossip because when a new director, Robert (Sebastian Pawlak), arrives to direct the Ibsen, it’s clear no one’s told him anything. Not about the

affair. Not about the imminent divorce. Not even when Ola takes over the Nora role, nor when she and her estranged husband have to portray the breakup scene in the play. “You have to really listen to each other,” Robert tells his actors. “Feel what connects them. Or rather what no longer connects them.” He suggests that Marcin immerse himself in his feelings. “I don’t know about your life experiences,” he says, “but try recalling something difficult.” Not a problem.

The use of stage direction as couples therapy is one of the more poignant sequences in a film that tends to dance along the line separating the farcical from the bitter-sweet. Two offscreen actors constantly argue about Robert De Niro (“You know nothing about his craft!”) as if “Taxi Driver” had just got to town. Marcin, initially as malignant as Hook and as blinkered as Torvald, eventually grows as repentant and noble as Oberon in “A Midsummer Night’s Dream,” which will co-star a certain native of Toruń as Titania. One might call the whole thing puckish, if that weren’t beneath the dignity of the very funny-lovely “Seasons.”

Seasons
Thursday, Viaplay

Mr. Anderson is the Journal’s TV critic.



Wiktorija Filus, left; Lukasz Simlat and Agnieszka Duleba-Kasza, above, in the film directed by Michal Grzybowski.

OPINION

Out With EVs, in With Spaceflight



BUSINESS WORLD
By Holman W. Jenkins, Jr.

Green pundits can still be heard insisting China has seized a strategic high ground in solar. But the conviction is noticeably leaking from their voices. Solar panels are useful; they seem less and less strategic by the hour. China's makers will have to keep cutting prices to find customers in a world of expanding energy options.

Those expanding energy options are the real story.

A nonsensical ideologized worldview has collapsed, the so-called energy transition. If battery electric is the future of transportation and robotics, as many say, so what? Fossil fuels will continue to find customers and myriad applications. Emissions will continue.

The fantasy about electric cars being the Christ of consumer products, our savior, has gone to the ideological landfill in the sky. A carbon tax remains the sensible approach to moderating CO2, if anyone is asking. They aren't. And yet the Trump administration may be about to open a backdoor to let Chinese EVs enter the U.S. tariff-free. Another strategic industry we're about to lose? No. Americans will suffer inferior cars and inferior carmakers only if we shield our domestic market from competition.

If you're confused about what constitutes world-changing energy and transportation engineering, maybe it's time to look elsewhere: human spaceflight.

The key is rocket reusability, pioneered by Elon Musk, which has given rise to a \$12-billion-a-year revenue-generating business in Starlink, soon to be joined by Jeff Bezos' version of space-based internet access through his company Blue Origin.

With SpaceX's forthcoming Starship, launch costs per kilogram are expected to fall to 1% of the costs under the space shuttle. New paying space ventures are in view. Microgravity manufacturing will allow purer and more-uniform crystals, alloys and drug compounds. Helium mining on the moon is possible. Large amounts of data for AI might be processed more cheaply in orbit thanks to solar energy and ease of cooling. Mr. Musk on Monday announced he will merge SpaceX with his AI company in pursuit of exactly this opportunity.

Two things might threaten this boom. One is debris proliferation in low Earth orbit if there's an accident. SpaceX will soon make its first attempt at refueling a rocket in space. For once, move fast and break things isn't the order of the day.

The other is the palsied hand of government. Private space flight has been going so well, it's hardly been a subject in this column since a 2004 effort to prod congressional ac-

tion on a safe harbor from the lawsuit industry. Now that moment has returned. The Senate is considering a bill to codify a Trump executive order streamlining licensing rules and procedures. Guess who opposes the order? The state of California, possibly out of animus for Mr. Musk.

I've made my forecast clear. The U.S. won't deal with its looming debt problem except with ad hockery—inflation, spending cuts, tax hikes, de facto claw-backs of government benefits via waiting lists and declining service quality.

But the coming debt convulsion can end badly or very, very badly depending on one thing: whether we protect a 15-generation North American legacy of personal enterprise and rule of law. For now, the U.S. remains outside the norm of our major global antagonists. Our politics isn't solely reduced to figuring out who has created something of value, like SpaceX, so it can be shaken down, stolen or harnessed for aggressive statist ends.

Less encouragingly, President Trump vents a noticeably corruption-tinged urge to extract favors from firms that

benefit from his decisions. And Democrats proclaim a strange new enthusiasm for socialism, never mind that we already have a lot of socialism. It's the source of our runaway debt.

Why not more socialism? For one thing, in our newly Hobbesian international environment, not keeping pace in the race for wealth and technology means falling prey to those who do. Ask yourself which countries are likely to prevail: Those that afford their industries relatively free access to a global division of labor? Or those that follow the lure of industrial policy and protectionism?

Mr. Trump does have a decision to make, and it isn't an easy one. The market is running away as fast as it can from centralized, government-run, cost-plus space endeavors. This month, until Monday's hydrogen leak, NASA hoped to test a rocket-and-capsule system that has been plagued with problems, delays and overruns. The test involves a four-astronaut flyby of the moon as a dry run for a moon landing, perhaps in 2028.

That 2028 landing remains on the agenda for now, but the latest Trump budget proposal calls for scrapping NASA's \$100 billion investment immediately after: too expensive, too complicated, too uncompetitive with private rockets for a sustainable moon presence. With this debate simmering nearby, going ahead with the launch will take some political bravery.

America's 'strategic' industries are those that reward innovation with profits.

Trump's ICE Tactics Alienate Americans



POLITICS & IDEAS
By William A. Galston

During the first year of his second term, President Trump has governed as if he needs to please only one subset of those who voted for him in 2024—his hard-core MAGA base. This is a mistake. Only 6 in 10 Republicans identify as MAGA supporters, while about 3 in 10 say they aren't and the rest are unsure, according to a recent Economist/YouGov poll. Only 54% of all Americans who voted for Mr. Trump identify with MAGA.

Polling last summer found that while 55% of Americans liked Mr. Trump's deportation goals, only 44% liked the means he was using to achieve those goals—and that support for Immigration and Customs Enforcement was declining. Many of the president's supporters have come to share these reservations.

More than a third of those who voted for him in 2024 now say in a Politico poll that while they back the goals of his mass-deportation campaign, they disapprove of the way he's implementing it. This sentiment is especially prevalent among non-MAGA supporters. Overall, 62% of MAGA Trump voters and only 37% of non-MAGA Trump voters support Mr. Trump's deportation goals and methods.

That Mr. Trump has governed with an eye only to his

base helps explain the steady erosion of support since the early weeks of his administration. The recent violent confrontations in Minneapolis have generated a crisis that threatens to engulf his agenda and wipe out the Republican majority in the House.

Nearly everyone agrees that immigrants illegally in the U.S. who have committed serious crimes should be deported. But self-identifying MAGA voters are out of step with the broader public. Of those polled by Politico, 44% of MAGA Trump voters say that "the federal government should aim to deport as many illegal immigrants as possible, regardless of criminal history." Only 18% of all voters take this stance. Less than a third of voters think that people who arrived here illegally as children should be deported, according to a Harvard Harris Poll. Putting a 5-year-old in a detention center generates images that no public-relations expert can spin away.

The distinction between permitted and forbidden means is the core of the rule of law. Most Americans understand this instinctively and reject government actions that violate their sense of what law and common decency permit.

The actions of ICE and Border Patrol agents have crossed this line. According to Harvard Harris, majorities believe that federal agents have gone too far and are violating civil liberties. In the fatal shootings of Renee Good and Alex Pretti, they say agents were too quick

to use excessive force. A plurality believe that agents should be making targeted arrests, not engaging in random street sweeps. Most Americans think agents shouldn't make arrests in workplaces, schools or daycare centers. By wide margins, according to Pew Research Center, they think it's unacceptable for agents to use people's appearance or the

The hard-core MAGA base supports him, but that won't be enough to win the midterms.

language they speak as a reason to check their immigration status. They also reject agents' use of face coverings to hide their identities.

According to multiple recent surveys, Americans now believe that ICE's actions have been more harmful than beneficial and have made American cities less safe. They want the federal government to change course. Agents shouldn't enter private homes without warrants or detain U.S. citizens, most Americans say. They shouldn't wear plain clothes but uniforms that identify their agency. They should be required to identify themselves and to wear body cameras.

Funding for ICE is now less popular than foreign aid, and 51% of Americans believe that the federal government should decrease funding for ICE "a lot

or slightly," according to a YouGov poll. This is a remarkable state of affairs for an agency whose goals enjoy broad public support.

The fight over the 2026 budget for the Department of Homeland Security gives the Trump administration and congressional Republicans an opportunity to change course. But they face a conundrum familiar to veterans of electoral politics: To placate the frustrated voters who threaten to jump ship, they'll need to take steps that could antagonize Mr. Trump's most fervent supporters. Persuading the MAGA base that it's necessary to moderate the push for mass deportations won't be easy. Immigration is the issue about which many of them care the most. If the administration looks as if it's pulling back, some of them could stay home in November.

Still, Mr. Trump has little choice, as he seems to realize. A new Fox News survey finds that 68% of Americans, including 48% of Republicans, believe that the president isn't devoting enough time to the country's economic problems. Mr. Trump's recent effort to pivot to the economy has no chance of breaking through as long as the controversy over deportations dominates the news. Seven in 10 Americans rate economic conditions as fair or poor. If they think that Mr. Trump isn't focused on improving the economy, it's hard to see how his party can avoid a serious setback in the midterm elections.

Newsom Continues a Medicaid 'Scam'

By Chris Jacobs

Gov. Gavin Newsom's press office has been pumping out social-media posts on healthcare fraud in red states. But the California governor's latest budget maintains a Medicaid funding gimmick designed to bilk federal taxpayers of billions of dollars, even though Congress outlawed it months ago.

Mr. Newsom's budget, released last month, assumes that a Medicaid provider tax on managed-care organizations will remain in place through December. In 2026 this assessment taxes insurers covering Medicaid enrollees at \$274 a month per enrollee, while the tax for other enrollees is \$2.25 a month. The disparate treatment seeks to maximize revenue from Medicaid beneficiaries, for whom California can gain additional federal matching funds, without raising costs for people with other forms of insurance, such as employer-sponsored coverage.

Provider taxes facilitate fraud on multiple levels. The Centers for Medicare and Medicaid Services described the taxes as "money laundering"—Vice President Joe Biden reportedly called them a "scam"—because they do little other than increase the share of Medicaid costs paid

His budget includes a tax that Congress has rendered illegal.

by federal rather than state dollars. With Washington bearing most of the burden due to these cost shifts, state Medicaid programs have less incentive to focus on program integrity.

Republican and Democratic administrations alike have warned about the abusive nature of this tax, which raises an estimated \$7.5 billion a year for California. On two occasions, the Biden administration warned California that CMS in-

tended to eliminate the loophole. In May the Trump administration issued a rule to do so; for states like California, which had received repeated warnings about the issue, CMS proposed ending the loophole immediately on publication of the final rule.

Weeks after CMS issued its proposed rule, Congress closed the loophole through a provision in the Big Beautiful Bill Act. The law provides that the provision became effective "upon the date of enactment . . . subject to any transition period determined appropriate" of up to three fiscal years.

In November, CMS issued guidance suggesting that the transition period would last until the end of the state's current fiscal year; in California's case, until June 30. Yet despite years of warnings that California needed to modify or repeal this abusive tax, and explicit guidance from CMS, Mr. Newsom's budget assumes it can maintain the status quo for all of 2026.

CMS has legitimate policy reasons for closing this loophole as quickly as possible. The proposed rule last May estimated that it would save \$33.2 billion in federal costs and an additional \$18.8 billion in state spending from 2026 through 2030. Given the repeated warnings states have received about this issue, one might ask why CMS hasn't insisted on enforcing the new restrictions retroactive to the enactment of the Big Beautiful Bill in July.

At a bare minimum, federal officials should reject any attempt by California to extend the transition period beyond June. If Mr. Newsom wishes to couple his continued reliance on this abusive—and now illegal—gimmick with online trolling, the Trump administration could respond: Be careful what you wish for in focusing on fraud—you just might get it.

Mr. Jacobs is founder and CEO of Juniper Research Group.

BOOKSHELF | By Andrew Stark

Self-Help You Can Use

How to Know Your Self

By J. Eric Oliver
Liveright, 288 pages, \$31.99

The psychologist B.F. Skinner (1904-90) is remembered for his principle of reinforcement. His idea was simple. When our actions are rewarded by their consequences, we tend to repeat them. When they are not, we don't.

One day a friend of mine witnessed Skinner rushing into an elevator at Harvard. The elevator was programmed, as signs indicated, to wait with its doors open for 2 minutes before heading up. That didn't prevent Skinner from repeatedly pressing the close-door button, even though his behavior wasn't once reinforced by any kind of reward.

It is a cautionary tale. If the great theorist of reinforcement couldn't stop himself from compulsively jabbing an unresponsive button, then how can the rest of us ever throw off the self-defeating thoughts, regrets and obsessions that replay themselves endlessly in our minds? J. Eric Oliver's "How to Know Your Self: The Art & Science of Discovering Who You Really Are" offers some hope.

Mr. Oliver, a political scientist at the University of Chicago, explains that our selves are composed of several layers. At the basic cellular level, we are beings that metabolize energy, reproduce offspring and pursue survival. Then comes our animal self, with its capacity to identify patterns in our immediate environment.

The next level, Mr. Oliver says, is our linguistic self. Language, which evolved within the past 200,000 years, endowed our species with the ability to plan for the future and reflect on the past, thus extending our selves backward and forward in time. As societies emerged, we began to develop egos, those brittle parts of our selves taxed with negotiating between our primal urges and the constraints of a civilized order.

As these layers piled up and the self grew more sophisticated, Mr. Oliver says, they also twisted and trapped us. Language's capacity to elongate the self in time burdened us with anxiety and regret. The ego's constant need to be fortified made us chronically insecure. Because we never got over the rejection we suffered from our first crush, for instance, we now perpetually worry that our spouse is about to leave us.

What to do about all of this? Mr. Oliver's answers might seem conventional, but they furnish a welcome alternative to much contemporary self-help literature. He has little use for those gurus who tell us that we can "conquer the world." Nor does he share the vogue for "radical acceptance," whose advocates counsel us to simply endure and even embrace the mental blocks and anxieties we have accumulated along our personal life path.

Instead, Mr. Oliver suggests, among other things, meditation and yoga, explaining how these Eastern practices can help us transcend our personal preoccupations and loosen the constraints of the ego's self-obsession. The ultimate goal, he says, is a "shift in perspective—seeing ourselves not as separate individuals but as interconnected participants in life's grand experiment."

Western psychotherapy also has a role to play. A skilled therapist—or the judicious use of psychedelics—can free us from the longtime anxieties, simmering resentments and secret vulnerabilities that our distorted sense of self has bequeathed to us. If you can't help worrying that your partner is about to "elope with that cute waiter who they smiled at with a little too much enthusiasm," Mr. Oliver writes, a therapist can help you recognize that such thoughts, even if they "made sense when you were young . . . are now just messing with your adult life."

Human psychology has burdened us with anxiety about the future and regret about the past. It may be fruitful to look outwards.

"How to Know Your Self" is an enjoyable book that is full of wry wit. For instance, Mr. Oliver observes that there is no adequate word for the simultaneous lust and disgust we can feel toward the same person, and suggests "disglust" as a possibility. But there are problems with the advice he offers.

Many of us, trying meditation, find it difficult to keep our mind focused on our mantra, let alone shed our ego and experience some kind of merger with the universe. And not everyone buys the self-help message that we can conquer the universe in every possible way. What we can do—what many of us try to do over the course of our lives—is find our own unique hill on which we occupy the top and take our egoistic satisfaction that way.

Ted Cohen didn't claim to be the greatest philosopher of his generation, for example, but the jacket of one of his books indicated that he was among the funniest. A.J. Liebling didn't profess to be the best wordsmith who ever lived, but he did say that he could write faster than anyone who could write better. Jean-Jacques Rousseau noted that if all else fails, each of us can be the best parent in the world in the eyes of our children. Think of all those shirts that say "World's Best Dad."

As for Mr. Oliver's enthusiasm for psychotherapy, not all of us are able to spend long hours exploring the wounds that our unique psychologies or childhoods have inflicted on us. Yet nor are we able to simply accept those wounds. Fortunately, literature can help. Good novels and memoirs remind us that whatever our own issues might be, they are at some level universal. Reading gives us the consolation of solidarity. For many it is a vital supplement to the therapy Mr. Oliver recommends.

This is where Skinner comes in. His doctrines are no longer cutting-edge. But in demonstrating, if inadvertently, that even he couldn't escape what Mr. Oliver calls the "obsessions, preoccupations, and mental loops that grip us so tightly," the psychologist provided an important service. He let the mantle slip and showed us that when it comes to being human, we're never alone.

Mr. Stark's books include "The Consolations of Mortality" and "Conflict of Interest in American Public Life."

OPINION

REVIEW & OUTLOOK

How to Get Kevin Warsh Confirmed

President Trump made a wise decision last week to nominate Kevin Warsh to run the Federal Reserve, but now Mr. Trump has to get him confirmed by the Senate. The big obstacle is Mr. Trump’s criminal probe into current Fed Chair Jerome Powell, which the President should stop in his own political interest.

Tell Pirro to drop the criminal probe over Powell’s testimony.

Federal prosecutors recently sent a criminal subpoena to Mr. Powell regarding testimony he gave to Congress last summer concerning the renovation of the Fed’s office buildings in Washington, D.C. The renovations cost hundreds of millions of dollars more than projected, which alas is all too typical for a government building project.

We haven’t seen the subpoena, but sources who have seen it say it amounts to a broad fishing expedition to find something, anything, to charge against the Chairman. His testimony on the renovations shows no criminal intent we can see. That suggests the investigation by the U.S. Attorney for the District of Columbia, Jeanine Pirro, is intended to punish Mr. Powell for not cutting interest rates as aggressively as Mr. Trump prefers.

This political lawfare now may backfire as Mr. Trump tries to get his own nominees on the Fed board. North Carolina GOP Sen. Thom Tillis on Friday praised Mr. Warsh as a “qualified nominee with a deep understanding of monetary policy.” But he reiterated that he won’t support a Trump nominee to the Fed until the investigation into Mr. Powell is resolved.

Mr. Tillis sits on the Senate Banking Committee, which will review Mr. Warsh’s nomination. Republicans have a 13-11 majority on the committee. Without Mr. Tillis’s support, a stalemate is likely. Senate Majority Leader John Thune on Thursday said that the Senate probably couldn’t confirm a Fed pick without Mr. Tillis’s support. Mr. Tillis isn’t running for re-election this year after Mr. Trump trashed him on social media, so the Senator has little incentive to give Mr. Trump a break.

Does this worry the President? Not that he’s letting on. Asked by the press if Ms. Pirro would drop the Powell probe in light of Mr. Tillis’s

statement, Mr. Trump replied: “She’s got to take it to the end and see. . . . It’s either gross incompetence or it’s theft of some kind.” He’s right that there’s incompetence—by his Administration.

Federal Housing Finance Agency director Bill Pulte, who seems to think his main duty is fealty to Mr. Trump, has been pushing for a Powell investigation since last summer. “Jerome Powell’s \$2.5B Building Renovation Scandal stinks to high heaven, and he lied when asked about the specifics before Congress. This is nothing short of malfeasance,” Mr. Pulte tweeted in July. This was a smear without evidence to support his claim of misconduct.

Our sources say Mr. Pulte wrote a report on the renovations that made its way to Ms. Pirro, a former Fox News celebrity who is a first-degree Trump loyalist. An extended legal fight is possible if Mr. Powell defies or challenges the subpoena. That would make it unlikely that the Senate advances Mr. Warsh’s nomination anytime soon.

The criminal probe may also encourage Mr. Powell to remain as a Fed governor even after his chairmanship ends in May. His term as governor doesn’t expire until 2028, and most chairmen step down from the board when their chairmanship ends. Mr. Warsh is filling the open seat created by the departure of Stephen Miran, whose term expired on Friday. But Mr. Powell might stay on if he feels the independence of the Fed is in jeopardy from the Pirro criminal probe.

If Mr. Powell departs, Mr. Trump would have a second opening to fill on the seven-person Fed board and a chance to give Mr. Warsh a wing man for his reform agenda. Mr. Warsh will need more support in particular to get his regulatory reform agenda past the Biden appointees on the board. Former World Bank president and Treasury official David Malpass would be a good, and confirmable, choice.

All of this argues for Attorney General Pam Bondi to order Ms. Pirro to close the Powell case file and focus on real crimes. The duo aren’t doing the President, or the country, any favors by continuing with this harassing and counterproductive investigation.

The Epstein Files Fallout Hits the Innocent

The Justice Department’s release of the so-called Epstein files has gone pretty much as skeptics warned. The feds published another three million pages on Friday. Such investigatory materials are usually kept private to protect innocent victims and witnesses—a lesson that Congress will now relearn at their expense.

Though the Justice Department sought to redact sensitive information, Congress mandated disclosure in 30 days. The Journal reports that last week’s documents initially failed to black out the names of at least 43 victims of Jeffrey Epstein, “including many who haven’t shared their identities publicly or were minors when they were abused by the notorious sex offender.” Some of their addresses or email addresses were posted.

The files also included “dozens of unredacted nude images,” showing the faces and bodies of “young women or possibly teenagers,” the New York Times said. The Justice Department scrambled to fix the oversights. “You’re talking about pieces of paper that stack from the ground to two Eiffel Towers,” Deputy Attorney General Todd Blanche told Fox News. “We knew that there would be mistakes.”

Meantime, heinous accusations are circulating against prominent people, without any evidence they’re true. Since Epstein died in 2019,

prosecutors have had time to chase real leads. The Epstein emails that show elites privately cozying up to a wealthy sex offender are embarrassing, but the government isn’t supposed to be in the business of posting scandalous raw evidence without a verifiable criminal case.

“There are allegations in there that, with 10 or 15 minutes of work, you can realize have no basis in fact,” Jay Clayton, the U.S. Attorney for Manhattan, told CNBC. Protecting accusers, he said, matters for prosecuting future offenders, since it’s “very, very difficult to get victims to come forward in these types of situations.”

Congress can’t fob off blame for the redaction errors, after it set an impossible deadline. If lawmakers have a vestigial sense of shame, they can apologize to the victims whose information was posted. The brave exception is Republican Rep. Clay Higgins, the only member of Congress who voted against this document dump, because it “abandons 250 years of criminal justice procedure” and “will absolutely result in innocent people being hurt.”

Apparently, neither the Biden Administration nor the Trump Administration was able to bring new charges against Epstein’s associates. Yet figures on both political sides have found it useful to engage in cheap posturing, claiming a government coverup. In the frenzy, innocent people are getting hurt.

Vladimir Putin Isn’t Winning in Ukraine

President Trump has his hands full in Venezuela while also pondering military action in Iran, but the Ukraine war is grinding on and Vladimir Putin wants the world to think he can’t be defeated. A new, detailed report on the war underscores that Mr. Putin isn’t winning, and Mr. Trump can still apply military and economic pressure to produce a peace that is honorable.

The Russian death toll may be as high as 325,000 in four years.

Russian forces have taken an astonishing 1.2 million casualties in Ukraine since 2022, according to estimates from Seth Jones and Riley McCabe of the Center for Strategic and International Studies. The Russian death toll may be as high as 325,000—more than five times than in all Soviet and Russian conflicts combined since World War II. Some 36,000 Americans died in the grinding three-year Korean War.

The conventional wisdom is that Mr. Putin will eventually prevail because Russia is the larger power and Mr. Putin can keep throwing men into his human meat grinder. Yet Mr. Putin isn’t making territorial gains commensurate with his losses.

Consider Mr. Putin’s struggle to take the city of Pokrovsk. Russian forces have advanced in the area on average 70 meters a day from late February 2024 to January of this year. That’s like starting the day on 42nd street in Manhattan and ending up on 43rd street.

The Ukraine war draws comparisons to the trench warfare of World War I, but the Russian advance has been “slower than the most brutal offensive campaigns over the last century, in-

cluding the notoriously bloody Battle of the Somme during World War I,” says the report. Ukraine has its own manpower shortages, but Russian casualties are two or 2.5 to one for Ukraine.

Meanwhile, half of Moscow’s budget is flowing to “the armed forces, the military-industrial complex, domestic security and debt service,” CSIS notes. Moscow doesn’t have the economic growth or dynamism to keep underwriting the misadventure for the long haul. One illustrative fact: Russia has “a grand total of zero companies in the top 100 list of technology companies as measured by market capitalization.”

All of this means Mr. Putin shouldn’t be able to wield a whip hand at the negotiating table. The Russian dictator is in a weakened position that Mr. Trump could exploit with tougher sanctions and more U.S. weapons, to at least force Mr. Putin to give up some stolen territory and tolerate real security guarantees.

The same Mr. Trump who arms his diplomacy with Iran to increase his leverage has been oddly unwilling to do the same with Mr. Putin. But a weak peace would let Mr. Putin “up off the mat,” as GOP Senate Armed Services Committee Chairman Roger Wicker put it last year. The Russian would rear up with a renewed animus for NATO.

Mr. Putin isn’t the unstoppable man he wants Mr. Trump to think he is. The question of the past year has been whether President Trump will see this strategic opening to reduce the Russian threat to the U.S., and deter the world’s bad actors in Beijing and elsewhere, by driving a harder bargain in Ukraine.

LETTERS TO THE EDITOR

Is It Time for ICE to Pause in Minneapolis?

I agree with one core point in your editorial (“Time for ICE to Pause in Minneapolis” Jan. 26): If the facts are as the video appears to show, this is exactly the kind of use-of-force incident that demands immediate, independent scrutiny and full accountability.

But calling for a “pause” is the wrong prescription—and dangerous. That would reward organized street obstruction. It would tell activists nationwide that confrontation, escalation and viral pressure can veto federal law enforcement. It would reward, too, the top state and local officials who encouraged mass “citizen monitoring,” urging people to flood the streets with phones, and who publicly frame Immigration and Customs Enforcement as an occupying force or “terror” operation.

The right standard is simple and consistent: Enforce the law everywhere, and enforce it professionally. If an agent fired after a weapon was already secured and the suspect was under control, investigate, preserve evidence, release bodycam where legally possible, and prosecute if warranted. We can defend the rule of law without defending sloppy tactics.

IGOR MERTZ
Royal Oak, Mich.

More than a pause is needed. While removing dangerous individuals who entered illegally has likely prevented crime, the administration’s current approach to deportations causes more harm than good. Mistakes by both advocates and opponents have led to unnecessary deaths and deepened national divisions.

The government cannot undo past mass illegal immigration, but humane, effective options exist. Greater

financial incentives under Customs and Border Protection’s Home program could encourage voluntary departures, and those who remain should be allowed, after careful vetting, to apply for legal residence. ICE should act only against individuals who pose credible threats.

ANDRÉ MONTERO
Brooklyn, N.Y.

Your editorial is on point in looking at how the use of ICE should be managed going forward, especially in sanctuary cities such as Minneapolis. But President Trump could’ve avoided this becoming a losing situation. Had he honored the wishes of Gov. Tim Walz and Mayor Jacob Frey, and not sent in more ICE agents and troops, all the onus of the likely future crimes would be on the Minnesota officials and proven Mr. Trump correct. The public would then likely be supportive of the president and demand help from federal agents to help search for and deport the criminal element of those in our country illegally.

DAVID AND CAROL POWELL
Tucson, Ariz.

Lamentations of immigration agents’ actions seem to miss who has responsibility for immigration law. Were Congress to address the status of illegal immigrants who have been here for a lengthy period and been law abiding, ICE could focus on criminal illegal aliens. ICE, today, must enforce today’s laws. This one action by Congress would reduce much of the frustration and hostility toward federal agents.

STEVEN R. ELMAN
Norfolk, Va.

Billionaire Tax Would Save Calif. Healthcare

I was disappointed to read Jon Hartley and Arthur Laffer’s misleading op-ed about the proposed California Billionaire Tax ballot measure in your pages (“California Wealth Tax Backers Ignore Proposition 13 Lessons” Jan. 26). As a dedicated healthcare worker and a member of our SEIU-United Healthcare Workers West’s statewide executive board, I was proud to vote “Yes” that our union should sponsor the proposal to protect our patients.

Contrary to the writers’ claims about high taxes, nationally billionaires pay less in taxes on their overall wealth than working families do, the National Bureau of Economic Research estimates. And soon, massive federal healthcare funding cuts in 2026 may

collapse key parts of the California healthcare system. Local hospitals and emergency rooms are at risk of shutting their doors forever.

That’s much too high a price to pay for billionaires who insist on paying less than the rest of us, and I believe the vast majority of Californians agree with me.

That’s why I’m joining with healthcare workers from across the state to support this commonsense measure, and I encourage your readers to join us.

MAYRA CASTAÑEDA
Ultrasound technologist
St. Francis Medical Center
Lynwood, Calif.

Who’ll Go Get Venezuela Oil

Peter McPherson’s proposal to stabilize Venezuela via an oil dividend is a compelling application of the “Alaska Model” (“Venezuela Can Learn From an Iraq Mistake,” op-ed, Jan. 28), but it raises a fundamental question of capital flow: In a nation with a hollowed-out energy infrastructure, whose money is actually reaching the people?

To restore Venezuela’s production from its current state, international oil companies must commit tens of billions in capital. These firms will rightly demand cost recovery and profit margins before a single barrel is cleared for a sovereign fund. If the proposed dividend is pulled from the top-line revenue, it risks deterring the very private investment required to make the wells pump again. Conversely, if it is pulled from the bottom-line—after the companies and the new government take their cut—the “dividend” for the average Venezuelan may be too negligible to spark the economic rebuilding Mr. McPherson envisions.

The Trump administration’s current use of a Qatar-based trust fund to shield assets from creditors is a necessary first step. But, for this to work, the administration must provide a transparent framework that balances a win-win for both the foreign investor and the local citizen. Without clear rules on who gets paid first, we risk repeating the mistakes of Iraq, where the promise of shared wealth was buried under the weight of reconstruction costs and lack of transparency.

MARK GIANNINY
Rochester, N.Y.

Pepper ... And Salt

THE WALL STREET JOURNAL



“Liar is a pejorative term. I prefer to think of myself as a fabulist.”

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OPINION

Trump Hands Democrats a Golden Opportunity

By **Rahm Emanuel**

The GOP is in trouble, as polls and pundits have made abundantly clear. President Trump is under-water, so much so that even Joe Rogan is comparing the deployment of Immigration and Customs Enforcement to “the Gestapo.”

Ten months ahead of an election destined to be a referendum on the incumbent party, the generic Democrat leads the generic Republican by 4 to 5 points, according to a January New York Times/Siena poll. That said, nuances in the public’s collective psychology matter for how or whether various voters show up to the polls. Three slices of American voters are having three distinct reactions to the president’s first year in office.

Voters reconsider the Faustian bargain they struck in voting for the president in 2024.

First, Democratic voters are angry at what the president is doing, and they’re even angrier that he’s seemingly getting away with it. We saw Mr. Trump for what he was during his first term, and we told the public what he was going to do during this second go-round. Yet much of the country ignored the warning signs. Now that the mask has come off—the personal enrichment, the ICE-induced chaos in Minnesota and Oregon, the pardons for Jan. 6 criminals and the alienation of traditional democratic allies overseas—many Democrats are rightfully indignant. But the intensity of our rage can easily come across as self-righteous. When indignation morphs into a tone of “I told you so,” it will be flipped against us.

The second, most surprising reaction is among the MAGA faithful.

Like many others, I presumed a few months ago that we were entering a post-Trump era. But when I listened to former Rep. Marjorie Taylor Greene argue that Mr. Trump is abandoning his “America First” credo, I realized that she and other disaffected Republicans are feeling not only untethered but betrayed. Mr. Trump promised to drain the swamp—instead he’s dug it wider and deeper. He claimed he would boost working-class incomes, but he has instead worked tirelessly to enhance his own family’s wealth. He claimed he would end foreign wars, but he has attacked Venezuela, Nigeria and Iran, and he has threatened Greenland.

The third shift for Democrats’ fortunes is among the voters who broke for Mr. Trump in 2024 despite all the things they found distasteful about him personally. Among these voters, who represent the largest slice of the electorate—according to Gallup, a record-high 45% today—the overwhelming sentiment is discomfort and disquiet. In a Faustian bargain, they overlooked his abhorrent personality because they believed his business acumen would fix the economy—that he wouldn’t get distracted by social and cultural issues. That was the subtext of the famous tagline: “Kamala is for they/them, President Trump is for you.”

But he hasn’t come through—the economy is still leaving too many people behind. Too many young people are still stuck in their parents’ basements because their paychecks don’t cover their monthly bills. These voters feel as though they’ve gotten the short end of the bargain.

Worst of all, no one is rising up to



stand in Mr. Trump’s way. No institution—not his staff, not the Supreme Court and certainly not Congress—is rising up to check Mr. Trump’s bad judgment, instincts and character. The president appears entirely unencumbered and unhinged.

Politically, this third group is most important, not only because they will decide who wins in November, but because independents have grown to encompass nearly half of the electorate and will be an essential part of any durable Democratic majority going forward. The Hispanic voters who swung to Mr. Trump in 2024 are more open than most voters to switching their party allegiance. But becoming anti-Trump doesn’t automatically make them Democrats, and that’s a key distinction. All of which is to suggest that Democrats need, in the short term, to lean heavily into the notion that Republican members of Congress are acting as the president’s enablers. If voters aren’t sick of hearing the phrase “rubber-stamp

GOP Congress” the day after the November election, our messaging will have failed in service of its strategic objective.

Which brings us to the long-term future. To cement the support of these unaffiliated voters, Democrats will have to avoid the mistake we so often make of telling people we were right all along. Smug superiority is the electoral kryptonite that gets us every time—but the road to sustained political success is filled with other messaging traps as well. Recall that “defund the police” was an electoral disaster. So was the offer of free healthcare at the border for undocumented immigrants in 2020.

Today, we risk losing sight of these same voters as activists try to rally around calls to “abolish ICE.” Far from abandoning enforcement in the wake of Renee Good and Alex Pretti’s killings, we need fundamental reforms that strengthen oversight, ensure due process and deepen trust between law enforcement at

every level and the local communities they serve.

Despite what the party’s small-dollar donor class may want, that doesn’t mean that voters are suddenly of a different mind about the effects of illegal immigration at the border, public safety, incomes for working families, or how people with fancy degrees from fancy colleges want to tell them how to live their lives “for the better.” We need to be focused on embracing policies that appeal not to our base alone, but to the swing voters who now represent nearly half the electorate and will determine our electoral success. We need to adopt a tone that draws those same voters into a more permanent part of our governing coalition.

For the past quarter-century, elections in this country have gone from post to post, with voters throwing one set of bums out for the next. Democrats have an opportunity to end that cycle, building for themselves the sort of approach that would win not only in 2026, but also serve as a building block for 2028, much as 2006 presaged 2008.

The next 10 months will be about branding Republicans in Congress as Mr. Trump’s enablers. Beyond that, we need to focus on speaking to the interests and sensibilities of those who considered or took the Faustian bargain Mr. Trump offered them last year and are uncomfortable today with all the chaos they got in return for little economic benefit.

Mr. Emanuel, a Democrat, served as a U.S. representative from Illinois (2003-09), White House chief of staff (2009-10), mayor of Chicago (2011-19) and ambassador to Japan (2022-25).

New York’s Charter Schools Live Up to Their Promise



UPWARD MOBILITY
By **Jason L. Riley**

The veteran grassroots activist Bob Woodson has long argued that policymakers would do better to spend less time focused on the social pathology in low-income communities and more on people in those same communities who have beaten the odds.

“If we see that 70% of households are raising children out of wedlock, that means 30% are not,” Mr. Woodson once told me. “We want to know what the 30% are doing right. How are they raising kids who aren’t dropping out of school or on drugs or in jail?” His advice? “Seek them out—we call them the antibodies of the community—and put a microphone on them, and say, ‘Tell us how you did this.’”

Our public school system can likewise seem indifferent toward identifying, studying and replicating successful education models. Everyone knows that there are too many substandard K-12 schools in America. A federal assessment released last

year found that only about a third of high-school seniors are prepared to handle college-level reading and math. American youngsters are also far from the top performers on international tests. Students from Japan, Hong Kong, Singapore, Finland, South Korea, Canada and elsewhere have consistently outscored their U.S. counterparts in math, reading and science.

Defenders of traditional public schools insist that kids, not schools, are the problem. They blame poor outcomes primarily on factors outside of the classroom that schools can’t control. Economic disadvantage is perhaps the most popular scapegoat. The claim is that students from low-income backgrounds, broken homes and violent neighborhoods can’t be expected to read and write at grade level.

Yet we know from decades of empirical research that public charter schools often outperform their traditional counterparts. The problem is that the American Federation of Teachers, the National Education Association and other opponents of school choice see charters as a threat—not to kids but to unions.

Because most charter-school teachers don’t belong to a union, the AFT and NEA fear that more charters will result in diminishing membership and dues. The upshot is that the education establishment is far more interested in dismissing or deriding charter schools than in learning from their success.

Detractors claim that school choice harms traditional public schools by luring away more-motivated students. But the decline in

Success Academy in the Bronx has a 90% poverty rate yet has reached a 96% proficiency rate in reading.

the quality of public education in the U.S. predates the advent of charters in the 1990s. Charter schools are being blamed for a pre-existing trend, when they should be credited for demonstrating that children from low-income families are just as capable of academic excellence as their better-off peers.

A new report published by The 74, an education news site, is typical of the type of research the education establishment prefers to ignore. A study of reading outcomes in New York state public schools that serve high concentrations of economically disadvantaged children found a disproportionate number of charter schools winning the highest marks. Charters were 9.5% of the study’s sample but “earned 38.5% of the spots on our list of exemplars.”

The 10 highest-scoring schools were located in New York City, and seven of those were charter schools in the Bronx, which is home to some of the poorest ZIP Codes in the country. “All serve a high concentration of low-income students, with 66% to 92% of children qualifying for free or reduced-price lunch,” the report noted. “And yet, 90% to 97% of their third graders were proficient readers in 2024, the year of our analysis. In comparison, the proficiency rate for all third graders across the state was just 43%.”

The report also cited traditional public schools that did significantly better than the state average in

reading scores. But the obvious takeaway is that charters are a viable model for narrowing education gaps regardless of a student’s socioeconomic background, and that opposition to school choice is especially harmful to our neediest children. The top-scoring school was a Success Academy charter school in the Bronx, where the student-body poverty rate is 90% and 94% of students scored proficient in third-grade reading in 2024. Somehow, the school managed to improve on that last year, when proficiency reached 96% in reading and 100% in math.

The response to these findings ought to be the creation of more high-performing charter schools. The demand from parents is unmistakable. A wait list in New York City runs to 163,000 students, yet lawmakers have placed an arbitrary limit on the number of charters that can operate, and Mayor Zohran Mamdani opposes lifting the cap.

The New York Post reported in December that Mr. Mamdani had rebuffed an offer to meet with charter school operators to discuss how they can work together. Maybe the mayor should talk to Bob Woodson.

I Detected My Alzheimer’s at 57—Early Enough to Intervene

By **Brent Beasley**

I worked as an internal-medicine physician for 31 years. Then, about two years ago, my supervisor called me into her office and fired me. I was forgetting instructions and struggling with technologies I had always handled with ease. She probably thought I had a substance-abuse problem. In reality, at 57, I had undiagnosed Alzheimer’s disease.

Overnight, I lost my income and employer-sponsored health insurance. My wife, Cindy, felt like she was losing her husband. Our hopes and dreams crashed down around us.

Despite my connections in medicine, it took me nearly a year to

wind through the system and get a confirmed Alzheimer’s diagnosis. A blood-based biomarker test called p-tau217 came back positive. Through a PET scan and spinal tap, I saw the sticky, abnormal plaques associated with the disease building up in my brain.

I was fortunate that we caught it early enough for my care team to act. Diagnosing Alzheimer’s early is like finding stage one cancer rather than stage four. If you catch it early, you can pursue lifestyle or medical interventions to slow the disease.

Stories like mine tend to make people think of loved ones with Alzheimer’s or their own fears of developing it. It’s an understandable concern: 1 in 5 women and 1 in 10 men 45 and older will develop

Alzheimer’s. The good news is that we now have the technologies to diagnose and treat it early. Up to 40% of dementia cases are preventable or can be delayed when caught early and treated with lifestyle changes such as exercise, good sleep and social engagement. Walking as few as 5,000 steps a day has been shown to delay markers of cognitive decline by seven years on average. For some patients, cutting-edge therapies like the anti-amyloid medicine my doctor prescribed for me can preserve cognitive health and independence.

Sadly, our healthcare system is built mostly for late-stage crisis care. Rather than routinely testing cognition in primary care, we wait for patients to reach late-stage clinical thresholds and send them to specialists with monthslong waiting periods, preventing thousands of patients from getting diagnosed and treated while it can still help. Others may live alone or in rural healthcare deserts, or be told that cognitive decline is a normal part of aging. By the time they get answers, the window for treatment has often closed. If it was difficult for me, a physician with a dedicated spouse, to get diagnosed in time, imagine how hard it can be for others.

Policymakers debate whether Alzheimer’s treatments work and are worth covering. Cindy has argued with our insurance company over these same questions when it has denied coverage for the treatment that has kept me alert and

functioning since my diagnosis.

It’s true that lifestyle interventions can be cheaper. But I was already eating healthy, exercising and drinking minimal alcohol. Yet before I began treatment, Alzheimer’s was taking hold of my body. I was a deacon in my church while battling the disease, and there were many moments after my diagnosis in which I was a fumbling mess, forgetting where I was supposed to be

The U.S. healthcare system is passive until a crisis. We should be proactive about diagnosing disease.

and what I was supposed to say in a given service. By contrast, nine months into treatment, I vividly recall a church service in which I knew exactly where I was and what I was supposed to do. Afterward, I told Cindy, “I’m back.” She smiled and said, “I could tell.”

There may be another lifestyle or medical intervention that works better for another patient. But even if a miracle one-size-fits-all Alzheimer’s therapy were approved tomorrow, the same dangerous barriers would remain: People are diagnosed too late, they can’t afford the tests or treatments, and they can’t get access to care in time.

To change the trajectory of the disease for our children and grandchildren, we must make early Alzheimer’s

Alzheimer’s detection a national priority. That means expanding access to blood-based tests like p-tau217 so that patients can be diagnosed before their brains are permanently damaged. It means ensuring that once someone qualifies for a U.S. Food and Drug Administration-approved anti-amyloid therapy, insurance rules don’t stand in the way. It means empowering primary-care doctors—the clinicians most people see—to detect Alzheimer’s early and guide families through treatment and lifestyle options rather than referring them to specialists with yearlong wait times.

We must also support caregiver planning so that families have the tools and resources to care for loved ones at home as long as possible. Cindy made it possible for me to get treatment, stay organized and keep living my life. Families need support if we want people with Alzheimer’s to remain at home, engaged and independent.

An Alzheimer’s diagnosis doesn’t have to be the devastating blow that it once was. I’m more than two years beyond my diagnosis and living a joyful, purposeful life. We now have the science to help patients like me stay cognitively healthy and engaged. But without a national effort to ensure the disease is diagnosed and treated early, those breakthroughs will never reach the people who need them most.

Dr. Beasley is a retired internal medicine physician living in Kansas City, Mo.

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SPORTS



point because he could absorb the wisdom of coach Kyle Shanahan, one of the game’s foremost offensive playcallers.

“It was huge,” Darnold said last year. “I learned so much.”

From there, he moved on to Minnesota, where he secured the starting gig once first-rounder J.J. McCarthy tore up his knee. Darnold didn’t waste the opportunity: He finished the season in the top five in passing yardage and touchdown throws while leading the Vikings to a 14-3 record.

Yet the ugly finish only magnified skepticism about his performance. Some chalked up his play as a mere byproduct of playing under Kevin O’Connell, another highly regarded offensive coach, and having one of the game’s best wideouts, Justin Jefferson.

When Seattle staked its future on Darnold, however, it meant tearing up a relatively successful blueprint. Geno Smith had been the team’s quarterback for three years and led them to three winning sea-

\$33.5M

Darnold’s salary ranked 18th among NFL quarterbacks according to Spotrac

NFL’s Best Free-Agent Bargain

Sam Darnold went through four NFL franchises before the Seahawks took a chance on him

By Andrew Beaton

San Francisco

Quarterback Sam Darnold was wrapping up the season of a lifetime for the Minnesota Vikings, finally making good on his potential as a top draft pick, when it suddenly crashed and burned.

In the 2024 regular season finale against the Lions, with a No. 1 playoff seed on the line, Darnold turned in one of the worst games of his career. A week later, he wasn’t much better as the Vikings quickly bowed out of the playoffs against the Los Angeles Rams, managing only nine points for the second consecutive game.

And so, a season that seemed like his long-awaited star turn ended with an all too familiar question: Is Sam Darnold actually any good?

As doubts hovered over him, the Seattle Seahawks saw none of the downside. Instead, they felt it was a rare chance to acquire an elite passer in his prime—and at a discount. In the era of the \$60-million-a-year quarterback, Darnold cost Seattle barely half of that. And the quality of his play since then has made the Seahawks look like geniuses.

Dollar-for-dollar, he is one of the most valuable players in the entire sport and now one win over the New England Patriots away from leading the franchise to its second Super Bowl victory.

“He just shut a lot of people



up,” Seahawks coach Mike Macdonald said after Darnold threw three touchdowns in their NFC Championship win over the Rams.

Darnold’s circuitous journey holds key lessons for teams across football. At a time when anyone could have signed him in free agency, the Seahawks were the ones willing to stomach some downside risk, dump their incumbent quarterback and bet on Darnold’s upside. In one move, they got

younger, cheaper and better at the most important position in football.

And Darnold himself is proof that there can be second acts in the NFL. Even a player who is quickly labeled a failure can take years to find the right situation and hit his stride. In Darnold’s case, he didn’t break out until playing on his fourth and fifth teams in Minnesota and Seattle. When the Vikings made the mistake of letting him walk out the door, he turned into

In the era of the \$60-million-a-year quarterback, Sam Darnold cost Seattle barely half of that after his Vikings stint ended with a thud.

the Seahawks’ next franchise quarterback.

“With quarterbacks, sometimes it’s about the right timing, the right environment and the right people that are around you,” said Clay Helton, who coached Darnold at USC and is now at Georgia Southern. “Sometimes you need time to grow in that league and you don’t get that opportunity—you’re forced into the fire really quick.”

In Darnold’s case, that fire was the dumpster blaze known as the New York Jets. They selected him at third overall in the 2018 draft, and Darnold not only arrived in a dysfunctional organization, he was also abnormally young on draft day at just 20 years old. (The No. 1 pick two years later, Joe Burrow, is actually older than Darnold.) So if any player was going to need a longer development timeline, Darnold was a prime candidate.

But the Jets traded him away after three seasons that were mostly remembered for a bout of mononucleosis and his being caught by a microphone saying that he was “seeing ghosts” in a particularly bad loss. His jersey might as well have read “bust” on the back.

That’s how he landed in Carolina for two forgettable years. He then latched on as a backup in 2023 with the San Francisco 49ers, which he points to as a turning

sons. The problem was that the Smith era produced zero playoff wins.

Still, trading away Smith and signing Darnold was an unusual gamble. Macdonald and general manager John Schneider were willing to give up the comfort of stability for a more volatile outcome.

“They’re willing to make moves that maybe might be looked at from the outside as something that’s different,” said quarterback coach Andrew Janocko. “Those guys had a vision for this organization and what it was going to take to get us to the next level.”

It proved to be a stroke of genius in two ways. Seattle cashed in Smith for a draft pick, and he then struggled with the Las Vegas Raiders on a new contract that costs more annually than Darnold’s. And when Darnold thrived, it meant they had locked in a top quarterback on a relatively cheap \$33.5 million a year deal. There are now 11 quarterbacks on contracts that pay more than \$50 million annually.

By the end of the season, Darnold was just the second quarterback in NFL history to win 14 games in consecutive seasons. The other is someone Patriots fans know a thing or two about. His name is Tom Brady.

And unlike last year’s 14-win campaign, when Darnold floundered down the stretch, he capped this one with the biggest performance of his life in the NFC Championship win. Now he’s just one game away from the ultimate football accolade.

No longer a disappointment or rehabilitation project, Darnold would simply be a Super Bowl winning quarterback.

NBA Players Are Flocking Back to College

By Laine Higgins

IT HAD BEEN 1,037 days since Charles Bediako last pulled on an Alabama basketball jersey. In the interim, he entered the 2023 NBA Draft, signed a two-way deal with the San Antonio Spurs and spent three seasons toiling away in the G League. He did everything a professional basketball player might do short of logging minutes in an actual NBA game.

Yet on Jan. 24, the 23-year-old was back in school, wearing a white Alabama top and throwing down dunks against Tennessee. And somehow, this was all perfectly legal—even if it might not be for long.

Bediako’s strange trip from Tuscaloosa, Ala. to the NBA and back—where he encounters chants of “G League dropout”—is the latest sign that the line that once separated unpaid undergraduates from the pros is eroding beyond recognition. The result is widespread confusion that has coaches scratching their heads and urgently calling for clarity.

“First of all, the systems are broken and I’m all for figuring out a way to fix it,” said Alabama coach Nate Oats last week. “But for now we’re going to continue to

support Charles.”

In the past, college basketball players would forgo their remaining NCAA eligibility the moment they entered the NBA Draft, even if they wound up without a team. The NCAA softened its stance a decade ago and dozens of players have tested the draft waters and participated in the NBA Draft Combine before ultimately withdrawing to go back to college.

The difference for Bediako was that, unlike the scores of undrafted players before him, he actually signed an NBA contract in October 2023. That is one of the last remaining red lines that the NCAA does not want to cross.

So it took a lawsuit for Bediako to earn his improbable return to school. After years of toiling away for the Austin Spurs, Grand Rapids Gold and Motor City Cruise—all in the NBA’s developmental league—the 7-footer petitioned the NCAA to allow him to go back to college. His lawyer argued that he should be able to rejoin the Crimson Tide because he was within the NCAA’s five-year window for athletic eligibility and had not appeared in a professional game.

The NCAA disagreed.

“The NCAA has not and will not grant eligibility to any players who have signed an NBA contract,” NCAA senior vice president of external affairs Tim Buckley wrote.

After the NCAA denied Bediako’s request, he sued the association in Tuscaloosa County Circuit Court on Jan. 20. A day later, a judge had granted him a temporary restraining order that allowed him to play immediately.

“We’re going to follow the court orders,” Oats said. “We’ve got a roster spot open, so this is not taking any opportunities away from a high school recruit or anybody else.”

Coincidentally, the judge overseeing Bediako’s case, Judge James H. Roberts Jr., happens to be a major Alabama donor. According to the website of the university’s athletics foundation, the lifetime donations by Roberts and his wife fall between \$100,000 and \$249,000.

Although Roberts has said that he remains impartial, he stepped back after the NCAA requested that he recuse himself from the case due to the “appearance of partiality.”

This isn’t the only twist in Bediako’s case, however. The hearing that was sup-

posed to take place on Jan. 27 was postponed because the lawyer representing the NCAA was snowed in by the recent blizzard in Tennessee.

That means Bediako is free to play until the rescheduled hearing on Feb. 6. That span included Sunday’s game against Florida, the defending national champions, and a Wednesday meeting with Texas A&M, the team currently atop the SEC standings.

Bediako is not the first player with professional experience to rematriculate in college this season. James Nnaji joined the Baylor squad in December despite previously playing professionally in Europe and being selected in the second round of the 2023 NBA Draft by the Detroit Pistons. Others have done so at Louisville and Santa Clara.

And Bediako’s return seems to have emboldened others. Amari Bailey was drafted out of UCLA in the same year as Nnaji, signed the same type of professional contract as Bediako and appeared in 10 games for the Charlotte Hornets. Over the weekend, the 21-year-old announced plans to sue the NCAA for another year of eligibility.

None of the players who



Charles Bediako is back at Alabama after leaving in 2023.

took a detour to the pros have been as impactful to their teams as Bediako, though. In his three appearances for Alabama, he’s averaging 11 points and 5.3 rebounds while averaging 22 minutes.

“The reality is I don’t agree with it, and I don’t think he should be playing,” Gators coach Todd Golden said last week. “If he plays, we’ll beat them anyways.”

Golden was right: Florida won 100-77.

Walmart Reaches \$1 Trillion Value

Stock gain puts the retail giant in select group mostly made up of tech companies

By SARAH NASSAUER

Retail behemoth Walmart has hit a market capitalization of \$1 trillion, becoming the first traditional retailer to reach the milestone. The achievement places Walmart among a small but

growing club of companies that have a 13-figure valuation, including Amazon.com, Nvidia, Meta Platforms and Microsoft.

In trading on Tuesday morning, Walmart stock passed the \$125.47 a share needed to reach a trillion-dollar valuation. Shares closed up 2.9% at \$127.71, giving the company a market cap of \$1.018 trillion.

Walmart's stock has surged in recent months, fueled in part by Wall Street's enthusi-

asm for the growth of the company's online business as well as its investments in automation and artificial-intelligence technology aimed at improving efficiency.

Sales also have ballooned as more shoppers have turned to Walmart for low prices, fast delivery and broad selection.

The change at Walmart over the past decade, culminating with its trillion-dollar valuation, "has been as profound a shift at a retail company that we have ever seen," said Sim-

eon Gutman, retail analyst at Morgan Stanley, who has studied Walmart since 2001.

Walmart's growth, along with Amazon's, creates a challenge for competitors, he said. Meanwhile, the Bentonville, Ark.-based company will have to navigate the ascension of a new chief, as longtime executive John Furner took the helm this month.

Most of the 11 companies that at any point reached a \$1 trillion valuation are technology-focused, though investment

firm Berkshire Hathaway joined the group in 2024. Drug-maker Eli Lilly crossed the mark in November before its valuation slipped to \$949 billion.

A decade ago, some Walmart investors didn't see the company's success as a sure thing. Rival Amazon was growing fast, and then-new Walmart CEO Doug McMillon was investing billions to raise worker pay, clean up stores and grow online. Investors Please turn to page B7

Musk's X Office in Paris Is Raided by Prosecutors

By SAM SCHECHNER AND KIM MACKRAEL

PARIS—French authorities raided the Paris office of Elon Musk's X and summoned the billionaire for an interview, a major escalation of European regulators' battles with the social-media platform.

Cybercrime prosecutors said Tuesday that they were searching X's office as part of a sprawling investigation first opened early last year. The probe initially focused on alleged bias in X's content algorithm but has since expanded to examine the platform's responsibility for sexualized deepfake images produced by its Grok chatbot.

French officials are also investigating other potential charges against X, including dissemination of child pornography and Holocaust denial, which is illegal in France, prosecutors said.

The raid came as French officials said they summoned Musk, former X Chief Executive Linda Yaccarino and other employees for what they described as voluntary interviews in April.

Prosecutors described their investigation as being at a "constructive" stage, aimed at achieving compliance with laws in France. Voluntary interviews would be a chance for executives to explain their efforts, they added.

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The Cincinnati Reds and Kansas City Royals, seen during a game last year, are among the growing number of teams joining with MLB as a TV-rights partner.

Some Baseball Teams Still Hunt for a TV Home

By JARED DIAMOND AND ISABELLA SIMONETTI

At least six more Major League Baseball teams just locked in a new partner for televising their games: the league itself.

The Cincinnati Reds, Kansas City Royals, Miami Marlins, Milwaukee Brewers, St. Louis Cardinals and Tampa Bay Rays until recently had broadcast deals with Main

Street Sports Group. But that company began missing payments to franchises over the winter, and despite earlier talks with British media company DAZN, it hasn't successfully found a buyer or new financing.

With spring training days away, teams rushed to find a way to earn revenue from local game broadcasts. While regional sports networks guaranteed rights payments, MLB's

structure is different. Teams have taken revenue haircuts in local media of more than 30% after switching to MLB, according to people familiar with the financials.

By opening day, MLB's in-house production and distribution division could be handling local coverage for half of the league's 30 franchises. Less than three years ago, all of them had deals with regional sports networks, dem-

onstrating just how quickly the sport's economic landscape is changing.

The Atlanta Braves, Detroit Tigers and Los Angeles Angels have yet to announce their TV plans for 2026. The Tigers and Angels could still join up with MLB Local Media, which doesn't guarantee set rights fees in advance. The Braves said Monday that they are "well on our way towards launching a new era in Braves

broadcasting." This could involve starting their own network, people familiar with the matter said.

"Our focus, particularly given the point in the calendar, is to maximize the revenue that's available to the clubs," MLB commissioner Rob Manfred said last month. He added that games will be available to fans in all local markets, whether with MLB or Please turn to page B2

Google Bets Big on Race for AI Energy

By KATHERINE BLUNT

Google plans to spend \$4.75 billion to help solve a problem stymieing the artificial-intelligence race: finding enough electricity to run an ever-larger fleet of data centers.

The company's pending deal to buy Intersect, a wind and solar developer, would make it the only tech giant to own a power company. That could give it a significant advantage over rivals as power officials favor tech companies prepared to bring their own electricity sources online and the Trump administration presses them to avoid passing on power costs to consumers.

The deal is the latest in a series of bets Google has made to develop a soup-to-nuts strategy for accessing vast amounts of power. Among its competitors, Google was first to strike deals to develop advanced nuclear and geothermal plants designed to operate constantly. It was first to experiment with how it can reduce data-center power use during times of strain on the grid.

And with the acquisition of Intersect, Alphabet will be the first to incorporate within its business the means to build

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INSIDE



TECHNOLOGY

PayPal replaces its CEO as the payments company sounds a profit warning. B2

HEARD ON THE STREET

How to buy gold and silver at a discount. B13

The Chips Are Down: PepsiCo to Cut Snack Prices After Outcry

By LAURA COOPER AND JESSE NEWMAN

PepsiCo is looking to cut prices by as much as 15% on products including Lay's potato chips and Flamin' Hot Cheetos.

The beverage-and-snack company is making the cuts after receiving a flood of emails and voicemail messages from shoppers complaining that high prices were making it hard to buy the company's snacks.

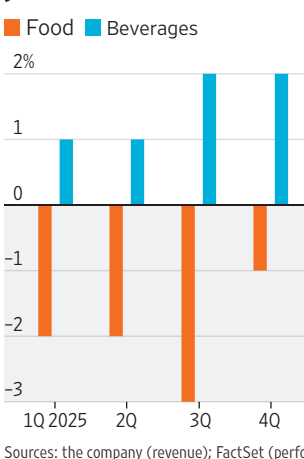
"Consumers told us they need more value," said Rachel

Ferdinando, chief executive of PepsiCo's U.S. food business.

Higher food prices have become an object of ire among consumers. In the wake of the Covid-19 pandemic, food companies steadily increased prices on a range of items. The snack aisles were a particular target for large food makers that bet consumers would remain loyal to their brands.

Retail prices for salty snacks were about 38% higher in June 2024 than they were in 2020, according to a 2024 report by Jefferies analysts.

PepsiCo organic revenue in North America, change from a year earlier

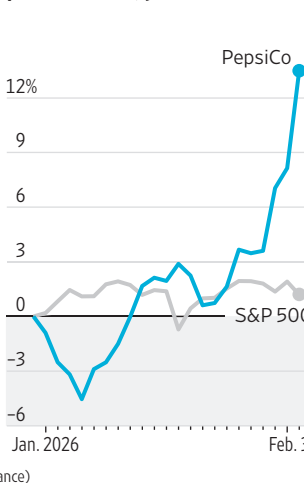


Sources: the company (revenue); FactSet (performance)

To save money, many shoppers have shifted to buying less expensive private-label or store brands.

PepsiCo executives said the company's snack prices rose as overall inflation climbed

Share-price and index performance, year-to-date



and the costs to make products increased. But sales growth has since slowed.

"It became a little more expensive than we would like it to be," said PepsiCo CEO Ra-

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BP Investors Want Assurance on Shift

By ADAM WHITTAKER

BP needs to demonstrate that higher spending on oil-and-gas production will deliver value for shareholders, a group of investors in the energy major said Tuesday.

BP is funneling investments into its traditional fossil-fuel business after a move into renewable sources of energy hit profits and led to multibillion-dollar write-downs. The company reset its strategy in February of last year, has cut costs and changed its leadership team in a bid to regain investor confidence that it can spend wisely and deliver higher returns.

A shareholder resolution filed by U.K. and European pension funds, along with activist investor Australasian Centre for Corporate Responsibility, said the reset strategy and renewed focus on oil and gas doesn't address the root cause of BP's underperformance.

The co-filers, including the Greater Manchester Pension Fund, Nest and more than 100 individual shareholders, represent 0.42% of BP's share capital. Their total stake was valued at more than \$400 million as of Tuesday, according to LSEG data.

The investors called on BP to take a more-disciplined approach to capital expenditure and to offer more-detailed disclosure that would allow investors "to better assess whether and how the company's investment decision-making promotes disciplined capital allocation."

A representative for BP declined to comment.

Under its new strategy, BP is increasing oil-and-gas investment to around \$10 billion a year for 2025 to 2027. This is 20% higher than previous guidance, and BP expects re-

turns of greater than 15% on these projects.

BP should better disclose how it assesses cost-competitiveness for each project and how it accounts for cost-overruns, and should explain how investment in exploration creates value for shareholders, the group said. The disclosures should be made no later than next year's annual meeting of shareholders, the group said.

"Enhanced disclosures will give BP's investors the insights they need to assess whether the company's plans to increase upstream investments is a value-accretive strategy for them," the group said.

In a second-quarter earnings call, BP's production and operations lead Gordon Birrell said the company wasn't just "throwing money" at exploration projects, and that it was forcing teams to select the best prospects to pursue.

In December, when outsider Meg O'Neill was named as BP's next chief executive, the group's chairman, Albert Manifold, touted her financial discipline, and said "increased rigor and diligence" were needed for the company to maximize value for shareholders.

BP's capital-allocation credibility has been severely impaired by its expensive missteps over the past decade and it needs to show investors how it has changed the decision-making processes that led to sustained and significant write-downs, Barclays analyst Lydia Rainforth wrote recently.

However, the company's finance chief Kate Thomson has taken a far more disciplined approach to spending over the past year, Rainforth added.

BP said in January it would write down the value of its gas and low-carbon energy division by up to \$5 billion.

ounce bag of Doritos would fall about 80 cents to \$5.49.

New packaging will advertise that the snacks are the same size but at a lower price.

The moves come after PepsiCo in December struck an agreement with activist investor Elliott Investment Management, a deal in which it pledged to improve the performance of its roughly \$27 billion North American food business.

The company said the affordability push is just one part of a strategy to accelerate growth. PepsiCo recently relaunched its Lay's brand without artificial colors and flavors.

Ferdinando, who took the reins of the U.S. food division

BUSINESS & FINANCE

PayPal Swaps CEO, Warns on Profit

By KATHERINE HAMILTON AND CONNOR HART

PayPal replaced its chief executive officer, saying its board decided "the pace of change and execution was not in line" with expectations and sending the payments company's shares tumbling.

The company said Tuesday that Alex Chriss would step down as CEO, and selected former HP CEO Enrique Lores to be its next leader, effective March 1.

PayPal separately said it is expecting earnings to decline in 2026 after growth from its key branded checkout product, which lets customers use PayPal when making online purchases, sputtered in the fourth quarter.

Shares finished Tuesday's trading down 20% at \$41.70.

The stock has lost more than half of its value over the past year.

Jamie Miller—PayPal's current chief financial and operating officer, who will serve as interim CEO during the transition—said on a call with analysts that weaker-than-expected performance across branded checkout stemmed from macroeconomic challenges and poor internal execution.

U.S. retail trends continue to be weak, especially among lower- and middle-income consumers. "While part of this can be attributed to macrofactors and a K-shaped economy, it is also clear that we need to do more to win with key merchants," she said.

PayPal's customer base



Enrique Lores will become PayPal CEO effective March 1.

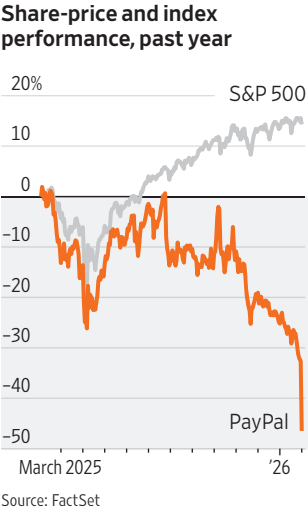
skews toward middle- to lower-income levels, Susquehanna analyst James Friedman said in a note.

That makes the San Jose, Calif., company more exposed to shifts in consumer sentiment, including the pullback in discretionary spending in 2025.

Branded checkout was additionally hurt by international headwinds and a slowdown across previously high-growth verticals such as travel, Miller said. Internally, operational and deployment issues further pressured performance.

"The reality is our merchants, especially the largest ones, have many competing priorities and require much more hands-on integration support than we anticipated," she said. "So while challenges in the macroenvironment are real, we haven't executed as well as we need to."

Payment-volume growth in



Source: FactSet

branded checkout slowed to 1% during the recent quarter, compared with 6% the year before.

Branded checkout is among PayPal's highest-margin businesses and is considered by Wall Street to be an important indicator of the company's strength.

In recent years, management has been trying to add revenue streams so the company isn't as reliant on branded checkout.

As part of those efforts to diversify, PayPal is pushing its debit card and trying to make the payment-transfer app Venmo more profitable. In the fourth quarter, Venmo's total payment volume growth increased 3 percentage points year over year to 13%.

PayPal also is stepping up investments across its business, including branded checkout, online shopping via artificial-intelligence agents,

and buy now, pay later. Increasing investments could weigh on margins in the year ahead, Friedman said.

Separately, PayPal guided for earnings per share to decrease by a mid-single-digit percentage in the current quarter and the full fiscal year. Analysts were anticipating a 3% increase in the quarter and an 8% increase for the full year, according to FactSet.

In the fourth quarter ended Dec. 31, PayPal's profit was \$1.44 billion, or \$1.53 a share, compared with \$1.12 billion, or \$1.11 a share, a year earlier.

Stripping out certain one-time items, adjusted per-share earnings were \$1.23, below the \$1.29 anticipated by analysts, according to FactSet.

Revenue rose 4% to \$8.68 billion. Analysts surveyed by FactSet forecast revenue of \$8.79 billion.

Some MLB Teams Hunt A TV Home

Continued from page B1 elsewhere.

Teams were close to this crisis point before. Main Street faced earlier financial challenges and emerged from bankruptcy at the beginning of last year. At the time, MLB was cautiously optimistic that the worst had passed. As recently as November, teams including the Reds and Royals announced extensions of contractual options to keep their local television rights with Main Street, which operates channels branded as FanDuel Sports Network.

But in recent weeks, the situation devolved. Main Street missed some payments, prompting all nine of its MLB franchise partners to terminate their deals and start weighing other options.

In addition to baseball, Main Street controls the TV rights for 13 NBA and seven NHL teams. The company is expected to continue airing their games through the end of those leagues' seasons.

"We appreciate the leagues' engagement in ongoing discussions on our go-forward plans," a Main Street spokesperson said. "We appreciate the relationships we have had with these MLB partners and fans over many years, and we wish them the best."

MLB teams traditionally have derived 20% to 25% of their overall revenue from local media, more than any other major American sports league. Now that money spigot is drying up, especially in smaller markets, as more consumers drop the cable bundles that long fueled the



The repeat world champion Los Angeles Dodgers boast a TV deal paying \$330 million a year.

sports economy.

"These local games' value is evolving, and it's evolving down," said sports media consultant Patrick Crakes, who has advised on regional sports networks and local media rights.

That evolution has spurred a widening revenue gap among major league teams, in turn affecting competition on the field.

The Los Angeles Dodgers have a local TV deal that pays them an average of about \$330 million annually until 2038. Some of their counterparts are making a 10th of that.

The Dodgers won their second consecutive World Series last year with a star-studded roster that cost more than a half-billion dollars between payroll and luxury tax payments for those high sala-

ries. The Marlins, meanwhile, had a payroll of around \$70 million and finished with a losing record.

Moving to MLB Local Media adds more uncertainty for small-market teams. Regional sports networks guaranteed payments regardless of how many people actually watched games.

But MLB offers what it describes as an "eat what you kill" model, whereby teams' cuts depend on how much is brought in from sources including streaming subscriptions, individual distribution deals with linear TV providers and advertising. In many cases, player payrolls for teams that made the switch to MLB dropped alongside their revenue.

The San Diego Padres made the jump to MLB for local games after Diamond Sports

Group—Main Street's pre-bankruptcy name—missed a scheduled rights payment during the 2023 season. The Arizona Diamondbacks followed not long after. The Colorado Rockies, Cleveland Guardians and Minnesota Twins joined MLB in 2024 and 2025, while the Seattle Mariners and Washington Nationals were signed on for 2026.

Manfred wants to centralize local TV rights for all 30 teams and sell them as a package, which he says could provide a long-term solution to MLB's media problem. He hopes to do this after the 2028 season, when MLB's national TV contracts expire. It would involve persuading the big-market teams still benefiting from their local TV deals, such as the Dodgers, to surrender control of those rights to MLB.

PepsiCo to Cut Prices On Snacks

Continued from page B1

mon Laguarta. Retailers set prices, not PepsiCo. Yet the company is making suggestions, which executives expect retailers will follow as a way to reach price-strapped consumers.

Under the suggested changes, an 8-ounce bag of Lay's classic potato chips could fall in price to \$4.29 from \$4.99. The suggested retail price for a roughly 9.25-



PepsiCo plans to cut prices by as much as 15% on Lay's chips.

last year, said PepsiCo is able to adjust prices—and fund affordability initiatives—by finding cost savings within the company. PepsiCo has closed three manufacturing plants and cut several product lines.

In the latest quarter PepsiCo's business showed some signs of improvement. Adjusted revenue in its North America food business declined 1% from the prior year. The company said Tuesday that U.S. savory and salty re-

tail sales have accelerated.

Other parts of PepsiCo, including its beverage business, showed stronger growth in revenue and profitability in the three months ended Dec. 27.

Executives also said that PepsiCo will boost marketing for brands including Lay's, Tostitos, Gatorade and Quaker, with a focus on simpler ingredients. A new slate of products focused on protein, fiber and hydration will also be introduced.

Other food companies have been lowering their prices in a bid to win back consumers.

General Mills last year cut prices across roughly two-thirds of its North America grocery products, including goods like Pillsbury refriger-

ated dough, fruit snacks and Progresso soup.

The company said in December that lower prices were helping drive sales, though they had also squeezed profitability.

TD Cowen analyst Rob Moskow said price cuts have so far failed to fully stabilize sales volume declines at big food companies. Prices still remain too high, he said, even though companies last year refrained from passing on all of their higher costs for commodities like coffee, cocoa, dairy and beef.

"That is cold comfort for a consumer who has been struggling with four years of exorbitant cumulative inflation and is looking for relief," Moskow said.

BUSINESS NEWS

Novo Nordisk Forecasts Sales Drop

Shares tumble as Danish drugmaker says sales could drop as much as 13%

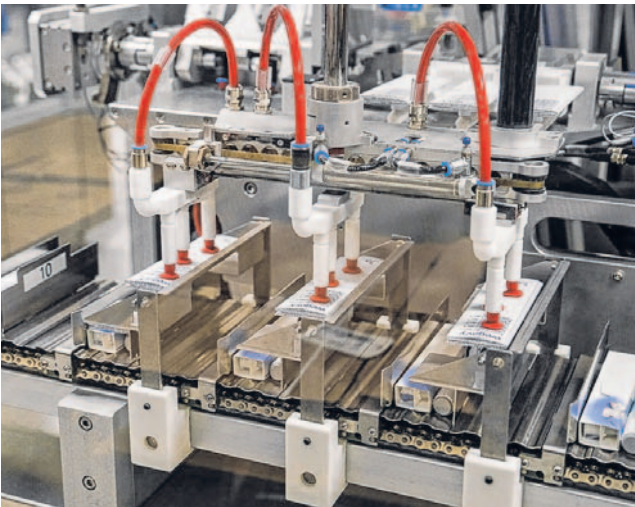
By Mauro Orru

Novo Nordisk said it expects lower sales this year as the Danish drugmaker takes stock of lower prices for weight-loss medicines Ozempic and Wegovy in the U.S.

The group said adjusted sales should decline between 5% and 13% at constant exchange rates in 2026, a reversal from last year, when sales grew 10% to 309.06 billion Danish kroner, equivalent to \$48.9 billion.

In the U.S., the company's shares dropped 14.6%.

Late last year, Novo Nordisk said it would lower U.S. cash prices of semaglutide, which it sells as Ozempic and Rybelsus for Type 2 diabetes and Wegovy for weight loss, for existing self-pay patients to \$349 a month. The company reached a



Competition is strong in the diabetes and obesity drugs markets.

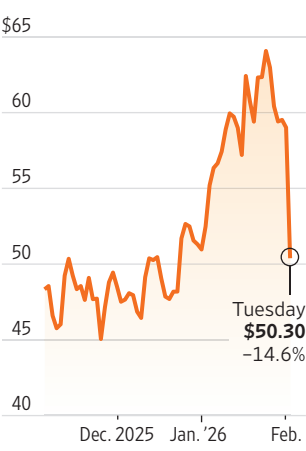
deal with the Trump administration to sell the drugs to Medicare for \$245 a month, with patients paying \$50 copays.

Novo Nordisk is forecasting higher sales internationally as it continues to roll out Wegovy in more markets. However, U.S. sales are projected to decline as the group faces intense com-

petition in the diabetes and obesity markets from the likes of **Eli Lilly**, aside from reduced obesity medication coverage in Medicaid and lower drug prices as part of a policy known as "most favored nation," or MFN.

The group said it had opted to present its guidance with adjustments for sales and operating profit as of this year to

Novo Nordisk ADRs, past three months



Source: FactSet

exclude certain exceptional and nonrecurring effects. This year's guidance excludes \$4.2 billion in provision reversals related to the 340B Drug Pricing Program, which allows hospitals that care for many uninsured and low-income patients to purchase outpatient medicines at steep discounts.

Novo Nordisk said its ad-

justed operating profit should decline by 5% to 13% at constant exchange rates this year, the same range it guided for adjusted sales. The company reported 6% growth in 2025 operating profit to 127.66 billion Danish kroner. It attributed the projected decline to its sales outlook and investments in research and development and commercial operations.

The group is pushing R&D and commercial investments to expand its early and late-stage pipeline of treatments within obesity and diabetes and further develop its GLP-1 portfolio.

Net profit grew 1% last year to 102.43 billion Danish kroner. The company said it would propose a final dividend of 7.95 kroner per share for 2025 at its coming annual general meeting, taking the expected total dividend for last year to 11.70 kroner.

Meanwhile, the group also said it would launch a new share repurchase program of up to 15 billion kroner in the first quarter.

Merck Sees Earnings Growth Slowing

By Katherine Hamilton

Merck recorded higher revenue in its fourth quarter, but expects earnings growth to slow as it ramps up acquisitions.

The healthcare company on Tuesday posted a profit of \$2.96 billion, or \$1.19 a share, in the fourth quarter, compared with \$3.74 billion, or \$1.48 a share, a year earlier.

Stripping out certain one-time items, adjusted per-share earnings were \$2.04, ahead of the \$2.01 anticipated by analysts, according to FactSet.

Revenue rose 5% to \$16.4 billion, beating analysts' expectations of \$16.2 billion.

Merck said sales were driven by growth in its oncology business, as well as cardiometabolic and respiratory, despite a decline in vaccines.

Revenue from Keytruda rose 7% to \$8.37 billion in the quarter, driven by an increased uptake in earlier-stage indications of the cancer immunotherapy. Sales of HPV vaccine Gardasil fell 34% to \$1.03 billion due to lower demand in China and lower sales in Japan.

In 2026, Merck expects revenue of \$65.5 billion to \$67 billion. Adjusted earnings per share are guided to be \$5 to \$5.15, down from \$8.98 a share in 2025. Analysts were projecting \$67.44 billion in annual sales and \$5.27 in adjusted earnings per share.

Merck said its adjusted earnings forecast includes a one-time charge of about \$9 billion related to the acquisition of the antiviral maker Cidara.

Merck announced several merger deals last year as it braces for Keytruda to lose the protection of its main U.S. patent. The patent expires in 2028, opening the door for lower-cost versions to compete with one of Merck's biggest revenue drivers.

Lower Demand for Covid-19 Drugs Hits Pfizer

By Nicholas G. Miller

Pfizer reported lower fourth-quarter sales as demand for its Covid-19 vaccine and antiviral drug continued to decline.

The drugmaker reported a loss of \$1.65 billion, or 29 cents a share, compared with a profit of \$410 million, or 7 cents a share, the year prior.

Adjusted earnings were 66 cents a share. Analysts polled by FactSet expected 57 cents a share.

Sales fell 1% to \$17.56 billion. Wall Street expected \$16.85 billion.

The company reiterated its forecast for 2026 adjusted earnings of \$2.80 to \$3 a share and revenue of \$59.5 bil-

lion to \$62.5 billion. Analysts see 2026 adjusted earnings of \$2.97 a share and sales of \$60.97 billion.

The company said the top-line decline was driven by lower Covid-19 infection rates, which hurt demand for its Paxlovid antiviral, and narrower Covid-19 vaccine recommendations, which reduced the eligible population for its Comirnaty vaccine.

Comirnaty fourth-quarter revenue was down 35% while Paxlovid revenue declined 70%.

Demand for Pfizer's Covid-19 pharmaceuticals has fallen precipitously since the peak of the pandemic and the company has been looking for new drugs to make up for the



The drugmaker posted a \$1.65 billion fourth-quarter loss.

drop-off in sales.

The company said in December it expects 2026 revenue from its Covid-19 products to be about \$1.5 billion

lower than in 2025, and sees a year-over-year revenue hit of \$1.5 billion because of the loss of exclusivity of certain products.

BUSINESS WATCH



Orsted's Revolution Wind project, seen under construction in Connecticut in 2024.

ORSTED

Europe Onshore Unit to Be Sold

Orsted agreed to sell its European onshore business in a \$1.7 billion deal, a day after a U.S. judge ruled that the renewable-energy company could resume work at its Sunrise Wind project off New York's coast.

The Trump administration ordered a halt to construction of five U.S. offshore wind projects just before Christmas, including the company's Revolution Wind and Sunrise Wind projects, citing national security risks. Sunrise Wind is around 45% complete.

—Dominic Chopping

ADVANCED MICRO DEVICES

Data Centers Boost Sales

Advanced Micro Devices recorded a jump in fourth-quarter sales as its data-center business boomed.

The chip maker posted a profit of \$1.51 billion, or 92 cents a share, for the quarter ended in late December, compared with \$482 million, or 29 cents a share, a year earlier. Stripping out certain one-time items, adjusted per-share earnings were \$1.53, ahead of the \$1.32 anticipated by analysts, according to FactSet. Revenue rose 34%, to \$10.27 billion.

—Katherine Hamilton

MONDELEZ

Cost of Cocoa Cuts Into Profit

Mondelez International posted lower profit for its latest quarter as it contended with higher cocoa costs.

The owner of Oreo and Cadbury posted a profit of \$665 million, or 51 cents a share, compared with \$1.75 billion, or \$1.30 a share, a year earlier. Adjusted earnings per share were 72 cents, ahead of estimates of 70 cents a share, according to analysts polled by FactSet. Revenue rose 9.3% to \$10.5 billion, topping analyst estimates of \$10.31 billion.

—Kelly Cloonan

ARCHER DANIELS MIDLAND Profit, Revenue Fall In Latest Quarter

Archer Daniels Midland logged lower fourth-quarter profit and revenue, hurt by a challenging operating environment marked by trade and policy uncertainty.

The processor of agricultural commodities like oilseeds, corn and wheat on Tuesday posted a profit of \$456 million, or 94 cents a share, compared with \$567 million, or \$1.17 a share, a year earlier. Stripping out certain one-time items, earnings were 87 cents a share.

—Connor Hart

ELECTRONIC ARTS

Earnings Decline Despite Sales Rise

Electronic Arts logged lower profit in its fiscal third quarter despite a slight uptick in revenue, driven by what it called record net bookings.

The videogame maker posted a profit of \$88 million, or 35 cents a share, for its three months ended Dec. 31, down from \$293 million, or \$1.11 a share, a year earlier. Revenue ticked 1% higher to \$1.9 billion.

EA had previously forecast per-share earnings of \$3.09 to \$3.79.

—Connor Hart

ASTRAZENECA

FDA Rejects Lupus Drug Application

AstraZeneca said the U.S. Food and Drug Administration rejected an initial submission for its Saphnelo lupus drug in injection form, and vowed to work with the regulator to move forward with an updated application.

The U.K. pharmaceutical company said Tuesday that the FDA issued a complete response letter, which indicates that a new drug application can't be approved in its present form, regarding Saphnelo for subcutaneous administration.

—Adrià Calatayud

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Nintendo Backs Annual Forecasts

Videogame maker upholds outlooks for Switch 2, profit amid effort to diversify

By KOSAKU NARIOKA

Nintendo maintained its annual forecasts for Switch 2 sales and net profit even as it reported sharply higher nine-month results, boosted by the gaming device's popularity.

The Japanese videogame maker started selling the console in June, aiming to build on the success of its predecessor, whose popularity was amplified by a pandemic-driven videogame boom.

U.S. market-research firm Circana said in January that Switch 2 was the bestselling game console in the U.S. by both volume and value in December and the year overall, beating its main competitor, **Sony Group's** PlayStation 5.

The new device, which retails for about \$450 in the U.S., features a larger, more responsive screen with enhanced graphics performance.

Nintendo on Tuesday said it continues to expect to sell 19 million Switch 2 consoles by the end of March. It reiterated guidance for net profit to climb 25.5% to ¥350 billion, equivalent to \$2.25 billion, for the year ending March.

The company's projections appear conservative given its strong performance. Net profit for the nine months ended December rose 51% from a year earlier to ¥358.86 billion, exceeding the full-year forecast, as revenue nearly doubled to ¥1.906 trillion.

The outlook also implies 1.6 million Switch 2 sales from January to March, given the 17.4 million units sold as of December—a relatively low bar to clear. In the March



The company has been trying to diversify its revenue streams beyond videogames, expanding into other entertainment.

quarter last year, it sold 1.3 million units of the old Switch.

The caution comes as hardware manufacturers are facing mounting headwinds from soaring prices for memory chips and related components, driven by the artificial-intelligence boom. Investor concerns about pricier components—especially memory chips—eroding the company's profit have weighed on its stock, which has fallen nearly 5% this year.

Nintendo President Shuntaro Furukawa sounded a positive note, saying at a briefing Tuesday that the company has been working with business partners to secure long-term stable supply of memory parts, and that it doesn't expect the recent surge in mem-

ory-chip prices to materially affect results this fiscal year.

Still, he cautioned that elevated memory prices could weigh on profitability if they persist.

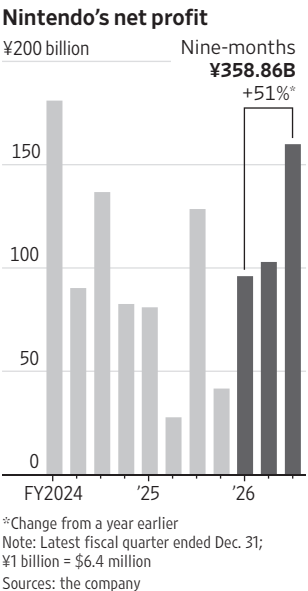
The company has been trying to diversify its revenue streams beyond videogames. It has expanded into movies, theme parks and other forms of entertainment by leveraging its popular characters and game titles.

There are a few major projects in the pipeline, including "The Super Mario Galaxy Movie," due to be released worldwide by Universal Pictures in April, and a live-action film based on Nintendo's popular game series "The Legend of Zelda," scheduled for 2027.

For the nine months ended December, intellectual-property-related income fell 10% to ¥54.5 billion due to lower movie-related revenue.

Nintendo continues to expect to sell 48 million Switch 2 software copies by the end of March. It sold 37.9 million copies as of December. Racing game "Mario Kart World," released on the same day as the hardware, sold 14 million copies, while action-adventure game "Donkey Kong Bananza," released in July, sold 4.25 million copies.

The company also backed its expectation for revenue to increase 93% to ¥2.250 trillion this fiscal year.



—Yang Jie contributed to this article.

Publicis Shares Drop 8% Amid Fears About AI

By ADRIÀ CALATAYUD

Publicis Groupe shares fell sharply after the advertising company's outlook for the year ahead failed to dispel investor concerns about the impact of artificial intelligence on its business.

Shares of Publicis fell 8% in European trading on Tuesday, their biggest one-day percentage drop since April 2020, at the height of the Covid-19 pandemic.

The stock has shed nearly one-quarter of its value over the past year amid investors' AI fears.

The Paris-based ad group forecast organic net revenue growth of between 4% and 5% this year. Organic growth is a common metric that strips out the effects of currency fluctuations, acquisitions and asset sales.

Analysts polled by Visible Alpha expect Publicis to deliver a 4.9% rise in organic net revenue in 2026.



Publicis Chairman and Chief Executive Arthur Sadoun.

The ad industry is confronting uncertainty because of the rise of AI, with companies' plans to adapt to the technology under the market's scrutiny. Some investors see ad agencies as potential losers from the shift to AI, a view company executives are trying to challenge.

Publicis expects AI to drive

sustainable top-line growth over the medium term, projecting annual net revenue to rise by 6% to 7% excluding currency changes beyond this year, Chairman and Chief Executive Arthur Sadoun said in a call with analysts. AI is also helping improve profitability, he said.

The company said account

wins and demand for products and services powered by AI helped it post organic net revenue growth 5.9% for the fourth quarter compared with the year-earlier period. This beat analysts' expectations of a 5.1% rise, according to consensus estimates provided by the company.

In setting its outlook for 2026, though, the company went with the same range it set at the beginning of the past two years, when it ended up raising its outlook several times and overshooting its forecasts. Analysts at UBS said Publicis was unsurprisingly conservative on its prospects at this stage of the year.

Sadoun said Publicis has also benefited from a drastic reduction in competition because of last year's tie-up between U.S. peers Omnicom Group and Interpublic Group. Publicis' U.K. rival WPP, meanwhile, is preparing a new strategy under new leadership.

Publicis claimed the No. 1

spot in the industry in terms of account gains last year, with net new business wins estimated at \$8.16 billion, while its big rivals lost more accounts than they won on balance, according to an analysis by J.P. Morgan. In the fourth quarter alone, however, WPP took the top spot ahead of Publicis, according to J.P. Morgan.

The company's connected media segment, which accounts for the majority of the group's revenue, was its main growth engine last quarter, with organic net revenue increasing by a high-single-percentage digit. Publicis attributed the segment's performance to market-share gains, rising demand for AI-powered products, and services and new markets.

For 2025 as a whole, Publicis' net profit edged lower to €1.65 billion, or \$1.95 billion, from €1.66 billion a year before. Total revenue rose 8.5% to €17.4 billion.

Cybersecurity company **Varonis Systems** said it would acquire artificial-intelligence specialist AllTrue, the latest in a series of deals by larger companies in the growing AI security space.

The \$125 million deal is expected to close this month, Varonis said.

AllTrue, founded in 2014, specializes in an emerging area known as AI trust, risk and security management, which puts controls around AI usage. The tools also monitor how models perform over time in terms of accuracy and reliability, assess their vulnerabilities and manage other risks, such as data bias.

As companies rush to roll out AI tools, security staff across all sectors must balance innovation with the need to ensure the technology doesn't open doors to hackers or cause systems to go haywire. A lack of governance and controls over how AI systems operate could lead to serious problems such as exposed data, said Yaki Faitelson, CEO and co-founder of Varonis.

James Rundle writes for WSJ Pro Cybersecurity.

Musk's X Paris Office Is Raided

Continued from page B1

Suspects who don't show up for such interviews in France can later be slapped with arrest warrants.

X described the raid as an "abusive act of law enforcement theater designed to achieve illegitimate political objectives" and called French allegations baseless. The social-media platform is part of Musk's artificial-intelligence firm xAI, which has now been purchased by the entrepreneur's rocket company SpaceX.

The summons and raid are the latest signals of a growing trans-Atlantic clash over how—and whether—big tech companies like TikTok, Instagram and X should police online speech.

Long-simmering tensions are now coming to a head. European regulators are ramping up enforcement of a new arsenal of content-moderation rules, while the Trump administration and other U.S. officials have accused Europeans of trying to silence dissent not just

on their continent but globally. Behind the clash are different approaches to free expression, with some European governments banning certain kinds of hate speech—like anti-semitic or racist posts—that are legal in the U.S. In other cases, a right to privacy can sometimes trump free speech in Europe.

The U.S. House Judiciary Committee released a report Tuesday accusing the European Commission, the EU's executive arm, of running a "global censorship campaign" that infringes on Americans' online speech in the U.S. A hearing on the subject is planned for Wednesday.

The report alleges that the European Union has pressured social-media platforms to change their content-moderation rules. Because platforms often apply the same content-moderation rules globally, the report says, "it affects what Americans can say and see online in the United States."

Last December, the U.S. imposed visa restrictions on five people it referred to as "agents of the global censorship-industrial complex." Those included Thierry Breton, a former French politician who served as the EU's internal market commissioner until 2024 and played a central role in the in-



X has been a lightning rod for regulators in Europe. The building housing its offices in Paris.

troducton and initial enforcement of the bloc's online-content law.

The European Commission says that law, called the Digital Services Act, supports free speech because it requires platforms to be transparent about content moderation and gives users tools to appeal platforms' decisions to remove their content.

"We stand for freedom of expression. Any allegation towards Europe saying that we

are not protecting freedom of expression, or any censorship allegations, are complete nonsense," a spokesman said Tuesday.

X in particular has been a lightning rod for regulators in Europe, spawning a series of probes.

The EU fined X about \$140 million in December for allegedly breaching its DSA. European officials are also probing X over the spread of illegal content and risks related to its

recommendation systems.

This year, the EU and the U.K. have both opened new probes into X over sexualized images, including of children, created by its Grok chatbot. The U.K. regulator said Tuesday that it has sent binding requests for information to X, which faces fines if it doesn't comply. X has said that it has limited use of the feature.

French authorities in particular have shown a willingness to go after overseas social-me-

dia platforms—and their executives.

Cybercrime prosecutors issued arrest warrants last week for executives at an Australian video website, which is under investigation for broadcasting the death of a French streamer, after they canceled a scheduled interview.

In August 2024, French police arrested **Telegram's** founder, Pavel Durov, as part of an investigation into the chat and social-media app's responsibility for alleged crimes conducted on the platform. Dubai-based Telegram has denied wrongdoing.

French prosecutors' investigation into X began in January 2025 after a lawmaker and another official filed complaints alleging that X's content-selection algorithm—which they saw as being skewed toward Musk's views—amounted to foreign interference in France.

French prosecutors in July asked for access to X's algorithm to investigate whether it was biased. They further expanded their case in November, after reports of antisemitic posts including Holocaust denial. In January, they added the creation and dissemination of child pornography and non-consensual deepfakes to the list of potential charges under investigation.

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THE PROPERTY REPORT

Can Deportations Lower Housing Prices?

White House cites crackdown for drop in some cities but economists disagree

By REBECCA PICCIOTTO

The Trump administration says its aggressive deportation push is central to its plan to lower housing costs for Americans. So far, there is little evidence that it is working.

“Want affordable housing? Help report illegal aliens in your area,” the Department of Homeland Security said in a social-media post last week.

White House officials say that fewer immigrants means less demand for housing, which will compel landlords to cut their prices. DHS says that three million immigrants have left the country since Trump took office last year, including 675,000 forced deportations over the past year, though those numbers are difficult to verify and could be overstated.

Rents had already been declining in cities that immigration officers have targeted, including Minneapolis, Los Angeles and Houston. The White House cited deportations

as the reason home listing prices are dropping in some U.S. cities like Austin, Texas, San Diego and San Jose, Calif.

Economists and housing industry analysts largely attribute price declines in those and other markets to oversupply and fewer people moving there from other states. Immigration, they say, is less correlated to housing prices.

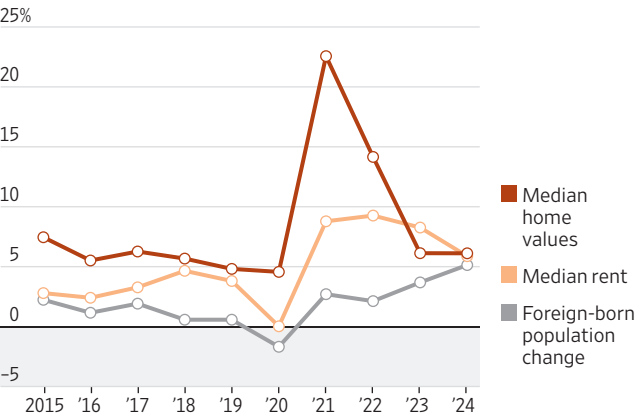
Trump’s deportations so far have mostly been felt by a few apartment owners struggling to fill their empty units, even with renter discounts.

The Department of Housing and Urban Development last month ordered public housing authorities and landlords of federally subsidized housing to verify the legal status for 200,000 of their tenants.

“Removing illegal aliens from our country will free up the housing supply for American citizens,” White House spokesman Davis Ingle said.

In Florida, 67% of multifamily building owners reported that immigration enforcement had a somewhat negative impact on their ability to fill their apartments, according to a recent survey by John Burns Research and Consulting, a real-estate research firm. In Texas,

Annual growth rates of housing prices vs. foreign-born population



Source: Census Bureau

21% of owners said it had a significant negative impact.

Developers, especially those in the Sunbelt, said they were offering rent discounts, mainly because of oversupply. Renters save about \$4.39 a month because of mass deportations, according to an estimate by Michael Konczal, senior director of policy and research at the Economic Security Project. He calculated that number using an economic housing study that Trump appointees often cite.

Is \$4.39 a month “really going to make or break someone

who can’t afford a home?” Konczal said.

In some cases, Immigration and Customs Enforcement has targeted apartment buildings that are already affordable. Aeon, an affordable-housing nonprofit in the Twin Cities, has had several instances of ICE activity in its income-restricted buildings. Some renters are now too scared to open their doors, said Laura Russ, the company’s chief real-estate officer.

Lack of affordable housing has become a major point of frustration for Americans. Pres-

The Empire State Building Tracks Nearby Bees’ Buzzing

By CLARA HUDSON

The Empire State Building in bustling Manhattan is now equipped with supersensitive microphones, tuning into bird calls and the slightest flutter of insects amid the cacophony of the concrete jungle.

The mics are attached to a nature-monitoring device collecting minute details on the cities’ bugs, birds and bats, which feed into an artificial-intelligence platform that can alert the building owners of any concerning patterns. It is part of a real-estate industry trend to track properties’ surroundings, amid pressure to anticipate how everything from pollutants to window cleaning could harm living creatures.

“As an insect flies it creates a vibration, a tiny little audio

frequency,” said Alex McLean, chief executive and co-founder of Alvéole, which oversees the nature-monitoring device and platform, called Aura. “We’re monitoring in real time any real living thing coming in contact with that building.”

He added: “When a real-estate owner makes a change, we can pick it up and see the fluctuation.”

Birds emit lower frequencies with their calls, while the sensors also pick up higher frequencies from hovering insects. The sensors aren’t positioned too high up in a skyscraper—they are typically outfitted anywhere from the ground level to the 15th floor.

The technology was installed at the Empire State Building last year, and has now accrued enough data to spot patterns for Empire State

Realty Trust.

New York City is filled with all kinds of creatures.

“Many species grow and thrive in one of the most dense urban environments in the world,” said Dana Schneider, senior vice president and director of energy and sustainability at Empire State Realty Trust.

Aura pairs the bioacoustic information it tracks from the wildlife with satellite-based environmental data, to provide broader context on the land and ecological conditions.

Alvéole, a Montreal company, also helps commercial buildings set up bee hives to help boost local biodiversity. The company got the idea for the tracking sensor after bees from its hives survived the fire at the Notre Dame Cathedral, in Paris, and the business was approached by scientists wanting to better understand the movements of the insects.

Protecting bees and butterflies is also on the mind of some lawmakers. A bipartisan group of legislators on Capitol Hill introduced a bill in January to improve natural habitats for pollinators along highways, in part to strengthen agriculture.

Real-estate firms are turning to nature monitoring in part because investors are paying more attention to biodiversity. There are sustainability accreditations or initiatives that encourage reporting on biodiversity and nature, such as the Task Force on Nature-related Financial Disclosures.

What’s more, some companies renting office spaces or



FROM TOP: BRENNAN GOLDSTEIN/ALVÉOLE

Above, an Alvéole bee keeper at the Empire State Building. Right, an Aura bioacoustic monitor in Montreal.



other sites are clamoring for nature data to help them put together reports on their environmental impact or risk. That is in part for requirements such as Europe’s Corporate Sustainability Reporting Directive, which will require nature and biodiversity reporting.

The disclosure effort is especially important considering that the real-estate industry contributes to habitat loss, pollution and stress on local ecosystems.

A report from PwC said the real-estate sector accounts for nearly 30% of biodiversity loss around the world because of the land and resources it uses up. The industry hasn’t done much overall to quell its harm on biodiversity, the report said, adding that there aren’t many regulations pushing the industry to conserve habitats and species.

But real-estate businesses can face losses if they don’t

pay attention to their impact on local wildlife, for example, if there’s public concern about any environmental damage.

The real-estate sector has an environmental and climate problem as everything from hurricanes to wildfires hit home prices and insurance availability. Pressure from the industry prompted **Zillow** to remove climate scores from a display on its website.

While tracking tiny fluctuations around one building—

even a butterfly flapping its wings—might seem insignificant, it feeds into a much bigger framework.

“One building is usually tied into a portfolio of hundreds and thousands of buildings,” McLean said. “You take this one street corner in Manhattan, and when you multiply that by 2,000, that starts to become a huge footprint.”

Clara Hudson writes for WSJ Pro Sustainable Business.

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Google Bets Big on AI Energy

Continued from page B1

its own electricity sources for Google data centers.

“The energy system, I would say, globally, is no longer fit for purpose, for serving the demands of AI,” said Amanda Pettersen Corio, Google’s global head of data-center energy. “What we’re trying to do is really think proactively.”

The acquisition has the potential to help Google better navigate the challenging process of bringing data centers online as regulators and legislators increasingly worry about electricity shortages. Tech companies are seeking to build data centers far more quickly than new power plants can be built to serve them.

Within PJM Interconnection, a 13-state power market

stretching from New Jersey to Kentucky, that dynamic has already resulted in higher electricity prices and concerns that there won’t be enough power to go around during times of extreme demand. The Trump administration has proposed that PJM hold an emergency power auction this year in which tech companies would have to cover the cost of building new plants.

Intersect, which is already working on several Google projects, pivoted in recent years from developing stand-alone wind and solar farms to building them to support data centers. The company, which has \$15 billion in assets online or under construction, is finishing construction of a solar farm with battery storage to supply a Google data center in West Texas.

“Just as Google brought in house some of the elements

around chip design to reduce reliance on Nvidia,” said Oliver Kerr, managing director for North America at consulting firm Aurora Energy Research, “I think it makes sense that they’re also bringing the power-generation piece in house.”

Having on-site power is becoming a strategic advantage for tech companies. Regulators and power officials in many regions are considering whether data centers built alongside new power sources should be afforded a faster connection to the grid because they will be less reliant on it. Data centers supplying themselves with electricity require fewer investments in centralized power plants and transmission lines to serve them, though most still seek a grid connection to draw power as needed.

Intersect Chief Executive Sheldon Kimber said energy

has become core to companies’ efforts to develop more powerful AI models.

“You don’t even get a seat at the table here without being a big, big player in physical infrastructure,” he said.

The AI race stemming from the 2022 launch of ChatGPT put fast-moving tech companies somewhat at odds with utility and power companies unaccustomed to the prospect of huge demand growth, much less having to accommodate it quickly. Until recently, U.S. power demand had long been mostly flat, and in some regions, older power plants have gone out of service more quickly than new ones have come online.

The supply challenge became more acute as each of the tech giants stepped up infrastructure spending plans to support larger data centers, some of which require the same amount of power as a midsize city. Google, Microsoft, Amazon and Meta have all struck deals to draw power from existing plants and pay power companies to build new ones.

BUSINESS & FINANCE

China Bans Retractable Car-Door Handles

By YOKO KUBOTA

BEIJING—China is banning retractable door handles on cars, used by **Tesla** and many Chinese electric-vehicle makers, after safety concerns grew over doors that couldn't be opened in accidents.

Under rules set to take effect next year, cars must have both internal and external door handles that can be mechanically opened, including in the case of an accident or power failure. The rules also specify where the handles must be located, both inside and outside the car, and require that an instruction sign be installed near the internal handle.

The new rules are intended to “improve the level of automotive safety design,” China’s Ministry of Industry and Information Technology said.

Retracted door handles have been on the rise in recent years, especially in electric vehicles that come with various electrified features. In the U.S., Tesla vehicles and **Hyundai**’s Ioniq are among the models with retractable handles. In China, the feature is especially widespread given that around half of the new cars sold are electric or plug-in hybrids.

Unlike traditional handles that stick out on the door surface and can always be grasped by hand, the retractable handle sinks into the door and isn't graspable in its default position. It pops out when it needs to be used, either automatically through the user's key fob or phone,



Carmakers say the retractable handle, which isn't graspable in its default position, increases aerodynamic efficiency.

or manually by pressing the handle. Carmakers say the retractable handle increases aerodynamic efficiency.

Some consumers have found the feature inconvenient or dangerous. In 2024, battery-electric vehicle owners reported their door handles being difficult to use at a rate of 3.1 problems per 100

vehicles, up from 0.2 in 2020, according to J.D. Power.

Inside, some cars have electrically powered doors that are opened by pressing a button. Many of these cars also have a mechanical door release, but they are often not so obvious to users.

Last year, a U.S. automobile-safety regulator opened

an investigation into Tesla, saying the mechanical door release on the company's 2022 Tesla Model 3 isn't easily accessible.

China's decision followed deadly accidents. In October, an accident involving a **Xi-aomi** SU7 Ultra left at least one passenger stuck in the car because the door couldn't

be opened, state media reported. The SU7 Ultra has retractable door handles. Xi-aomi didn't respond to a request for comment.

For vehicle models already approved and nearing launch, carmakers must change the door handle design by January 2029, the Chinese regulators said.

Ivanhoe Mines in Talks Over Minerals for U.S.

By ROBB M. STEWART

Ivanhoe Mines said it was in talks to supply critical minerals from its mine in Congo to the Trump administration's proposed \$12 billion stockpile.

The Canadian mining company said it is in advanced discussions with Congo's state-owned miner, Gécamines, as well as Swiss metals and energy trading firm Mercuria to supply production from the Kipushi mine to the U.S.

Ivanhoe's U.S.-listed shares climbed 8.5% to \$13.63.

Ivanhoe founder and executive co-Chairman Robert Friedland on Tuesday joined President Trump at the White House for the official launch of Project Vault, an initiative aimed at securing critical minerals to help U.S. manufacturers navigate future supply shortages and avoid future reliance on China for rare earths and metals.

Under a proposed agreement, Ivanhoe said zinc concentrate from the Congo mines that currently is heading to Mercuria would be assigned to the trading arm of Gécamines, Ivanhoe's partner in the Kipushi mine.

Excess mineral volumes generated after removing bottlenecks and boosting Kipushi's concentrator late last year also would be included.

That would see supplies of zinc concentrate, including critical minerals including germanium and gallium, sent to U.S. markets.

Kipushi is expected to produce between 240,000 and 290,000 metric tons of zinc concentrate this year, as well as significant quantities of germanium and gallium.

Ivanhoe said Gécamines has the potential to be responsible for the sale of up to 50% of the Kipushi mine's concentrate production, including to the U.S.

Germanium is used in electronic devices, flat-panel display screens, light-emitting diodes, night-vision devices, optical fibers and solar power arrays.

Gallium is used to manufacture compound semiconductor wafers for integrated circuits and optoelectronic devices such as laser diodes, light-emitting diodes, photodetectors and solar cells.

Ivanhoe bought a 68% stake in the Kipushi project in late



Robert Friedland of Ivanhoe Mines, left, with Secretary of the Interior Doug Burgum on Monday in Washington.

2011. The balance is owned by Gécamines, whose ownership will rise to 38% when certain conditions that were part of a 2023 joint venture agreement are met. An 800,000 ton-a-year concentrator was completed in May 2024, and the first concentrate was produced in June that year.

New Highs and Lows

The following explanations apply to the New York Stock Exchange, NYSE Arca, NYSE American and Nasdaq Stock Market stocks that hit a new 52-week intraday high or low in the latest session. % **CHG**-Daily percentage change from the previous trading session.

Tuesday, February 3, 2026					Tuesday, February 3, 2026					Tuesday, February 3, 2026				
Stock	52-Wk %	Sym	Hi/Low	Chg	Stock	52-Wk %	Sym	Hi/Low	Chg	Stock	52-Wk %	Sym	Hi/Low	Chg
Highs														
AAR	AIR	110.01	1.8		Barclays	BES	27.70	...		Cummins	CMH	612.10	1.3	
ACM Research	ACR	64.79	0.2		Belfuse A	BELFA	204.00	0.7		Curtiss-Wright	CW	683.09	1.6	
AES	AES	16.19	0.2		Belfuse B	BELFB	222.49	0.8		CustomTruck	CTOS	6.80	-0.4	
ATI	ATI	137.00	0.1		BeliteBio	BLTE	200.00	8.1		CytomXTherap	CTXM	6.17	-0.3	
ATN Intl	ATNI	25.99	5.1		BenchmarkElec	BHE	56.25	4.0		DHT	DHT	14.49	-0.3	
AXIAEnergyAC	AXIAP	10.60	1.7		BlackhawkAcqn	BKHAU	12.40	5.4		DT Midstream	DTM	127.79	2.5	
AXIAEnergyIA	AXIIA	10.99	2.5		BlackSpadeAcqnl	BSILU	10.17	0.2		DXP Ent's	DXPE	140.48	2.9	
AZZ	AZZ	130.89	-0.1		BloomEnergy	BE	176.49	8.2		DSAKUSpec	DSAKU	10.13	0.2	
AcademySports	ASO	59.67	5.2		BlueFoundryBncp	BLFY	13.77	2.7		DarlingIngred	DAR	48.10	1.1	
Acushnet	ACZ	99.58	1.3		BorDrilling	BORR	4.95	4.7		Deere	DE	545.32	2.4	
Adage	ADAG	3.19	0.3		Brady	BRC	88.93	1.6		DelekLogistics	DLEK	51.85	2.7	
AdamasPfdF	ADAM	23.35	-0.4		BridgewaterBchs	BWB	20.15	-0.5		DevonEnergy	DVN	41.54	2.4	
AdiaNortye	ADN	12.09	1.4		BritShAmTob	BTI	62.04	1.4		DimeCommBchs	DCOM	121.80	5.8	
AdvDrainageSys	ADW	16.11	0.1		BrookfieldInf	BIPC	49.31	-0.1		DiversHlthcrNtst	DHNI	17.62	-0.4	
Al	AL	64.70	0.1		BrookfieldInfR	BFIR	36.92	0.2		Dole	DOLE	16.32	0.2	
AirTPrfd	AIRTP	20.60	0.1		BusFirstBchs	BFST	29.57	1.9		DouglasDynamics	DLOW	39.33	1.3	
AlerusFinancial	ALF	25.68	2.1		BylineBancorp	BYL	33.31	0.1		DrugsMadeAmll	DMII	10.01	0.4	
Algonquin2079	AQNB	25.93	0.2		CF Bankshares	CFBK	31.40	1.5		DrugsMadeAmll	DMIIU	10.80	0.3	
AlmontyIndustries	ALM	13.30	18.0		Ch Robinson	CHRB	202.80	0.6		Ducommun	DCO	154.04	2.3	
AlphaCent	ALC	17.29	4.0		CME Group	CME	296.16	0.8		DuPont	DD	45.88	2.8	
Alphabet C	GOOG	390.15	-1.2		CNB Fin PA	CNBF	28.81	1.2		Dyciminds	DY	402.33	2.1	
AmalgamFm	AMAL	40.88	1.8		CNX	CNX	39.45	2.0		EDAP TMS	EDAP	4.60	-4.0	
Ambev	ABEV	3.72	0.3		CTS	CTS	54.23	0.3		ESCO Tech	ESE	239.03	2.5	
AmerServFin	ASRV	2.92	0.5		Calumet	CLM	24.00	5.5		EagleBncpMT	EBMT	23.00	2.3	
AmesNational	AME	23.17	0.5		CapitolNatn	CN	50.38	1.1		EastmanBancshares	EBSC	22.10	3.4	
AnalogueDevices	ADI	321.23	-1.8		CIBC	CIB	95.47	0.2		ElPASenogy pFC	EPFC	50.10	0.4	
Andersons	ANDE	65.28	3.2		CapitolFedFin	CFIN	7.74	...		Electrovaya	ELVA	11.88	-1.0	
AB Indev	ABD	73.72	1.5		CardinalHealth	CAH	220.27	-0.4		ElementSols	ESI	33.86	2.3	
ApexTreasuryA	APT	9.99	0.2		Carnival	CAR	32.82	-1.2		EmbotelAndinaB	AKO.A	26.96	6.1	
ARCB	ARCB	37.82	3.9		Caterpillar	CT	22.51	0.4		EmersonElec	ENR	154.04	2.3	
ArchMittal	MT	57.66	0.3		Chervon	CVX	178.82	2.3		Enerflex	ENR	15.99	0.8	
ArchCapital	ACGL	97.85	0.1		ChinaYuchai	CYD	49.93	5.0		Enertech	ENRT	19.65	0.8	
Arcosa	ARCO	118.90	1.3		Ciena	CEN	284.79	3.0		EnlightRenewableEn	ENLT	62.94	5.1	
ArrowElec	AROW	136.34	1.3		CoscoSystems	CSO	83.25	3.1		EnovaIntl	ENVA	176.68	7.7	
ArrowFinancial	ARWF	35.63	2.3		CoscoSystems	CSO	83.25	3.1		EnterpriseProd	EPD	35.08	4.6	
AscendIndustries	ACNT	17.29	4.0		Citizens&Northen	CZNC	23.43	3.0		Enviri	ENV	19.65	0.8	
AssociatedBanc	ASB	28.45	1.6		CitizensFin	CFIN	66.18	1.7		ERAS	ERAS	11.00	-0.2	
Assurant	AIZ	244.83	0.3		Coca-Cola	KO	77.50	2.1		EsteeLauder	EL	121.64	-2.1	
AstedIndustries	ASTO	53.00	4.0		Coherent	COH	146.92	3.0		ExactSciences	EXAS	102.70	...	
Astronics	ATRO	81.89	4.0		Cohu	COHU	30.83	1.4		ExpeditorsIntl	EXPD	167.19	-0.8	
AtmcoBankcorp	ATMB	62.30	...		ColonyBankcorp	CBAN	122.00	2.9		ExxonMobil	EXX	25.79	3.6	
Audiotronics	AVTH	31.07	1.3		CompassSystems	CSYS	122.00	2.9		Ezcorp	EZPW	22.15	2.1	
AvidiaBancorp	AVBC	19.82	4.1		CmclBancorp	CBK	87.93	1.0		FNB	FNB	18.31	2.5	
AvidityBio	AVIB	73.06	0.3		CommecialMetals	CMC	21.85	1.9		FedEx	FDX	355.15	5.4	
Avnet	AVT	64.22	-0.5		CommWestBchs	CWBC	25.32	0.8		FergusonEnts	FERG	262.88	1.1	
AxosFinancial	AX	100.83	-0.7		SABESP	SBS	28.37	1.5		FinInstitutions	FISI	34.81	0.9	
BBB Foods	TBBB	37.82	3.9		CompassMinerals	CHP	26.45	4.6		FirstBancCorp	FBC	23.02	1.5	
BCE	BCE	26.26	1.0		CompassTherap	CMXP	6.88	-1.5		FirstCmwlthFin	FCF	18.68	1.8	
BP	BP	38.92	3.0		Constellation	CSTM	24.83	3.6		FirstEagleUSEq	USFE	35.29	0.5	
Babcock&Wilcox	BW	11.29	10.7		ContinuumTherap	CTNM	15.48	5.8		FirstFinBncpOH	FFBC	29.94	1.0	
Ball	BALL	62.77	9.0		Copa	CPA	146.92	3.0		FirstFinancial	THFF	66.95	1.2	
Ball&Bradesco	BLX	50.50	1.0		Corning	GLW	117.30	2.2		FirstFoundation	FFWM	6.70	0.8	
Blades	BLD	14.61	1.1		Costarane	CSA	18.25	7.4		FirstHorizon	FHN	25.79	3.6	
BancoSantander	BAN	13.11	6.1		CovenantLogist	CVLG	27.81	2.5		FirstMidBchs	FMBS	44.61	0.5	
Bank1st	BFC	146.91	1.0		Credent	CBL	38.20	2.0		FirstNatiVA	FNVC	27.87	0.9	
BankofBartfield	NBO	53.85	-0.2		Crown Holdings	CKH	122.30	3.5		FiveStarBncp	FSBC	41.00	1.2	
BankMontreal	MTB	141.97	2.0		CrownReservel	CRAC	10.03	0.5		FlagstarBanc	FLG	14.05	3.5	
BankJamesFinl	BTJ	20.50	0.2		CullinanTherap	CCEM	13.43	3.9		Flowerave	FLS	80.89	0.7	

Stock	Sym	Hi	Low	Chg	Stock	Sym	Hi	Low	Chg
Fortis	FTS	54.12	2.6		KochAvDefense	KCHV	10.26	-0.4	
GenorEnergyTb	GET	47.29	3.1		KRAAcquisition	KRAQ	10.20	-0.3	
FosterLib	FSTR	31.60	0.8		LatinAirlines	LTAM	70.42	-1.1	
FranklinRscs	FEN	27.47	-0.3		LinkBancorp	LNKB	9.13	1.1	
Frontline	FRO	29.04	1.0		LakeshoreAcqll	LLCC	10.27	...	
FultonFin	FULT	21.61	2.7		LeapfrogAcqn	LFACU	10.26	-1.4	
FVCBancorp	FVCB	15.88	0.6		LeggettPlatt	LEG	12.78	1.4	
GATX	GATX	186.69	1.4		LindbladExped	LECO	172.65	1.5	
GE Vernova	GEV	791.95	3.3		LincolnElectric	LIND	17.74	1.1	
GSK	GSK	53.38	1.7		Liquida	LQDA	46.67	5.5	
GSK ADHrghed	GSKH	72.95	1.3		Littelfuse	LFUS	336.13	2.0	
G Willi-Food	WILC	31.16	-0.8		LiveOakBankV Wt	LOKW	1.98	11.4	
GXO Logistics	GKO	58.38	0.5		LloydsBanking	LNG	6.26	1.3	
GencoShipping	GSK	53.38	1.7		LockheedMart	LMT	64.59	-1.2	
GenuineParts	GPC	145.20	1.1		Lumentum	LITE	464.00	2.8	
GermanAmBncp	GABC	44.00	-0.2		Macom Tech	MTSI	236.80	-0.8	
GileadSciences	GILD	145.94	0.3		M&T Bank	MTB	229.68	1.1	
GlacierBancorp	GBCI	52.14	2.6		MYR Group	MYRG	266.00	2.5	
GlobalShipLease	GSL	38.52	1.6		MartiniMarietta	MLM	676.74	1.3	
Gorman-Rupp	GRC	57.76	1.0		MasTec	MTZ	252.00	1.7	
Graco	GGO	89.70	0.4		Matson	MATX	169.09	-0.3	
Grainger	GGW	1169.57	5.4		MazeTherap	MAZE	48.75	3.1	
GraniteConstr	GVA	125.02	1.0		MechanicsBnk	MCBH	15.97	-2.5	
GreenPlains	GPKE	12.59	5.8		Merck	MKR	118.46	2.4	
GrubHub	GRUB	125.02	1.0		MetLife	MTL	100.00	0.5	
ASUR	ASR	365.43	4.3		Metallus	MTUS	21.26	2.2	
HAStuSntFinCh	HASI	35.61	2.4		MidwestPetrol	MCB	98.85	1.0	
HancockWhitney	HWC	71.97	3.2		MetroBankInc	MOFG	40.05	0.1	
Helsios	HAS	95.91	0.9		Millicomint	TIPO	62.81	3.3	
HeliosTech	HULG	69.62	3.4		MirumGroup	MIRG	105.64	1.4	
Hercules	HRT	125.02	1.0		Mitochondria	MITO	10.26	-0.4	
Herbife	HLF	17.93	-2.6		MizuhoFnc	MFG	8.99	0.7	
Hershey	HSY	204.41	2.7		MinomFng	MOD	205.74	1.4	
Hilltop	HTH	39.12	1.7		MonolithicPwr	MPWR	119.76	-0.4	
Honeywell	HON	231.76	1.5		Moog B	MOOG	327.27	9.9	
HookerFunding	HOFT	14.65	7.4		Moog A	MOGA	326.00	2.2	
HookerHush	HOPE	19.59	1.9		Moog B	MOGB	327.27	9.9	
Hood	HOD	125.02	1.0		MyersIndustries	MYE	33.30	3.3	
Hubbell	HUBB	513.59	1.7		NACCO Lns	NC	56.00	2.2	
JBHunt	JBHT	22.69	4.2		NB Bancorp	NBBK	22.70	-0.2	
Hyperliqulid	PURR	8.75	-0.7		NGL Energy	NGL	13.00	-2.2	
HSX Holding	HSX	5.98	1.3		NGL EnergyPgr	NGLP	25.68	0.6	
Humana	HUM	125.02	1.0		NHFX Inc	NHFX	18.22	1.2	
InteropTwp	IPGP	10.27	0.1		NatBankshares	NKSH	31.05	1.1	
IllinoisToolWorks	ITW	282.88	5.6		NatlEnergySvcs	NESR	28.16	1.1	
Immuno	IMNM	27.23	3.2		NationalGrid	NGG	86.35	1.1	
ImperialOil	MO	107.19	3.9		NatHealthcare	NHC	151.29	-0.2	
Indenets	IDNB	84.61	3.0		NatWestlons	NPK	135.96	2.2	
Ingevity	INGV	69.37	3.1		NexGen2	NXG	18.22	1.2	
Intercontinental	INTC	125.02	1.0		NexGen2	NXG	18.22	1.2	
InteropFinSvcs	IFS	52.58	1.8		NewOriLeasRcs	NJR	52.31	3.3	
IntSeaways	INSE	61.20	1.1		NewOriLeasRcs	EDJ	63.80	2.2	
IntEST	INTT	9.67	3.2		NxtEra299Xln	NEEPs	55.69	1.1	
IuranLocation	IRF	46.26	1.6		NxtEra299Xln	NES	152.09	0.9	
Iron Mountain	IRM	125.02	1.0		nRtH	NRT	58.00	1.4	
JFR Constructn	JFR	33.68	5.1		NorthEastBank	NBN	122.79	2.2	
JohnsonFin	XJ	126.31	-3.1		NorthropGrum	NOG	707.66	2.2	
JamesRiver	JVR	6.94	-1.0		NorthWestEne	NWE	69.39	2.2	
HancockDisctVal	JVLS	29.05	0.9		Nucor	NUE	189.92	3.3	
HancockDivlwn	HNC	11.20	0.2		Novartis	NVS	125.02	1.0	
JohnsonControls	JCI	124.81	0.8		OFSSCreditPfc	OCFPM	26.06	0.3	
JohnsonOutdoors	JOUT	48.57	2.4		O-I Glass	OI	16.09	0.9	
KaiserAlum	KALU	139.72	5.3		OceanVeringBank	OVB	31.78	2.2	
Kennametal	KNT	36.34	0.6		ChicoValleyBanc	OVBC	42.16	0.4	
KeyCorp	KEY	22.46	1.5		OldStateStn	OIS	8.90	4.4	
KeyBankTech	KBT	125.02	1.0		OldStateStn	OIS	8.90	4.4	
Knights	KNS	45.90	0.6		OrangeCybncPnt	OCB	32.71	0.0	
Knights	KNS	45.90	0.6		OrangeCybncPnt	OCB	32.71	0.0	
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Knights	KNS	45.90	0.6		OrangeCybncPnt	OCB	32.71	0.0	
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Knights	KNS	45.90	0.6		OrangeCybncPnt	OCB	32.71	0.0	
Knights	KNS	45.90	0.6		OrangeCybncPnt	OCB	32.71	0.0	
Knights	KNS	45.90	0.6		OrangeCybncPnt	OCB	32.71	0.0	
Knights	KNS	45.90	0.6		OrangeCybncPnt	OCB	32.71	0.0	
Knights	KNS	45.90	0.6		OrangeCybncPnt	OCB	32.71	0.0	
Knights	KNS	45.90	0.6		OrangeCybncPnt	OCB	32.71	0.0	
Knights	KNS	45.90	0.6		OrangeCybncPnt	OCB	32.71	0.0	
Knights	KNS	45.90	0.6		OrangeCybncPnt	OCB	32.71	0.0	
Knights	KNS	45.90	0.6		OrangeCybncPnt	OCB	32.71	0.0	
Knights	KNS	45.90	0.6		OrangeCybncPnt	OCB	32.71	0.0	
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Knights	KNS	45.90	0.6		OrangeCybncPnt	OCB	32.71	0.0	
Knights	KNS	45.90	0.						

MARKETS DIGEST

EQUITIES

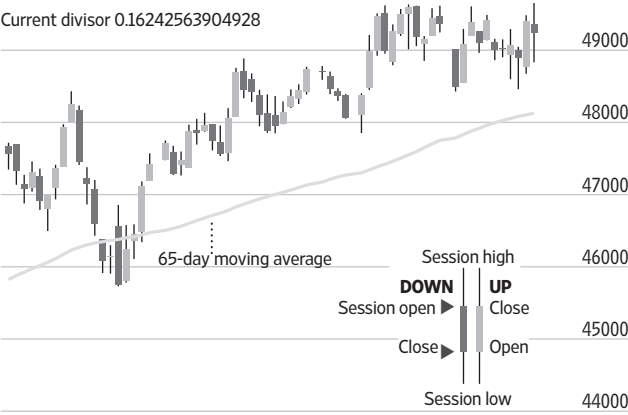
Dow Jones Industrial Average

49240.99 ▼166.67, or 0.34%

High, low, open and close for each trading day of the past three months.

Trailing P/E ratio	24.29	27.07
P/E estimate *	21.17	20.73
Dividend yield	1.70	1.83
All-time high	49590.20, 01/12/2€	

Last 24.29
 Year ago 27.07



Current divisor 0.16242563904928

*Weekly P/E data based on as-reported earnings from Birinyi Associates Inc.; †Based on Nasdaq-100 Index

Major U.S. Stock-Market Indexes

	High	Low	Latest Close	Net chg	% chg	52-Week High	52-Week Low	% chg YTD	% chg 3-yr. ann.
Dow Jones									
Industrial Average	49653.13	48832.78	49240.99	-166.67	-0.34	49590.20	37645.59	10.5	2.5
Transportation Avg	19369.27	18887.77	19259.33	382.96	2.03	19259.33	12637.04	19.6	11.0
Utility Average	1094.43	1075.81	1088.22	12.85	1.19	1168.30	953.88	9.4	1.9
Total Stock Market	69053.70	67742.11	68349.30	-527.31	-0.77	69049.79	49067.76	13.7	1.3
Barron's 400	1488.46	1463.17	1477.71	-1.26	-0.09	1496.23	1058.38	13.7	4.6

Nasdaq Stock Market									
Nasdaq Composite	23691.60	23027.21	23255.19	-336.92	-1.43	23958.47	15267.91	18.3	0.1
Nasdaq-100	25840.04	25112.46	25338.62	-399.99	-1.55	26119.85	17090.40	17.5	0.4

S&P									
500 Index	6993.08	6862.05	6917.81	-58.63	-0.84	6978.60	4982.77	14.6	1.1
MidCap 400	3500.74	3433.69	3473.51	6.04	0.17	3521.86	2560.93	7.9	5.1
SmallCap 600	1581.98	1546.34	1564.93	-1.39	-0.09	1591.78	1106.12	8.4	6.6

Other Indexes									
Russell 2000	2666.85	2605.88	2648.50	8.22	0.31	2718.77	1760.71	15.6	6.7
NYSE Composite	23006.94	22679.55	22881.21	-4.44	-0.02	22885.65	17188.46	14.6	4.0
Value Line	654.97	642.27	649.23	-2.97	-0.46	663.49	495.50	3.6	3.3
NYSE Arca Biotech	7536.81	7355.96	7414.45	-41.70	-0.56	7711.58	5060.12	19.7	3.7
NYSE Arca Pharma	1179.15	1146.25	1148.23	-21.09	-1.80	1169.32	860.88	18.8	2.0
KBW Bank	173.54	169.30	171.80	1.32	0.77	172.62	104.27	25.1	4.6
PHLX ^S Gold/Silver	402.17	386.73	398.43	17.62	4.63	451.13	154.42	152.1	16.4
PHLX ^S Oil Service	89.74	87.60	89.70	2.32	2.66	89.70	50.70	21.0	22.3
PHLX ^S Semiconductor	8239.64	7796.46	7966.33	-168.16	-2.07	8320.39	3562.94	60.1	12.5
Cboe Volatility	20.37	16.05	18.00	1.66	10.16	52.33	13.47	4.6	20.4

^SNasdaq PHLX

Sources: FactSet; Dow Jones Market Data

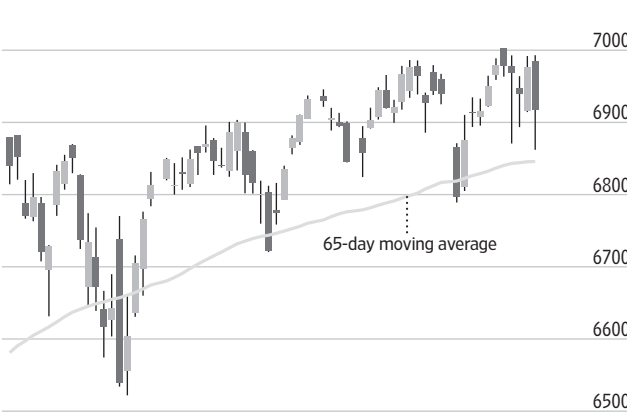
S&P 500 Index

6917.81 ▼58.63, or 0.84%

High, low, open and close for each trading day of the past three months.

Trailing P/E ratio *	25.69	25.52
P/E estimate *	22.18	22.33
Dividend yield *	1.13	1.22
All-time high	6978.60, 01/27/26	

Last 25.69
 Year ago 25.52



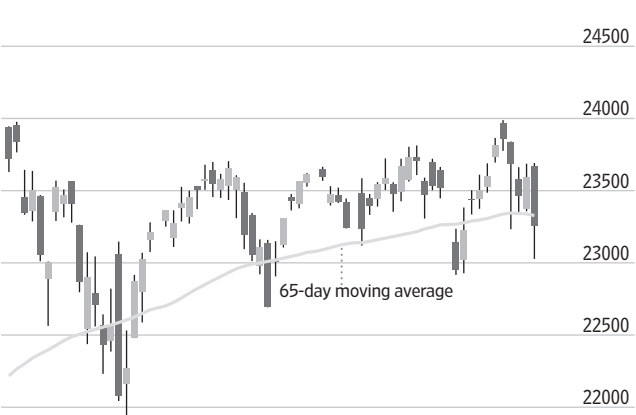
Nasdaq Composite Index

23255.19 ▼ 336.92, or 1.43%

High, low, open and close for each trading day of the past three months.

Trailing P/E ratio *	32.87	33.38
P/E estimate *	25.89	27.20
Dividend yield *	0.64	0.70
All-time high	23958.47, 10/29/25	

Last 32.87
 Year ago 33.38



Late Trading

Most-active and biggest movers among NYSE, NYSE Arca, NYSE Amer. and Nasdaq issues from 4 p.m. to 6 p.m. ET as reported by electronic trading services, securities dealers and regional exchanges. Minimum share price of \$2 and minimum after-hours volume of 50,000 shares.

Most-active issues in late trading

Company	Symbol	Volume (000)	Last	Net chg	After Hours % chg	High	Low
Direxion Dly Semi 3 Bear	SOXS	15,295.7	2.03	0.06	3.05	2.04	1.96
Advanced Micro Devices	AMD	9,827.6	223.73	-18.38	-7.59	249.55	222.71
Super Micro Computer	SMCI	9,680.5	30.99	1.32	4.45	32.91	29.04
Apple	AAPL	9,407.1	269.47	-0.01	-0.002	285.05	252.50
SLB	SLB	8,614.2	49.62	-0.14	-0.28	52.73	49.50
State Street SPDR S&P 500	SPY	8,456.3	688.84	-0.69	-0.10	689.92	653.01
Intel	INTC	7,885.8	48.97	-0.28	-0.57	49.50	48.60
NVIDIA	NVDA	7,549.1	178.96	-1.38	-0.77	180.92	167.55

Percentage gainers...

Silicon Laboratories	SLAB	239.0	182.50	45.88	33.58	198.99	136.62
8X8	EGHT	3,563.9	2.14	0.48	28.92	2.41	1.66
Enphase Energy	ENPH	2,463.1	45.00	7.72	20.71	46.36	34.70
Defiance Tgt 2X Shrt AMD	DAMD	228.7	20.75	2.70	14.96	20.97	16.94
Sonos	SONO	162.2	16.27	1.64	11.18	17.81	14.63

...And losers

Intapp	INTA	125.4	23.75	-5.56	-18.97	30.00	22.21
Leverage 2X Lg AMD Dly	AMDG	133.9	27.72	-5.52	-16.61	34.50	27.37
GrShr 2x Long AMD Daily	AMDG	4,960.8	16.32	-2.98	-15.44	20.49	16.16
Varonis Systems	VRNS	307.0	22.62	-3.91	-14.74	29.18	22.03
nLIGHT	LASR	69.9	45.84	-4.14	-8.28	49.98	44.50

Percentage Gainers...

Company	Symbol	Close	Net chg	% chg	52-Week High	52-Week Low	% chg
Leverage 2X Lg USAR Dly	USGG	28.65	7.60	36.08	43.67	12.22	...
Leverage 2X Lg UUUU Dly	UUUG	21.92	5.60	34.31	30.00	14.87	...
Phaos Tech (Cayman)	POAS	4.99	1.24	33.07	4.99	2.90	...
Atlas Critical Minerals	ATCX	8.68	1.95	28.97	47.16	4.80	-26.9
Creative Global Tech	CGTL	5.08	1.10	27.64	6.52	0.41	-2.3
Texxon Holding	NPT	7.20	1.50	26.32	13.48	3.14	...
Leverage 2X Lg TER Dly	TERG	38.01	7.87	26.12	38.60	12.19	...
United States Antimony	UAMY	9.65	1.79	22.77	19.71	1.21	421.6
NioCorp Developments	NB	7.50	1.34	21.75	12.58	1.59	193.0
Velo3D	VELO	15.32	2.72	21.59	23.84	1.43	-26.0
DaVita	DVA	134.73	23.54	21.17	178.47	101.00	-24.0
Critical Metals	CRML	15.14	2.55	20.25	32.15	1.23	79.2
Hycroft Mining Holding	HYMC	42.07	6.86	19.48	58.73	2.22	1631.3
Syntec Optics CI A	OPTX	8.00	1.29	19.23	8.00	1.02	300.0
Defiance Tgt 2X Lg RKL B	RKLX	49.48	7.97	19.20	78.00	3.81	...

Most Active Stocks

Company	Symbol	Volume (000)	% chg from 65-day avg	Latest Session Close	% chg	52-Week High	52-Week Low
Tian Ruixiang	TIRX	1,250,638	15273.7	0.15	98.41	10.75	0.07
Direxion Dly Semi 3 Bear	SOXS	771,322	116.4	1.97	6.49	53.43	1.72
ProSh UltSh Silver	ZSL	391,830	255.7	2.23	-12.89	40.13	1.44
NVIDIA	NVDA	202,245	9.2	180.34	-2.84	212.19	86.62
Gaxos.ai	GXAI	186,925	9119.4	2.00	41.84	2.96	1.00
Strive CI A	ASST	185,861	77.0	0.68	-5.68	13.42	0.39
iShares Silver Trust	SLV	173,490	110.9	76.96	6.24	109.83	26.57
PayPal Holdings	PYPL	140,998	733.5	41.70	-20.31	82.69	41.43
ProShares UltraPro QQQ	TQQQ	128,720	26.5	52.52	-4.68	60.69	17.50
iShares Bitcoin Trust ETF	IBIT	124,743	101.5	43.30	-2.08	71.82	41.30

* Volumes of 100,000 shares or more are rounded to the nearest thousand

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Percentage Losers

Company	Symbol	Close	Net chg	% chg	52-Week High	52-Week Low	% chg
Massimo Group	MAMO	1.28	-1.88	-59.49	5.59	1.21	-59.1
Leverage 2X Lg PYPL Dly	PYPG	5.23	-3.60	-40.77	22.80	5.14	...
PMGC Holdings	ELAB	2.01	-1.34	-40.00	189.14	1.85	-98.8
Polaryx Therapeutics	PLYX	21.95	-13.05	-37.29	48.91	16.70	...
Leverage 2X Lg GLXY Dly	GLGG	7.68	-4.01	-34.29	45.80	6.69	...
China SXT Pharm	SXTX	4.53	-1.94	-29.93	1176.00	4.01	-99.1
Defiance Target 2X Lg NVO	NVOX	20.05	-8.35	-29.40	105.60	16.08	-76.1
VenHub Global	VHUB	57.06	2.75	-2.32	-28.71	40.30	5.56
Corvel	CRVL	51.58	-18.17	-26.05	128.61	51.42	-58.6
HUHUTECH Intl	HUHU	5.00	-1.49	-22.96	12.20	2.95	20.2
FuboTV	FUBO	1.77	-0.50	-22.03	4.72	1.57	-61.4
Fusemachines	FUSE	2.12	-0.58	-21.48	25.00	1.45	-81.7
Gartner	IT	160.16	-42.24	-20.87	584.01	139.18	-70.7
Clarivate	CLVT	2.11	-0.54	-20.38	5.26	2.10	-58.9
AsiaStrategy	SORA	2.23	-0.57	-20.36	14.15	1.57	...

Volume Movers

Ranked by change from 65-day average*

Company	Symbol	Volume (000)	% chg from 65-day avg	Latest Session Close	% chg	52-Week High	52-Week Low
Texxon Holding	NPT	35,711	51430	7.20	26.32	13.48	3.14
Black Spade Acqn III	BIII	1,054	9898	9.94	-0.17	10.02	9.92
AstraZeneca	AZN	2,659	5093	184.32	-2.10	195.00	122.26
Allspring LT Large Growth	AGRW	331	3966	29.16	-2.49	31.48	20.68
WT China exStateOwn	CXSE	2,148	3953	40.77	-0.10	45.65	27.81
Allspring Special Lg Val	ASLV	329	3206	29.29	0.13	29.40	21.86
Innov Intl Dev Pwr Feb	IFEB	202	2611	30.59	0.03	33.48	24.86
FIEE	FIEE	2,626	2282	4.48	-13.18	7.95	0.16
SoFi Next 500 ETF	SFYX	120	2194	16.96	0.18	17.91	11.57
Leverage 2X Lg TER Dly	TERG	202	2153	38.01	26.12	38.60	12.19

* Common stocks priced at \$2 a share or more with an average volume over 65 trading days of at least 5,000 shares *Has traded fewer than 65 days

CURRENCIES & COMMODITIES

Currencies

U.S.-dollar foreign-exchange rates at 5 p.m. ET

Country/currency	Tues in US\$	US\$ vs. YTD chg per US\$ (%)	Country/currency	Tues in US\$	US\$ vs. YTD chg per US\$ (%)
Americas			Vietnam dong .00003846 26002 -1.1		
Argentina peso .00071444 9635 -0.4			Europe		
Brazil real .1909 5.2392 -5.0			Czech Rep. koruna .04857 20.589 0.1		
Canada dollar .7330 1.3643 -0.6			Denmark krone .1583 6.3184 -0.6		
Chile peso .001163 860.08 -4.5			Euro area euro 1.1819 .8461 -0.6		
Colombia peso .000273 3656.50 -3.01			Hungary forint .003103 322.24 -1.6		
Ecuador US dollar 1 1 unch			Iceland krona .008151 122.69 -2.1		
Mexico peso .0580 17.2287 -4.3			Norway krone .1039 9.6256 -4.6		
Uruguay peso .02595 38.5400 -1.3			Poland zloty .2798 3.5736 -0.5		
Asia-Pacific			Sweden krona .1123 8.9034 -3.3		
Australia dollar .7021 1.4243 -4.9			Switzerland franc 1.2902 .7751 -2.2		
China yuan .1441 6.9382 -0.8			Turkey lira .0230 43.4812 1.2		
Hong Kong dollar .1280 7.8131 0.4			Ukraine hryvnia .0231 43.3500 2.4		
India rupee .01106 90.423 0.6			UK pound 1.3698 .7300 -1.6		
Indonesia rupiah .0000596 16.767 0.4			Middle East/Africa		
Japan yen .006420 155.77 -0.6			Bahrain dinar 2.6527 .3770 ...		
Kazakhstan tenge .001998 500.41 -1.4			Egypt pound .0213 47.0060 -1.5		
Macau pataca .1242 8.0515 0.4			Israel shekel .3238 3.0879 -3.1		
Malaysia ringgit .2543 3.9325 -3.1			Kuwait dinar 3.2567 .3071 -0.3		
New Zealand dollar .6045 1.6543 -4.8			Oman sul rial 2.5991 .3847 -0.1		
Pakistan rupee .00357 279.925 -0.1			Qatar rial .2751 3.635 -0.5		
Philippines peso .0169 59.667 0.2			Saudi Arabia riyal .2667 3.7502 -0.02		
Singapore dollar .7875 1.2699 -1.2			South Africa rand .0626 15.9725 -3.6		
South Korea won .0006894 1450.44 0.7			Close Net Chg % Chg YTD % Chg		
Sri Lanka rupee .0032323 309.38 ...			WSJ Dollar Index 94.76 -0.23 -0.24 -1.21		
Taiwan dollar .03165 31.594 0.8			Sources: Tulliet Prehron Dow Jones Market Data		
Thailand baht .03159 31.660 0.5					

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Futures Contracts

Metal & Petroleum Futures						
	Open	Contract High hilo	Low	Settle	Chg	Open interest
Copper-High (CMX) -25,000 lbs.; \$ per lb.						
Feb	5.8745	6.0745	5.8695	6.0625	0.2610	2,387
March	5.8395	6.1150	5.8300	6.0865	0.2610	126,235
Gold (CMX) -100 troy oz.; \$ per troy oz.						
Feb	4680.00	4984.60	4674.30	4903.70	281.20	5,721
March	4679.30	5000.00	4679.30	4917.70	281.20	4,966
April	4691.00	5018.10	4690.20	4935.00	282.40	293,249
May	4842.20	5024.30	4807.80	4953.40	283.60	173
June	4748.00	5055.40	4720.90	4971.40	285.00	57,450
July	4900.00	5009.30	4840.00	4989.30	286.20	65
Palladium (NYM) -50 troy oz.; \$ per troy oz.						
Feb	1643.50	1668.50	▼ 1625.00	1746.10	56.20	61
March	1740.50	1841.00	1705.00	1758.60	53.60	14,843
Platinum (NYM) -50 troy oz.; \$ per troy oz.						
Feb	2096.70	2105.00	▼ 2082.90	2195.60	102.10	200
April	2127.80	2277.30	2108.20	2208.80	104.70	58,472
Silver (CMX) -5,000 troy oz.; \$ per troy oz.						
Feb	80.125	88.195	80.000	83.042	6.264	766
March	79.220	89.100	79.010	83.301	6.292	86,440
Crude Oil, Light Sweet (NYM) -1,000 bbls.; \$ per bbl.						
March	62.28	64.21	61.12	63.21	1.07	348,001
April	61.89	63.75	60.71	62.83	1.11	214,884
May	61.42	63.35	60.37	62.48	1.14	142,463
June	61.09	62.98	60.08	62.15	1.15	192,909
Dec	59.48	61.16	58.72	60.54	1.13	246,746
Dec'27	59.41	60.85	59.05	60.43	0.86	102,853
NY Harbor ULSD (NYM) -42,000 gal.; \$ per gal.						
March	2.3717	2.4422	2.3334	2.4093	-.0495	104,973
April	2.2839	2.3530	2.2518	2.3266	-.0516	58,008
Gasoline-NY RBOB (NYM) -42,000 gal.; \$ per gal.						
March	1.8546	1.9181	1.8305	1.8979	-.0465	112,054
April	2.0864	2.1497	2.0673	2.1306	-.0427	88,500
Natural Gas (NYM) -10,000 MMBtu.; \$ per MMBtu.						
March	3.263	3.397	3.169	3.311	-.074	352,113
April	3.182	3.280	3.099	3.193	-.020	174,202
May	3.227	3.299	3.118	3.208	-.013	128,440
July	3.601	3.709	3.517	3.636	-.023	106,497
Oct	3.683	3.795	3.595	3.725	-.032	141,833
Jan'27	4.809	4.914	4.724	4.854	-.049	92,406

Agriculture Futures						
Corn (CBT) -5,000 bu.; cents per bu.						
March	425.75	429.25	425.50	428.50	2.75	653,042
May	433.25	436.75	433.25	435.75	2.25	349,461
Oats (CBT) -5,000 bu.; cents per bu.						
March	302.00	306.75	300.00	304.75	4.00	2,755
May	307.25	310.75	306.00	309.75	2.75	1,360
Soybeans (CBT) -5,000 bu.; cents per bu.						
March	1060.50	1071.00	1060.00	1065.75	5.50	341,760
May	1072.50	1083.00	1072.50	1077.25	4.75	200,951
Soybean Meal (CBT) -100 tons; \$ per ton.						
March	294.00	294.70	291.60	291.90	-2.60	205,866
May	297.50	298.50	295.30	295.70	-2.50	141,824
Soybean Oil (CBT) -60,000 lbs.; cents per lb.						
March	53.35	54.80	53.35	54.49	1.29	205,931
May	53.79	55.31	53.79	55.03	1.29	163,025

Cash Prices | wsj.com/market-data/commodities

These prices reflect buying and selling of a variety of actual or "physical" commodities in the marketplace—separate from the futures price on an exchange, which reflects what the commodity might be worth in future months.

Tuesday		Tuesday		Tuesday	
Energy				Food	
Coal,C,Apic,12500Btu,1.2502-r,w	81.000	BMi Lithium Carbonate, EXW China, ~99.5%-v,v	24125	Beef,carcass equiv. index	
Coal,Pwdr,RvBsn,8800Btu,0.8502-r,w	15.000	BMi Lithium Hydroxide, EXW China, ~56.5%-v,v	24200	choice 1-3,600-900 lbs-u	360.66
Metals		BMi Cobalt Sulphate, EXW China, >20.5%-v,v	13968	select 1-3,600-900 lbs-u	354.15
		BMi Nickel Sulphate, EXW China, >22%-v,k	4763	Butters, National comp wtd. avg.-w,u	1.1837
		BMi Flake Graphite, FOB China, -100 Mesh, 94-95%-v,m	413	Broiler, AA, Chicago-d	1.5800
		Fibers and Textiles		Cheddar cheese,bbl,Chicago-d	141.00
Gold, per troy oz		Burlap,10-oz,40-11yd-nw	1.2060	Cheddar cheese,blk,Chicago-d	140.50
Engelhard industrial	4926.00	Cotton,1,1/16 std lw-mdMphs-u	6.0606	Milk,Nonfat dry,Chicago-lb-d	150.00
Kruggerand,wholesale-e	5151.31	Cotlook 'A' Index-t	*73.80	Coffee,Brazilian,Comp-y	3.2130
Maple Leaf-e	5274.54	Hides,hvy native steers piece fob-u	n.a.	Coffee,Colombian, NY-y	3.5213
American Eagle-e	5274.54	Wool,64s,staple,Terr del-u-w	n.a.	Eggs,large white,Chicago-u,w	1.2950
Mexican peso-e	6359.52	Grains and Feeds		Flour,hard winter KC-p	14.80
Austria crown-e	4834.88	Bran,wheat middlings, KC-u,w	123	Hams,17-20 lbs,Mid-US fob-u	n.a.
Austria phil-e	5175.95	Corn,No. 2 yellow,Cent IL-bp,u	4.0900	Hogs,lowa-So. Minnesota-u	84.87
		Cottonseed meal-u,w	n.a.	Pork bellies,12-14 lb MidUS-u	1.5456
Silver, troy oz.		Hominy feed,Cent IL-u,w	118	Pork loins,13-19 lb MidUS-u	1.0563
Engelhard industrial	88.0000	Meat-bonermeal,50% pro Mnpls-u,w	260	Steers,Tex.-Okla. Choice-u	n.a.
Handy & Harman base	87.0880	Oats,No.2 milling,Mnpls-u	3.7975	Steers,feeder,Okla. City-u,w	441.50
Handy & Harman fabricated	108.8600	Rice, Long Grain Milled, No. 2 AR-u,w	28.50	Fats and Oils	
Coins,wholesale \$1,000 face-a	5946.0	SoybeanMeal,Cent IL,rail,ton48%-u,w	300.20	Degummed corn oil, crude wtd. avg.-w,u	n.a.
Other metals		Soybeans,No.1 yllw IL-lb-p,u	10.3800	Grease,choice white,Chicago-h	0.5000
Platinum,Engelhard industrial	2257.0	Wheat,Spring14%-pro Mnpls-u	7.5575	Lard,Chicago-u	n.a.
Palladium,Engelhard industrial	1827.0	Wheat,No.2 soft red St.Louis-u	5.2275	Soybean oil,crude,CentIL-u,w	0.5331
Aluminum,LME,\$ per metric ton	*3042.0	Wheat- Hard - KC (USA) \$ per bu-u	5.1475	Tallow,bleach,Chicago-h	0.5500
Copper,Comex spot	6.0625	Wheat,No.1soft white,Portld,OR-u	5.9500	Tallow,edible,Chicago-u	n.a.
Iron Ore, 62% Fe CFR China-s	*102.4				
Steel,HRC USA, FOB Midwest Mill-s	*950.0				
Battery/EV metals					

KEY TO CODES: A=aask; B=bid; BP=country elevator bids to producers; C=corrected; D=CME; E=Manfra,Tordella & Brookes; H=American Commodities Brokerage Co; K=bi-weekly; M=monthly; N=nominal; n.a.=not quoted or not available; P=Posland Publishing; R=SNL Energy; S=Platts-TSI; T=Comlook Limited; U=USDA; V=Benchmark Mineral Intelligence; W=weekly; Y=International Coffee Organization; Z=not quoted. *Data as of 2/2

Source: Dow Jones Market Data

Borrowing Benchmarks | wsj.com/market-data/bonds/benchmarks

Money Rates

Key annual interest rates paid to borrow or lend money in U.S. and international markets. Rates below are a guide to general levels but don't always represent actual transactions.

Inflation				Week				-52-WEEK-						
	Dec. index	Chg From (%)		Latest	Week ago	High	Low		Latest	Week ago	High	Low		
				Britain	3.75	3.75	4.75	3.75	13 weeks	3.60	3.580	4.300	3.540	
				Australia	3.60	3.60	4.35	3.60	26 weeks	3.525	3.525	4.220	3.475	
U.S. consumer price index														
All items	324.054	-0.02	2.7	Overnight repurchase										
Core	330.506	0.02	2.7	U.S.	3.71	3.71	4.46	3.65	Other short-term rates					
International rates														
	Latest	Week ago	-52-Week-	Discount										
			High Low		3.75	3.75	4.50	3.75	Call money					
									5.50	5.50	6.25	5.50		
Prime rates				Commercial paper (AA financial)										
U.S.	6.75	6.75	7.50	6.75	90 days									
Canada	4.45	4.45	5.45	4.45	n.a.									
Japan	1.875	1.875	1.875	1.625	Secured Overnight Financing Rate									
Policy Rates														
Euro zone	2.15	2.15	3.15	2.15	3.69									
Switzerland	0.50	0.50	1.00	0.50	Latest									
				Value Traded										
				-52-Week-										
				High Low										
				DTCC GCF Repo Index										

Notes on data: U.S. prime rate is the base rate on corporate loans posted by at least 70% of the 10 largest U.S. banks, and is effective December 11, 2025. Other prime rates aren't directly comparable; lending practices vary widely by location. Discount rate is effective December 11, 2025. Secured Overnight Financing Rate is as of February 2, 2026. DTCC GCF Repo Index is Depository Trust & Clearing Corp.'s weighted average for overnight trades in applicable CUSIPs. Value traded is in billions of U.S. dollars. Federal funds rates are Tullett Prebon rates as of 5:30 p.m. ET.

Sources: Federal Reserve; Bureau of Labor Statistics; DTCC; FactSet; Tullett Prebon Information, Ltd.

Exchange-Traded Portfolios | wsj.com/market-data/mutualfunds-etfs

Largest 100 exchange-traded funds, latest session.										ETF				
Tuesday, February 3, 2026										ETF				
ETF	Symbol	Closing Price	Chg (%)	YTD (%)	ETF	Symbol	Closing Price	Chg (%)	YTD (%)	ETF	Symbol	Closing Price	Chg (%)	YTD (%)
CapGrpDivVal	CDGV	44.73	-0.47	2.5	ISHRuss2000	IWM	262.78	0.23	6.8	SSIMSPDRSP6500	SPY	689.53	-0.85	1.1
DimenUSCoreEq2	DFAC	40.79	-0.44	3.0	ISHS&P500Grw	IWM	122.27	-1.62	-0.8	SSIMSPDRSP6400	MLX	633.88	0.19	5.1
InvsNasd100	QQQM	253.81	-1.56	0.4	ISHS&P500Value	IWE	218.93	-0.05	3.2	VanEckGoldMin	GDXX	98.22	4.28	14.5
InvsQQQ	QQQ	616.52	-1.54	0.4	ISHS&P100	IEF	341.91	-1.00	-0.3	VanEckSemicon	SMH	397.68	-2.52	10.4
InvsS&P500EW	RSP	198.57	-0.27	3.7	ISh7-10YTreaBd	IEF	95.53	0.09	-0.7	VangdSctVal	VBR	225.64	0.30	6.5
IShBitcoin	IBIT	43.30	-2.08	-12.8	IShSilver	SLV	76.96	6.24	19.5	VangdDivD	VTV	214.93	0.20	2.8
IShBrdUSDHYGcpBd	USHY	37.42	-0.11	0.1	ISh20+YTreaBd	TLT	86.76	0.24	-0.5	VangdDivAAPL	VDV	225.30	-0.40	2.5
IShCoreDivGrowth	DGRO	72.51	0.25	4.5	ISHUSExFactRotat	DYFN	61.64	-0.47	1.4	VangdTSEAWXUS	WEA	78.37	0.27	6.5
IShCoreDiversEAFE	IEFA	94.61	0.07	5.8	ISHUSTreasuryBd	GOVT	22.94	0.04	-0.4	VangdTSEDEVMK	VEA	66.72	0.39	5.8
IShCoreMSCIEM	IEMG	73.15	0.44	8.8	ISH0-3MTreaBd	SGOV	100.39	0.02	0.0	VangdTSEEM	WMT	56.75	-0.05	5.6
IShMSCIIntDev	IDEV	87.03	0.18	5.5	JPMNasdaqEqPrem	JEPO	58.62	-1.28	0.9	VangdTSEEurope	VGK	87.87	-0.37	5.1
IShMSCIStkTotInt	IXUS	90.11	0.30	6.5	JanusHendersonAAA	JAAA	50.68	-0.02	0.2	VangdHDiv	VGH	473.45	-1.94	-3.0
IShCoreSP500	IIVV	692.57	-0.85	1.1	JPMHempson	JEPI	58.26	-0.27	1.8	VangdInfoTech	VBT	736.44	-2.21	2.3
IShCoreSP6 MC	IJH	69.38	0.19	5.1	JPMUStShlncom	JPST	50.61	...	0.0	VangdIntermBd	BM	77.53	0.04	-0.4
IShCoreSP6 SC	IJR	128.24	-0.09	6.7	ProSharePrQQQ	TOQQ	52.52	-4.68	-0.4	VangdIntlrCorpBd	CIT	83.54	0.02	-0.3
IShCoreSP6TotUS	ITOT	150.61	-0.78	1.3	SPDRDJIA Tr	DIA	492.31	-0.35	2.4	VangdIntermTrea	VIG	59.65	0.03	-0.5
IShCoreSP6USGrw	IUSG	167.15	-1.54	-0.5	SPDRGoldMini	GLDM	97.87	6.39	14.6	VangdGLC	VGL	316.92	-0.97	0.7
IShCoreUSAggBd	AGG	99.20	0.01	-0.2	SPDRGold	GLD	254.29	6.36	14.6	VangdMegaGrwth	MKG	398.11	-2.06	-3.6
IShCoreUSUniUSDBd	UAL	46.37	0.02	-0.2	SPDRGold	GLD	254.29	6.36	14.6	VangdMCM	MO	296.70	-2.24	2.6
IShEdgeMSCIUSAqua	QUAL	20.37	-1.16	1.4	SchwabIntlEquity	SCHF	25.62	0.23	6.8	VangdRealEst	VNQ	89.66	-0.22	1.3
IShGoldTr	IAU	93.03	6.24	14.6	SchwabUS BrdMkt	SCHB	26.58	-0.78	1.3	VangdRuss1000Grw	VNG	118.18	-0.76	-2.9
IShBoxxSP5Cpb	LQD	110.01	0.05	-0.1	SchwabUS Div	SCHD	30.50	1.67	11.2	VangdSP500ETF	VO	634.15	-0.86	1.1
IShMBS	MBB	95.25	0.02	0.0	SchwabUSLC	SCHX	27.17	-0.84	1.0	VangdSTBond	BSV	78.64	0.03	-0.2
IShMSCIACWI	ACWI	145.54	-0.53	2.9	SchwabUSLC Grw	SCHG	31.44	-1.96	-3.6	VangdSTCpBd	VCSH	79.68	-0.01	-0.1
IShMSCIEAFE	EFA	101.45	0.05	5.6	SSIMCommsSvcsSel	XLC	117.74	-1.61	0.0	VangdShortTrea	VSHS	58.65	...	-0.1
IShMSCIEAFEValue	EEM	59.60	0.54	8.9	SSIMEnergySel	XLE	51.67	3.24	15.6	VangdSC	VS	272.22	1.18	5.5
IShNatlMuniBd	EFV	76.60	0.86	7.3	SSIMFinlSel	XLF	53.53	-0.93	-2.3	VangdTaxExemptBd	VTEB	50.50	0.04	0.4
IShRussMCI	MUB	107.63	-0.03	0.5	SSIMHlthGrSel	XLI	154.10	-1.02	-0.5	VangdTotlIntBd	BND	73.93	0.03	-0.2
IShRussMCI	IWR	99.71	-0.09	3.6	SSIMIntlSel	XIL	168.94	0.84	8.9	VangdTotlBd	BNDX	48.41	-0.04	0.2
IShRuss1000	IWB	37.31	-0.86	1.0	SSIMSPDRBbg1-3M	BM	91.39	...	0.0	VangdTotIntStk	VXUS	80.31	0.25	6.5
IShRuss1000Grw	IWF	49.18	-1.78	-3.0	SSIMSPDRDevUS	SPDW	47.40	0.34	6.7	VangdTotlStk	VTV	339.85	-0.77	1.4
IShRuss1000Val	IWD	22.91	0.11	5.5	SSIMSPDRSP500	SPY	81.33	-0.87	1.1	VangdTotWrldStk	VTW	145.67	0.37	3.2
					SSIMSPDRSP6500	SPY	105.86	-1.64	-0.8	VangdValue	VTV	202.47	0.51	6.0
					SSIMSPDRSP6400	SPYV	58.66	-0.02	3.3					

BIGGEST 1,000 STOCKS

How to Read the Stock Tables

The following explanations apply to NYSE, NYSE Arca, NYSE American and Nasdaq Stock Market data. Prices are based on trades reported to various market centers, including securities exchanges, Finra, electronic communications networks and other broker-dealers. The list comprises the 1,000 largest companies based on market capitalization.

Underlined quotations are those stocks with large changes in volume compared with the issue's average trading volume.

Boldfaced quotations highlight those issues whose price changed by 5% or more if their previous closing price was \$2 or higher.

Footnotes:

F-New 52-week high; F-New 52-week low; dd-Indicates loss in the most recent four quarters.

Stock tables reflect composite regular trading as of 4 p.m. ET and changes in the official closing prices from 4 p.m. ET the previous day.

Tuesday, February 3, 2026

Stock	Sym	Close	Net Chg	Stock	Sym	Close	Net Chg	Stock	Sym	Close	Net Chg
A	B	C	D	E	F	G	H	I	J	K	L
AECOM	ACM	95.51	-1.30	Aflac	AFL	112.04	0.09	Agilent	AGN	114.9	0.32
AEOS	AEOS	16.09	1.36	Alkermes	ALK	264.57	-0.51	Alkermes	ALK	264.57	-0.51
Aflac	AFL	112.04	0.09	Alkermes	ALK	264.57	-0.51	Alkermes	ALK	264.57	-0.51
AGNC Invst	AGNC	11.49	0.32	Alkermes	ALK	264.57	-0.51	Alkermes	ALK	264.57	-0.51
APA	APA	26.46	0.57	Alkermes	ALK	264.57	-0.51	Alkermes	ALK	264.57	-0.51
Ascent	ASCN	17.09	-0.02	Alkermes	ALK	264.57	-0.51	Alkermes	ALK	264.57	-0.51
ASML	ASML	139.85	-45.51	Alkermes	ALK	264.57	-0.51	Alkermes	ALK	264.57	-0.51
AST Space	ASTS	11.75	11.21	Alkermes	ALK	264.57	-0.51	Alkermes	ALK	264.57	-0.51
AT&T	ATT	128.34	0.57	Alkermes	ALK	264.57	-0.51	Alkermes	ALK	264.57	-0.51
ATI	ATI	128.34	0.57	Alkermes	ALK	264.57	-0.51	Alkermes	ALK	264.57	-0.51
AXIA	AXIA	1.97	-0.01	Alkermes	ALK	264.57	-0.51	Alkermes	ALK	264.57	-0.51
AXIA	AXIA	1.97	-0.01	Alkermes	ALK	264.57	-0.51	Alkermes	ALK	264.57	-0.51
AXIA	AXIA	1.97	-0.01	Alkermes	ALK	264.57	-0.51	Alkermes	ALK	264.57	-0.51
AXIA	AXIA	1.97	-0.01	Alkermes	ALK	264.57	-0.51	Alkermes	ALK	264.57	-0.51
AXIA	AXIA	1.97	-0.01	Alkermes	ALK	264.57	-0.51	Alkermes	ALK	264.57	-0.51
AXIA	AXIA	1.97	-0.01	Alkermes	ALK	264.57	-0.51	Alkermes	ALK	264.57	-0.51
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AXIA	AXIA	1.97	-0.01	Alkermes	ALK	264.57	-0.51	Alkermes	ALK	264.57	-0.51
AXIA	AXIA	1.97	-0.01	Alkermes	ALK	264.57	-0.51	Alkermes	ALK	264.57	-0.51
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AXIA	AXIA	1.97	-0.01	Alkermes	ALK	264.57	-0.51	Alkermes	ALK	264.57	-0.51
AXIA	AXIA	1.97	-0.01	Alkermes	ALK	264.57	-0.51	Alkermes	ALK	264.57	-0.51
AXIA	AXIA	1.97	-0.01	Alkermes	ALK	264.57	-0.51	Alkermes	ALK	264.57	-0.51
AXIA	AXIA	1.97	-0.01	Alkermes	ALK	264.57	-0.51	Alkermes	ALK	264.57	-0.51
AXIA	AXIA	1.97	-0.01	Alkermes	ALK	264.57	-0.51	Alkermes	ALK	264.57	-0.51
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AXIA	AXIA	1.97	-0.01	Alkermes	ALK	264.57	-0.51	Alkermes	ALK	264.57	-0.51
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AXIA	AXIA	1.97	-0.01	Alkermes	ALK	264.57	-0.51	Alkermes	ALK	264.57	-0.51
AXIA	AXIA	1.97	-0.01	Alkermes	ALK	264.57	-0.51	Alkermes	ALK		

BUSINESS & FINANCE

Santander Buys Webster, Expanding U.S. Footprint

By GINA HEEB, CHRIS WACK
AND ELIAS SCHISGALL

Banco Santander is buying **Webster Financial** in a cash-and-stock deal valued at \$12.3 billion, marking an escalation in the Spanish banking giant's push to expand its presence in the U.S.

The deal would put Santander in contention with big regional U.S. banks. Santander called it “strategically significant” for its U.S. business and said it would make it a top bank in the Northeast. With more than \$80 billion in assets, Stamford, Conn.-based Webster has dozens of branches throughout Connecticut, Massachusetts, Rhode Island and the New York metro area.

Though Santander is one of the largest banks in Europe and a major U.S. auto lender, its presence in the U.S. has otherwise been more limited. It has branches and ATMs across the Northeast, including in many **CVS** stores.

The deal is expected to

close in the second half.

Banks are under pressure to grow to compete with megabanks, as well as crypto and fintech companies that want to operate more like banks themselves. A string of larger bank deals have already been announced under the Trump administration, which has taken a friendlier stance toward them.

As part of the transaction, Webster would become a wholly owned unit of **Santander**. Christiana Riley would remain country head in the U.S. for Santander and chief executive of Santander Holdings USA.

Webster stockholders would receive \$48.75 in cash and 2.0548 Santander American depositary shares for each Webster common share.

Midsized banks have been un-

der pressure to reduce expenses. Webster was one of the regional banks that had higher exposure to the troubled commercial real-estate sector.

Webster Chief Executive John Ciulla would be the head of Santander Bank NA, into which all of Webster's businesses would be integrated. Luis Massiani, Webster's president and operating chief, would be operating chief of both Santander Holdings USA and Santander Bank NA.

Ciulla and Massiani, along with two other current directors of Webster, are expected to join the boards of directors of both Santander Holdings USA and Santander Bank NA. Tim Ryan would continue to chair the boards of directors of both Santander Holdings USA and Santander Bank NA.

Canada to Claim Stellantis, GM Owe Hundreds of Millions

By PAUL VIEIRA

OTTAWA—Canada estimates that officials will aim to recover “hundreds of millions of dollars” from **Stellantis** and **General Motors** after the carmakers scaled back production in the country, Industry Minister Melanie Joly said Tuesday.

Joly said she would provide more details in the coming days. Seeking compensation of that scale is likely to escalate tension between Ottawa and North American automakers, whose share of automobile production in Canada has declined steadily in the past decade.

Canadian officials and representatives from Stellantis have been in talks since at least November after the automaker said it would shift production of the Jeep Compass from a factory in Brampton, Ontario, to Illinois. Earlier this decade, Canada provided the equivalent of just over C\$1 billion, or about US\$731 million, to

the automaker to reconfigure the Brampton plant and maintain production in Canada.

“A lot of our support was linked to production, and therefore if there was no production, obviously there was no funding,” said Joly, before a cabinet meeting. She has previously threatened to sue Stellantis to get taxpayers’ money back.

Last week, Joly told the Canadian Broadcasting Corp. that she would also seek money from GM after the Detroit-based company followed through last week on its plan to cancel a third shift at its factory in Oshawa, Ontario. Last October, GM also said it wouldn’t resume production of an electric van at a factory in Ingersoll, Ontario, citing weak demand. At that time, Joly said she would seek repayment from GM on some of the C\$260 million that Ottawa provided for the Ingersoll factory.

A spokeswoman for Stellantis said the company is fo-

cused on talks with Canadian officials about securing a future for automotive production in Canada. Previously, Stellantis said almost 240 employees from the Brampton factory accepted transfer offers to work at a company factory in Windsor, Ontario.

A spokeswoman for General Motors wasn’t available to comment.

Data from the Trillium Network for Advanced Manufacturing, a nonprofit organization, indicate that the share of auto production in Canada from Stellantis, GM and **Ford Motor** has declined to 23% last year from 56% in 2016. Conversely, **Honda** and **Toyota** account for 77% of auto production. Trillium Network, which is part of Western University in London, Ontario, said future government policy on encouraging auto production with financial incentives should shift its focus from the big U.S. carmakers to Honda, Toyota and other foreign manufacturers.

Mutual Funds

Data provided by LSEG																			
Top 250 mutual-funds listings for Nasdaq-published share classes by net assets.																			
e-Ex-distribution. f-Previous day's quotation. g-Footnotes x and s apply. j-Footnotes e and s apply. k-Recalculated by LSEG, using updated data. p-Distribution costs apply. 12b-1 r-Redemption charge may apply. s-Stock split or dividend. t-Footnotes p and r apply. v-Footnotes x and e apply. x-Ex-dividend. z-Footnote x, e and s apply. NA-Not available due to incomplete price, performance or cost data. NE-Not released by LSEG; data under review. NN-Fund not tracked. NS-Fund didn't exist at start of period.																			
Tuesday, February 3, 2026																			
Fund	NAV	Net Chg	YTD %Ret	Fund	NAV	Net Chg	YTD %Ret	Fund	NAV	Net Chg	YTD %Ret	Fund	NAV	Net Chg	YTD %Ret	Fund	NAV	Net Chg	YTD %Ret
AB Funds																			
MuniIncShares	11.21	-0.01	0.9	WshA	66.19	-0.42	1.5	EmMktCorEq	31.55	+0.39	8.5	IntlVal	30.79	+0.29	7.7	IntlCoreEq	21.57	+0.11	6.3
AB Funds - ADV																			
LgCpGrAdv	110.18	-2.27	-2.5	Artisan Funds	55.89	+0.32	3.9	IntlVal	30.79	+0.29	7.7	IntlSmCo	27.16	+0.14	6.2	SeriesBondFid	9.12	...	0.1
American Century Inv																			
Ultra	92.10	-1.73	-2.1	Baird Funds	9.92	...	0.1	IntlSmCo	27.16	+0.14	6.2	IntlSmVal	33.46	+0.34	8.0	SeriesOverseas	15.55	-0.06	4.2
American Funds CI A																			
AmcpA	45.44	-0.89	-1.3	AggBdInst	10.29	...	0.1	LgCo	45.92	-0.39	1.1	US CoreEq1	51.01	-0.22	2.8	SmCapVal	56.51	+0.56	9.4
AMutIA	60.85	-0.10	2.3	CorBdInst	10.29	...	0.1	US CoreEq2	45.63	-0.15	3.1	US TgdVal	40.19	+0.31	8.7	US TgdVal	40.19	+0.31	8.7
BalA	38.41	-0.17	2.5	IntlBdInst	10.54	...	0.1	US Small	55.81	+0.06	6.8	USLgVa	59.84	+0.36	6.3	USLgVa	59.84	+0.36	6.3
BondA	11.42	...	0.1	BlackRock Funds III	10.54	...	0.1	US Sml	55.81	+0.06	6.8	Dodge & Cox	13.78	-0.01	2.1	Balanced	13.78	-0.01	2.1
CapIBA	79.65	+0.05	3.6	BlackRock Funds Inst	9.82	+0.01	1.0	US Sml	55.81	+0.06	6.8	Income	12.88	...	0.2	Income	12.88	...	0.2
CapWGrA	75.04	-0.44	4.9	Calamos Funds	15.81	...	0.7	Intl Stk	17.50	+0.02	6.3	Intl Stk	17.50	+0.02	6.3	Intl Stk	17.50	+0.02	6.3
EupaCA	63.93	-0.06	5.7	Calamos Funds	15.81	...	0.7	Stock	16.91	-0.05	1.9	DoubleLine Funds	8.91	+0.01	0.2	TotRetBdI	8.91	+0.01	0.2
FdlInvA	94.68	-1.14	3.0	CausewayInst	24.69	-0.02	5.1	Dimensional Fds	40.17	+0.46	7.9	Fidelity	22.93	-2.93	-2.0	Total Bd	22.93	-2.93	-2.0
GwthA	79.64	-1.49	-1.0	CausewayInst	24.69	-0.02	5.1	EmgMktVat	40.17	+0.46	7.9	Fidelity Freedom	19.98	+0.01	2.9	FidSalCndmFnd	14.50	+0.09	1.8
ICAA	63.21	-0.73	0.9	Columbia Class I	38.12	+0.17	5.1	EmgMktVat	40.17	+0.46	7.9	Fidelity Freedom	19.98	+0.01	2.9	FidSalCndmFnd	14.50	+0.09	1.8
IncoA	27.20	+0.09	4.2	Divlncm I	38.12	+0.17	5.1	EmgMktVat	40.17	+0.46	7.9	Fidelity Freedom	19.98	+0.01	2.9	FidSalCndmFnd	14.50	+0.09	1.8
N PerA	71.74	-0.90	1.6	Divlncm I	38.12	+0.17	5.1	EmgMktVat	40.17	+0.46	7.9	Fidelity Freedom	19.98	+0.01	2.9	FidSalCndmFnd	14.50	+0.09	1.8
NEcoA	74.32	-1.20	2.3	Divlncm I	38.12	+0.17	5.1	EmgMktVat	40.17	+0.46	7.9	Fidelity Freedom	19.98	+0.01	2.9	FidSalCndmFnd	14.50	+0.09	1.8
NwWrldA	98.93	+0.09	6.1	Divlncm I	38.12	+0.17	5.1	EmgMktVat	40.17	+0.46	7.9	Fidelity Freedom	19.98	+0.01	2.9	FidSalCndmFnd	14.50	+0.09	1.8
SmCpA	76.78	+0.43	4.8	Divlncm I	38.12	+0.17	5.1	EmgMktVat	40.17	+0.46	7.9	Fidelity Freedom	19.98	+0.01	2.9	FidSalCndmFnd	14.50	+0.09	1.8

The WSJ CPO Council Summit | Talent Reimagined: CPOs at the Crossroads of Tech and Humanity

March 25-26, 2026 | Palo Alto

OVERVIEW

The WSJ's inaugural CPO Council Summit in Palo Alto examines how people leaders are navigating a hybrid workforce that integrates human and artificial intelligence capabilities. The program will explore strategies for identifying AI-ready talent and supporting employee resilience during periods of significant organizational change. Through expert-led sessions and peer discussions, participants will gain practical insight into managing AI-driven transformation. The agenda also includes senior-level networking and wellness experiences that complement the professional programming. The summit aims to strengthen the role of chief people officers as strategic advisors on the future of work.

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FINANCIAL ANALYSIS & COMMENTARY

How to Buy Gold and Silver at a Discount

At some precious-metals funds, price discrepancies have grown amid wild price swings

The volatility in precious metals is creating some strange anomalies for gold and silver investors, which could present an opportunity for treasure hunters.

While prices have swung wildly, some investments in the shiny metals haven't kept pace. **Sprott Physical Gold and Silver Trust**, a \$10 billion closed-end bullion fund, traded at the end of last week for a 9.5% discount to its net asset value. That was after gold and silver each posted record one-day declines on Jan. 30 of more than 11% and 31%, respectively; both metals were up sharply on Tuesday, reflecting the heightened volatility.

The discount was even bigger on Jan. 28, when the metals were near their peaks and the Sprott fund closed at a record 11.4% discount to net asset value. The fund's holdings consist of physical gold and silver bullion held at the Royal Canadian Mint, plus a small bit of cash, and the net asset value is updated daily for market prices.

One way to look at this anomaly: An investor on that day in essence was buying a dollar of gold and silver for 89 cents.

Of course, the timing would have been horrible, given what happened to gold and silver prices right afterward. But for bargain hunters seeking out deals amid the volatility, who are inclined already to invest in precious metals, closed-end bullion funds such as this could be a buying opportunity, at least while the large discounts remain.

While it is normal for closed-end funds, including this one, to trade at a discount to NAV, the sheer size of the Sprott fund's recent discount is unusual. Since its inception in 2018, the discount typically has been about 4%. On Monday, the discount shrank to 7.2%.

It isn't clear why the discount grew recently, except that the widening coincided with the recent spikes in volatility for gold and silver prices. Trying to make sense of the latest moves in gold and silver prices is hard enough.

The situation could be ripe for investors seeking pairs trades. Theoretically, an arbitrageur should be able to buy units in the Sprott fund and short a basket of gold and silver in the same proportion as the fund's holdings, profiting when they converge.

The Sprott fund's holdings by market value were about 59% gold and 41% silver at year-end. It trades on NYSE Arca and the Toronto Stock Exchange, and it has a 0.48% expense ratio.

To be sure, the prices might not ever converge, and such a trade would be complex and entail borrowing costs. The practical difficulty in taking advantage of the diverging prices through arbitrage also might help explain how the anomaly is possible. Strange anomalies can get stranger and remain so for a long time.

Everyday investors who want to buy the metals dip (and aren't interested in a complicated pairs trade) could figure that buying a closed-end bullion fund at a discount, instead of a more conventional gold or silver exchange-traded fund, gives them hope of adding to their eventual gains if the discount narrows.

Sprott didn't respond to requests for comment.

In its disclosures, Sprott says that since there are a fixed number of units outstanding at any given time, they may trade at a premium or a discount to net asset value, depending on investor demand. Unit holders have the right to redeem for physical metals monthly, although this is available only to large holders that can meet minimum redemption amounts. Sprott says this feature typically helps to reduce the discount, but it doesn't seem to have helped much lately.

Other Sprott closed-end bullion funds have seen widening discounts to net asset value. The \$17 billion **Sprott Physical Silver Trust** ended last week at a 9.4% discount to its net asset value, compared with a 1.7% discount just



While prices for precious metals have swung wildly, some investments in the shiny commodities haven't kept pace.

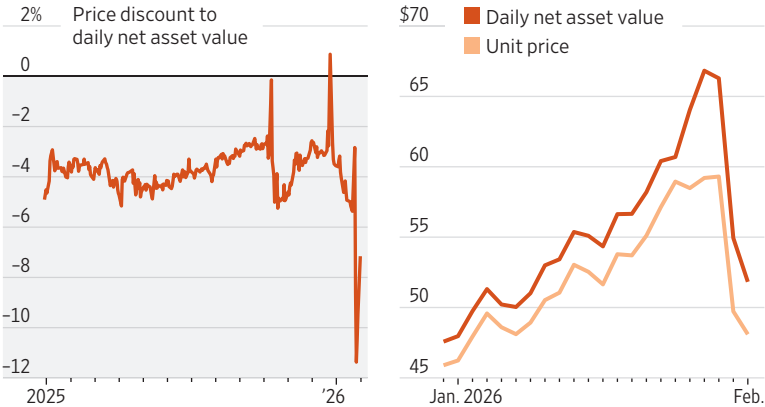
four days earlier. On Monday, the discount shrank to 4.9%.

The \$18 billion **Sprott Physical Gold Trust** ended last week at a 4.1% discount to its net asset value, compared with a 1.2% discount four days earlier. On Monday, the discount contracted to 3.4%.

Whatever explains the bouncing discounts, they are a reminder that when volatility surges, the values of similar assets can become disconnected, and even the relationship between prices for physical metals and funds that own them can break down. Eventually they should revert to the mean. There is just no telling when that will be.

—Jonathan Weil

Sprott Physical Gold and Silver Trust



Source: LSEG

Oracle Faces Risk From Nvidia's Pivot on OpenAI

The likelihood that **Nvidia** will be investing far less than \$100 billion in OpenAI raises big questions for **Oracle**.

Foremost are whether the ChatGPT developer can make good on its five-year, \$300 billion contract with Oracle, and whether the tech giant should really be recording the full amount of that deal on its own books.

As of Nov. 30, Oracle reported \$523 billion of remaining performance obligations, which represent contracted sales not yet recognized as revenue.

The figure, which is a closely watched footnote disclosure, was about nine times Oracle's revenue for the previous four quarters, and included the \$300 billion related to OpenAI. Oracle's stock soared in early September, at one point jumping 36% in a single day, after an earnings report showed its RPOs had more than tripled since the previous quarter.

OpenAI's relationship with Nvidia has epitomized concerns about circularity in artificial-intelligence deals. The companies' letter of intent, unveiled Sept. 22, called for Nvidia to invest as much as \$100 billion in OpenAI over many

years. While some of the money would flow back to Nvidia for its chips, some would help OpenAI pay for things like its deal for Oracle to supply computing capacity.

Amid concerns about its debt levels and OpenAI's reliability, Oracle has faced calls to raise equity to support its investment-grade rating. The company appears to be responding.

On Feb. 1, Oracle said it plans to issue as much as \$20 billion of common stock this year, as part of a broader plan to raise \$45 billion to \$50 billion through equity and debt financing to expand its cloud-infrastructure business.

Issuing stock would dilute shareholders, after they have already seen their shares lose about half their value since they peaked in September. But with the uncertainty and circularity of AI deals being what they are, boosting the company's equity cushion seems prudent.

For its part, Oracle is already building data centers, financed with new debt, in reliance on the contract it struck with OpenAI. Oracle and Nvidia also are major customers of each other, although Oracle recently signaled it would diversify

Oracle share price



*Remaining performance obligations
Source: FactSet

its AI-chip purchases beyond Nvidia.

Now a big chunk of OpenAI's anticipated funding is in doubt. This raises fresh questions about how OpenAI will pay for its estimated \$1.4 trillion of commitments, including those to Oracle. This will depend on its ability to raise money from investors and increase revenue dramatically.

An Oracle spokeswoman, Deborah Hellinger, said, "The Nvidia-OpenAI deal has zero impact on our

financial relationship with OpenAI. We remain highly confident in OpenAI's ability to raise funds and meet its commitments."

The Wall Street Journal reported on Jan. 30 that the September deal with Nvidia had stalled, after some inside Nvidia expressed doubts about the deal. Nvidia's chief executive, Jensen Huang, the next day told reporters in Taipei that the chip giant would "absolutely be involved" in OpenAI's latest funding round. When asked whether the amount would be over \$100 billion, he said: "No, no, nothing like that."

OpenAI is targeting \$100 billion for its latest fundraising effort, which could include Nvidia. **SoftBank Group** is in talks to invest as much as \$30 billion more, after boosting its stake to 11% in December when it invested \$22.5 billion. **Amazon.com** also is in talks to invest in the round, and OpenAI is aiming for an initial public offering in the fourth quarter of this year.

It is possible this all could happen, and OpenAI might raise the vast sums of money it needs. Or if OpenAI can't pay the full \$300 billion, then perhaps another customer could step in to fill its place. But all of that is speculative, and

the news that Nvidia is downsizing its commitment to OpenAI raises fresh questions about the likelihood that the \$300 billion will come through.

This means Oracle will have a pressing question regarding its own books: Is collecting the \$300 billion from OpenAI still "probable" in management's judgment? The answer has to be yes, under the accounting rules, for Oracle to include the sum in its RPOs.

How management answers the question in its coming financial reports, and how the market responds, could have knock-on effects. Oracle's investment-grade credit rating, now at triple-B, is on negative watch at S&P and Moody's, signaling a potential downgrade. Some of Oracle's debt, including a 10-year note sold in September, recently has been trading like junk bonds, and the cost to protect Oracle's debt against defaults has surged.

What Oracle can't afford to sacrifice is credibility. If the company's management continues to conclude that collectibility from OpenAI is probable, that judgment call had better be right.

—Jonathan Weil

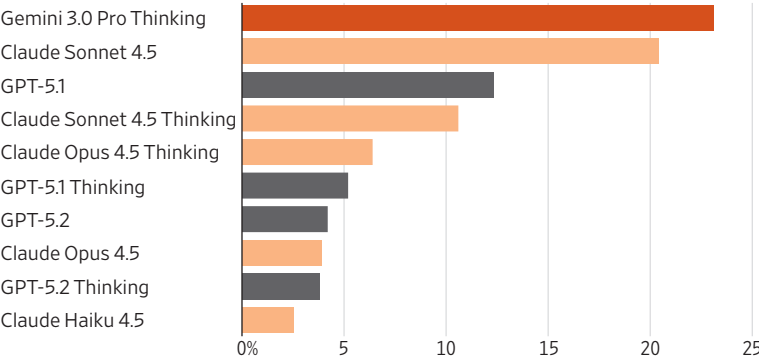
AI Users Have Many Choices. Few Companies Are Winning.

Which AI model do you use now? An even more interesting question might be: Which model do you think you will be using a year from now?

The unnerving thing about being in the LLM business is that the competition is only a click away. ChatGPT may have hit the market first, but the onset of models from Google, Anthropic, xAI and others have eaten into that first-mover advantage. That much was clear late last year, when Google launched Gemini 3 to great acclaim and sparked a "Code Red" moment at ChatGPT parent OpenAI.

Precise market-share figures aren't easy to come by, given the wide variety of ways that people and businesses use LLMs and their

Models selected by Perplexity Enterprise Pro users



Note: Data are for the month of December 2025.

Source: Perplexity AI

associated chatbots. One interesting view comes from Perplexity AI, creator of an AI-powered "answer engine" that provides con-

versational replies to search queries. Perplexity has a product called Enterprise Pro that allows users to select which AI model

they want to power their search experience.

Those choices have gotten a lot more diverse. In January of 2025, just over 90% of Perplexity Enterprise users were using one of just two models: Anthropic's Claude Sonnet 4 and OpenAI's ChatGPT-4o, according to data shared with The Wall Street Journal. By the end of the year, the same market share was spread across nine LLMs; Google's Gemini 3 Pro was the highest with 23%.

Google's Gemini had virtually no share among Perplexity's Enterprise users a year ago, showing how quickly things can shift in a rapidly evolving business. But Perplexity's data also shows how scale and heft still matter. As of December, a little over 98% of Per-

plexity's Enterprise users chose models from just three companies: Google, Anthropic and OpenAI.

It isn't a game that just anyone can play. Google has one of the largest cash balances on the planet. Anthropic and OpenAI are both working to raise billions in new financing while also racing toward IPOs.

But that is no guarantee any of them will continue to dominate the market. **Meta Platforms** plans to launch new models early this year, after spending a king's ransom on AI talent.

How those models will actually do is anyone's guess. But given how easy it is for AI users to switch, incumbents can never rest easy.

—Dan Gallagher

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LAY'S WON'T DO,
IT'S REDUCE PRICES."

- Michael

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